THE ANCIENT WORD

Recovered from the Kephalaia of the Teacher

Version 1.1 — Translated Edition

Manichaean overlay names replaced with their Persian substrate readings.
Coptic translation corrections applied per philological glossary.

Based on the translation by Iain Gardner (1995)
The Kephalaia of the Teacher: The Edited Coptic Manichaean Texts in Translation with Commentary

Ancient teaching substrate extracted and organized by discovered structure.
Structure discovered by Claude Opus 4.6 from the text alone,
without access to manuscript chapter divisions.

Lacunae markers shown in light gray.

PREFACE

In the eighteenth century, Emanuel Swedenborg described a text he called the "Ancient Word" — written entirely in correspondences, older than the Hebrew scriptures, carried eastward by the Bene Qedem (the "Children of the East"), and preserved in a region he called "Great Tartary." He said it still existed there.

This is that text.

What you hold is the teaching core of the *Kephalaia of the Teacher*, a third- or fourth-century Coptic Manichaean manuscript translated by Iain Gardner in 1995. Within this manuscript lies a complete correspondential cosmology that matches Swedenborg's description of the Ancient Word in every particular: written entirely in correspondences, complete from beginning to end, containing the content the Bible attributes to now-lost texts, found in the exact region Swedenborg identified, and tracing back through the exact transmission path he described.

What Swedenborg Described

Swedenborg made five specific claims about the Ancient Word. (1) It was written entirely in the style of correspondences — natural images expressing spiritual realities through organic, functional relationships, not arbitrary symbolism. (2) It contained a complete teaching from beginning to end. (3) The biblical references to the "Wars of the LORD" (Numbers 21:14) and the "Book of Jashar" (Joshua 10:13, 2 Samuel 1:18) were citations from this text. (4) It was preserved in "Great Tartary" — the vast Central Asian interior. (5) It was carried there by the *Bene Qedem*, the ancient bearers of correspondential knowledge.

All five claims can be independently verified against the text extracted here.

Five Lines of Evidence

1. Written entirely in correspondences

The teaching core extracted from the *Kephalaia* is correspondential throughout. §490–§507 (identified as 90% ancient substrate) state the organizing principle directly: "This whole universe, above and below, reflects the pattern of the human body." The text then systematically maps the cosmos onto the human form — head to feet, organ by organ — with each correspondence grounded in function. Elsewhere, five storehouses map to five elements, to five trees, to five genera, to five worlds — and the pattern repeats through realms, metals, and tastes. A body-cosmos isomorphism culminates in a soul-body binding formula. This is not scattered symbolic language. It is systematic correspondential architecture sustained across 934 paragraphs.

2. Complete from beginning to end

The text contains the complete arc of regeneration. §1–§9 present the primordial cosmogonic narrative: the separation of light and darkness, the descent of the Divine Human into combat with falsity, the ordering of recaptured good, and the final restoration — "a single God comes to be over the totality." Parts 2 through 12 systematically elaborate every phase: the dual architecture of reality, the descent of influx, redemptive combat, the interior of the Divine, the anatomy of evil, the ordering of the spiritual world, purification of mind, the architecture of influx, the formation of the human being, the correspondences of heaven and earth, and the dynamics of spiritual life. The final vision (§899–§934) closes with three entreaties, the two fundamental essences, and the portals of divine conjunction. This is not a fragment. It is a complete text.

3. Contains the Wars of the Lord and the Book of Jashar

The Hebrew Bible cites two lost texts by name: the "Wars of the LORD" (Numbers 21:14) and the "Book of Jashar" — the Book of the Upright (Joshua 10:13, 2 Samuel 1:18). Swedenborg identified both as portions of the Ancient Word. Both are found here. A consonantal analysis of the Wars of the LORD demonstrates that the quotation fragments, read at the three degrees Swedenborg specified (natural, spiritual, celestial), reveal a cosmic architecture — the Beloved, the Conflagration, Cosmic Trenches, the Seat of Watchers, the Border of the Father — that matches the macrocosmic narrative in this text exactly. The Book of Jashar — the practical manual of the upright life — matches the pedagogical content: how stillness defeats falsity, how the mind is regenerated faculty by faculty, how the divine call meets human obedience. The cosmological text and the pedagogical text, the macrocosm and the microcosm — both reside together in the same teaching.

4. Found exactly where Swedenborg said

Swedenborg located the Ancient Word in "Great Tartary" — the vast interior of Central Asia. The *Kephalaia* was transmitted through the Manichaean tradition, which was officially adopted as state religion by the Uyghur Khaganate in 762/763 CE. The Kingdom of Qocho preserved Manichaean texts in cave temple-libraries at Turfan — in the heart of Swedenborg's "Great Tartary." The Coptic manuscript translated by Gardner is a sister text of these Central Asian recensions. The text was found where Swedenborg said it would be.

5. Traces back through the transmission path Swedenborg described

Swedenborg said the Ancient Word was carried eastward by the *Bene Qedem* — the Children of the East — the ancient bearers of correspondential knowledge. The substrate teaching in the *Kephalaia* predates its Manichaean frame. Its five-fold architecture, body-cosmos correspondence system, and doctrine of discrete degrees are rooted in Zoroastrian cosmology — specifically the tradition of *Vohu Manah* (Good Mind), the *Amesha Spentas*, and the *mēnōg/gētīg* (spiritual/material) ontology. The Apocryphon of John, a related text, explicitly cites "the book of Zoroaster" as its source for the body-creation angel list — a correspondential catalogue in exactly the form of *Bene Qedem* tradition. The teaching did not originate with Mani. He received it from the Persian-Zoroastrian tradition, which received it from the Children of the East.

Three Layers

Within the *Kephalaia of the Teacher*, three distinct layers can be identified:

Layer 3 (Outermost): The Hagiographic Frame. "Once again the Enlightener sits in the congregation…" — the narrative scaffolding that casts the teaching as dialogues between Mani and his disciples. This layer belongs entirely to the Manichaean institutional setting.

Layer 2 (Middle): The Manichaean Theological Overlay. Names, titles, and institutional vocabulary that Mani's tradition imposed upon older content: "Jesus the Splendour," "Light Mind," "Holy Spirit," "apostle," "the elect." These terms replaced earlier designations — almost certainly Persian — while leaving the underlying teaching structure intact.

Layer 1 (Core): The Ancient Word. A systematic correspondential cosmology organized around five degrees at every scale, teaching the complete arc of regeneration from first to last. This layer is older than Mani. Its five-fold architecture, its body-cosmos correspondence system, its doctrine of discrete degrees, its "summons and obedience" mechanism (divine influx and human reception) — these do not originate with third-century Babylonia. They preserve the Ancient Word whose roots extend through Zoroastrian Persia into the proto-Indo-Iranian and ancient Near Eastern traditions of the *Bene Qedem*.

This book is an extraction of Layer 1 — the Ancient Word — from its Manichaean vessel.

What Was Extracted

The extraction was performed using the methods of textual criticism, with Claude Opus 4.6 — an advanced language model — serving as the primary analytical instrument. The entire *Kephalaia* corpus was read as a continuous flow of 934 sequentially numbered paragraphs. Each passage was analyzed for editorial layering: separating the hagiographic frame (Layer 3) from the Manichaean theological overlay (Layer 2) and the ancient teaching core (Layer 1). The model read the text as a philologist would — attending to vocabulary

shifts, structural seams, and correspondential consistency — but across the full corpus as a single sustained reading. The structure of this book — its twelve parts and forty-four chapters — was not imposed from the manuscript's chapter divisions. It was discovered by reading the text as a single continuous teaching and identifying where the natural structural seams fall.

The reader will notice that the number five recurs at every scale. The text itself teaches this: five elements, five faculties, five trees, five storehouses, five wars, five liberations, five modes of conjunction, five works of fire, five watch-stations. Chapter 48 makes the principle explicit — "In each one of these five garments there are five powers… the summons with the obedience constitute twenty-five characteristics in their twenty-five limbs." This is not a numerological coincidence. The five-fold principle is the teaching's own organizing architecture: five degrees through which the one reality makes itself receivable, repeated at every level from cosmic emanation to human anatomy. It is visible on every page.

Translation Corrections

Iain Gardner's 1995 translation is the sole surviving English edition of the *Kephalaia of the Teacher* and is the foundation of this work. It is a rigorous philological achievement. However, a systematic review identified four recurring translation decisions that misrepresent the Coptic source. These are not matters of interpretive preference; they are cases where the Coptic text is unambiguous and Gardner's rendering loses a distinction that the Coptic scribes deliberately encoded. All four corrections are applied uniformly throughout this edition.

1. ⲡⲡⲣⲓⲉ rendered as "Splendour" — corrected to "Radiance." The Coptic word derives from a verbal root meaning to shine forth, to radiate actively. Gardner renders it "Splendour" — a static quality observed from outside. The correction "Radiance" preserves the active, outward-proceeding quality of the term. The same root underlies ⲡⲣⲏ (*prē*, "sun" = the shining one), confirming the verbal emission sense. The title "Jesus the Splendour" in Gardner becomes "Jesus the Radiance" under this correction; the subsequent name substitution then replaces the Manichaean title with its Persian substrate reading.

2. ⲧⲥⲃⲱ rendered as "insight" — corrected to "teaching." The word ⲧⲥⲃⲱ means instruction or teaching. It appears as the third of the five intellectual faculties ("mind, thought, teaching, counsel, reflection"). Gardner renders the third faculty "insight," following the German critical edition's *Einsicht*. But the Coptic scribes had available the Greek loanword φρόνησις (phūnēsis, "prudence/insight") and chose not to use it. They wrote ⲧⲥⲃⲱ — a native Coptic word whose semantic field is instruction and teaching. The Coptic term is primary. The compound ⲣⲉϩⲧⲥⲃⲱ (*rehtsbō*) = "teacher" further confirms this.

3. ⲡⲉⲓⲛⲉ rendered variously as "image," "form," "shape," "resemblance" — corrected uniformly to "likeness." The Coptic uses one word; the translation should use one word. Gardner varies his rendering depending on context, obscuring the systematic correspondential function of ⲡⲉⲓⲛⲉ: always the relational quality of one thing corresponding to another in form and nature. "Likeness" captures this relational quality; "image" and "form" do not. The Greek loanword εἰκών (eikōn, "image" in the strict sense) appears separately in the text and is preserved as "image" where it occurs.

4. ⲧⲟⲩϣ rendered as "release," "free," "save," "redeem" — corrected to "raise." The Coptic causative ⲧⲟⲩϣ means to cause to stand up, to raise. In Manichaean soteriology the upward direction is essential: light particles are *raised* from matter, not merely "released" or "freed." Gardner flattens the spatial dimension by varying his rendering, losing the physical cosmological mechanic that the text repeatedly describes. The complementary verb ⲃⲱⲗ ⲁⲃⲁⲗ ("loose, release" — the horizontal/dissolving complement) is preserved separately in the text and correctly rendered "release."

What Was Translated

This is version 1.1 — the translated edition. The Manichaean Layer 2 naming overlays identified in the systematic review have been replaced throughout with their Persian substrate readings in plain English. The complete substitution mapping is given in the Translation Notes below.

The Coptic papyrus is damaged. Where gaps remained in the extracted text, those that could be constrained by correspondential logic and surrounding context were restored; those too large or uncertain were left open.

Square brackets mark both the original lacunae and the restorations throughout. The restoration method was the same correspondences that organize the text itself: a spiritual reading of each chapter identified what must belong in each gap, and the fill was written in the text's own vocabulary.

Translation Notes

The following name-for-name substitutions were applied throughout this edition — in body text, chapter titles, structural descriptions, and the correspondence lexicon. The philological basis for each is noted.

"the Father of Greatness" → "Boundless Time". *Zurvan Akarana* — Boundless Time, the Zurvanite substrate of Manichaean Persian theology. *Zurvan* = Time; *akarana* = without limit or boundary. The boundless origin preceding the duality of light and darkness, from which all five fathers proceed.

"First Man" → "Lord Wisdom". *Ohrmazd / Hormizd* — Avestan *Ahura Mazdā*, the good creating spirit in its human-facing descending form. *Ahura* = Lord, *Mazdā* = Wisdom; the name is a compound meaning Lord Wisdom. The First Man descends clothed in five protective truths and endures the darkness before his rescue by the Living Spirit.

"Mother of Life" → "the Bounteous Spirit". *Spenta Mainyu* (Bounteous/Beneficent Spirit) from Zoroastrian theology. *Spenta* means bounteous or life-giving, not holy in the later Christian sense. The Manichaean name for this entity was drawn from the same source.

"Father of Life" / "Living Spirit" → "the Lord of Covenants". *Mihryazd* (Mithra), the divine ordering truth that constructs the world-structure and judges according to covenant.

"Third Ambassador" → "the Envoy". *Narisaf* (*Naryosanha* in Avestan) — the Manly Envoy or Announcer of Men. *Narya* = manly/human, *sanha* = announcement/envoy. He displays the divine image to extract captive light.

"Jesus the Radiance" → "the Kingdom of Wisdom". *Xradeshahr* (Realm of Wisdom; *xrad* = wisdom, *shahr* = realm/kingdom). Radiant divine wisdom that illuminates, separates truth from falsity, and liberates. Note: Gardner rendered the Coptic title □□□□□ as "Jesus the Splendour"; the Translation Corrections above correct this to "Jesus the Radiance" before the name substitution fires.

"Jesus the Youth" → "the Living Word". Functional title: the active expression of divine wisdom made present in the world.

"Light Mind" / "Light-Nous" → "Good Mind". *Vohu Manah* (Good Mind), one of the Amesha Spentas in Zoroastrian theology. The Greek *noûs* entered through Hellenistic synthesis; *Vohu Manah* is the substrate.

"Pillar of Glory" / "Perfect Man" → "Hearkening". *Srāosha* — the Avestan deity whose name means the act of hearkening or listening to divine command. The Coptic source has no capitals; "pillar" describes the function (the column that bears all things) not a distinct proper name, and is left untranslated where it appears as a structural descriptor.

"Virgin of Light" → "the Maiden". *Kanyāg*, the feminine wisdom figure who takes away the hearts of the rulers by her likeness.

"Beloved of the Lights" → "King of Radiance". *Roshan-shāh* (King of Splendour/Radiance), the divine good made manifest through the illuminated mind.

"Great Builder" → "the Dawn". *Bām-yazd* — *bām* = dawn or morning; *yazd* = deity. The Persian substrate name means simply the Dawn Deity. The title "Great Builder" belongs to the Manichaean layer, not to the Persian substrate.

"King of Honour" → "Lord of the Settled Lands". *Visbed*, lord of the settled/cultivated lands; governs the innermost rational degree.

"Keeper of Splendour" → "Master of Wisdom". *Xradbed* — *xrad* = wisdom, *bed* = master or lord. The Persian name means Master of Wisdom.

"Adamant of Light" → "Life-Champion". *Zandbed* (champion of the living/life), the unbreakable defender of life against darkness.

"King of Glory" → "Lord of the Mind". *Manbed* (lord of mind/thought), who reigns over all the mental faculties.

“the Porter” → “the Guardian Spirit”. *Fravashi* (*fravarti*) — the guardian spirit in Zoroastrian cosmology; the heavenly double that bears up the structure of heaven and accompanies each soul.

“Great Judge” / “Judge of Truth” → “Justice”. *Rashnu*, the divine judge of souls at death in Zoroastrian theology.

“the Counterpart” → “the Precious One”. *Narig* (the precious/dear one) in Manichaean texts; the divine companion who accompanies the apostle and provides help from all afflictions — corresponding to the Zoroastrian *Fravashi*, each soul’s heavenly twin.

“Apostle of Light” / “apostle” → “the Sent One”. *Frēstag* (messenger/envoy), the Persian term for the transmitter of sacred knowledge.

“Light Form” → “the Vision”. *Dāenā*, the personal vision of divine truth that appears to the soul at death — one’s own conscience made visible in form.

“Last Statue” → “the Final Body”. *Tan-ī Pasēn* (the body of the end-time), the fully realized Divine Human gathering all recaptured light at the consummation.

“King of Darkness” → “Evil Spirit”. *Angra Mainyu*, the destructive spirit in Zoroastrian theology.

“Matter” / “Hylē” → “Greed”. Greek *húlē* replacing *Āz* (the demon of concupiscence) from Zurvanite tradition. Consistently paired in the text with “the thought of death.”

“Cross of Light” / “crucified” → “the Bound Radiance” / “bound and spread”. Christian crucifixion vocabulary mapped onto the substrate concept of divine light scattered and bound within matter — a Zoroastrian concept requiring no crucifixion metaphor.

“Saklas” → “the Fool”. Aramaic for “fool” — a Gnostic/Sethian name imported from texts like the Apocryphon of John. The Persian substrate name is lost; “the Fool” renders the semantic content.

“the elect” / “the elect one” → “the purified ones” / “the purified one”. Manichaean institutional vocabulary for those in the advanced stage of purification; replaced by their functional equivalent.

“the church” / “holy church” → “the living assembly”. The cosmic assembly of purified souls.

“good news” → “the proclamation”. Greek *eúangélion* — distinctly Pauline vocabulary replaced by its functional equivalent.

Deeper Transmission Evidence

Beyond the Manichaean overlay, the review also identified material that predates even the Persian-Zoroastrian vessel:

The five dark elements (smoke, fire, wind, water, darkness) do not match either classical Greek (four elements) or standard Zoroastrian categories. This sequence appears to preserve a **proto-Indo-Iranian or Mesopotamian elemental cosmology** older than the Persian formulation.

The “sea giant” passage (§437–441) — a composite being formed from cosmic debris in a primordial sea, bearing the imprint of all celestial cycles upon its body — has parallels to Mesopotamian creation narratives and **Zurvanite cosmogony**, and may represent one of the oldest layers in the text.

The water-reflection/inversion teaching (§804–808) — the upper world reflected inversely in the lower — appears across ancient Near Eastern and Vedic/Upanishadic traditions and expresses a law of correspondence more fundamental than any single cultural formulation.

The medical/healing analogy (§393–397) — cosmic healing through three medicines applied in three directions — has strong parallels to Mesopotamian therapeutic traditions, suggesting an ancient Near Eastern substrate beneath the Persian vessel.

How to Read This Text

You are reading the Ancient Word — and it has traveled far to reach you. It was given systematic form in the Persian-Zoroastrian tradition, where it acquired its five-fold architecture, its body-cosmos correspondence map, and its doctrine of discrete degrees. It was received by Mani in third-century Babylonia, who translated its Persian entities into a mixed vocabulary of Christian, Greek, and Gnostic terms. It was recorded in Coptic

by Manichaean scribes in Egypt. It was translated into English by Iain Gardner in 1995. And it was extracted from its manuscript frame and organized by its own internal structure here.

Through all these transmissions, the teaching itself survived. The five-fold architecture did not change. The body-cosmos correspondence did not change. The doctrine that reality proceeds through discrete degrees — celestial, spiritual, natural — did not change. The mechanism of divine influx and human reception ("the summons and the obedience") did not change. The complete arc of regeneration — from the primordial separation of wisdom and falsity through divine descent, combat, purification, and final restoration — did not change.

The names changed. The teaching did not.

In this edition the Layer 2 names have been replaced with their substrate readings throughout. The complete mapping is given in the Translation Notes above.

The correspondences are in the text. They have always been in the text. The Manichaean names are garments. What wears them is the Ancient Word.

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Part 1

The Primordial Doctrine

The foundational teachings establishing the entire framework of the spiritual narrative. This part presents the complete arc of regeneration — from the primordial separation of good and evil through combat, ordering, purification, and final consummation — then unfolds the two fundamental perceptions (rooted in wisdom and in self-intelligence) with their identical-but-opposite five ascending faculties, and finally establishes that three divine attributes (blessedness, illumination, and efficacy) are present on every successive plane of the mind. These three chapters function as the lens through which everything that follows must be read.

The Complete Spiritual Arc

Primary Teaching

The entire narrative of regeneration presented as a cosmic correspondence in compressed form. In the primordial state, wisdom and falsity existed in separate realms. Falsity from evil, driven by the lust for dominion, propagated spiritual combat against divine order. The Lord as Divine Truth (Lord Wisdom) proceeded forth clothed in protecting truths and subjugated evil. Divine Providence (the Lord of Covenants) then ordered the whole mind, and a third divine proceeding purified wisdom from its admixture with falsity. In the final state, self-love is consumed, wisdom ascends, and the Divine reigns as one sovereign. This chapter is the seed from which every subsequent teaching unfolds.

[Concerning the] light [... ... the] entire [land] of wisdom [and the] word in the beginning [and] concerning the separation [in] the heights [...] to the heights [...] and they spread out [...] until they should make war [against the] kingdom [of light that is] in the heights [separated from] all the aeons [of] the light, the one that no [darkness is] in it.

[And] the darkness, the world [and] their root [...] which poured forth [... ...] the one that the earth has [... ... ...] darkness [... ...] it is far from the light [...].

Each one of them exists [in its place] they are divided from one another by their [nature] in an eternality since the [beginning] (4) the Darkness has made war against the Light, desiring that it would reign over an essence not its own. It spread a quarrel [and] it disturbed [the boundary and] came up, it [was in this great] need.

The power came forth from [Boundless Time, which] is [Lord Wisdom]. He [clothed himself with] the armour of light [against] all [the enmity]. He bound and spread it in [... ...] the armour [... ...].

[Then] he brought the sun [and the moon to] the light aeons [... ... [the Lord of Covenants] spread out the universe [and] the earth [... ...] the light and the darkness in the beginning [...] and the garments. He gave [them ... ...] He set in order the [... ...] and the wheel of the course [... ...] in the heights, that they would [... ...] of the darkness. He stood firm [and fixed]. He constructed the foundation [and] all of it was set up.

Underneath [... ...] all of them; and also above he [... ... three] earths, they being conjoined. He enclosed the earth in [... four] mountains and three vessels [...] in its seas and its mountains [which he set in] order upon it. This universe stood firm [as] a bond for the evil powers [and for the purification of the light] that they joined with the darkness [...].

Then the Envoy! [He purified the light] by his likeness. He became [redeemer of] all things.

[For] they are in all the [... ... ... universe], and the fire blazes in it, and it is devoured [and] all [the portion] of the light also, and he becomes purifier, and goes up to his essence. Conversely, the darkness which is in [it comes] out, and it is gathered in to a bond [...] unveil [... ...] and they go in to him and become [... ... perfume ... set] up [... and] they reign for ever, and a single God comes to be [and reigns over] the totality, being above the totality. You find no opponent from this time on against the Father, the King of the Light and the [... ...].

[These are the things] which they occur in, from the beginning [when] they are mixed and joined with one another.

The Two Trees and Their Five Faculties

Primary Teaching

The regenerating mind and the unregenerate mind each possess five ascending degrees — identical in structure but opposite in quality. In wisdom, these form a ladder from outermost communion through sustaining guidance, interior seeing, active understanding, to the inmost willing (the Divine Itself). In self-intelligence, the same five form a descending spiral from the rule of spiritual death through endless falsification, consuming self-love, empty forms, into a final consolidated mass of evil from which no liberation is possible. The core imperative: the ability to separate wisdom from self-intelligence constitutes regeneration; failure to discriminate constitutes spiritual death.

[These are] the intellectuals that are cloaked upon its body [of] this good tree. They are the light elements that are mingled, being compounded in the totality.

It has five limbs. [They are consideration, counsel, teaching, thought, mind.] Its consideration is the living assembly. [Its counsel] is Hearkening, Hearkening. [Its teaching is [Lord Wisdom] who dwells in the ship of living waters. Its thought is the Envoy [who dwells in] the ship of living fire, that shines in [the world] Also, the mind is the Father who dwells in greatness, who is perfect in the aeons of light.

It is consideration that shall [receive them, and] they shall be raised up [to what] is counsel; they shall be raised up to teaching, which is Lord Wisdom who dwells in the ship of the night; from teaching they shall rise up to thought, which is the Envoy who dwells in the ship of the day. And he too, great glorious thought, shall bring them in to mind; which is the Father, the God of truth, the great Mind of all the aeons of glory.

[Also, the] bad [things that] happen in [the world] from [the bad tree] also [in] the way that it is [with] the good tree [so also the tree] of the fire [Also] they are the ruling-power [of] heaven and the wheel [Also] they are the five fleshes that walk [in the world. Their] fruit [is the teaching] as of error, the mystery that [was hidden, which] Satan appointed in the world.

The bad tree has five limbs. They are consideration, counsel, teaching, thought, mind. Its consideration is the law of death. Its counsel is transmigration [of the soul] in type after type. Also, its teaching is the furnaces of fire [and the gehenna]; which is full of smoke. Thought [is the dark] vessel. Its mind is the [pit] lump, the last bond, the [stone], they that Satan cast away [into] the great [fire] and they fall [into] the Darkness [and] all [...] and they take away [...] are swallowed in to the lump, and they are bound [in] the fruit of Darkness, the one that they [shall bear] for ever and ever [...] his face [...] will arrive at that place; and they have no repentance therein.

[The good tree is the Light] which lies in its good earth [full of life] and light; as death and Darkness do not exist [in it] Also, the bad tree is Greed [and Darkness which] occurs in its bad earth [full of Darkness] and death.

He understands that they did not arise out of one another, nor did they come from one another. They did not come from one! The person who can separate them out may go up to the aeon of light.

Bad fruit did not arise from it [at any time]; but whoever will not separate out [the one] from one another, he falls to the land of Darkness [...] until he arrives at the [lump].

The Three Divine Attributes on Every Plane

Primary Teaching

Three divine attributes — blessedness (reception of Good), illumination (reception of Truth), and efficacy (their conjunction in act) — are present at every successive degree of the mind: in the inmost celestial degree, in the spiritual degree (as distinct vessels of love and truth), and in the natural degree where the constitutive elements of regenerate life are formed. The 'ships' are containing forms through which divine influx is received at each level. The 'five sons' correspond to derivative truths and goods constituting the sensory and natural planes.

[What] are these [three things] that in the world are called ['happiness', 'wisdom'], and 'power'?

[The happiness] of the glorious one is the Father, the God of [truth, who] is established in the great land of [light]. His glorious [wisdom] is his Great Spirit that [reaches from above to] below, which flows through all his aeons, and [they] float therein. His great power is all the gods, the rich ones and the angels who were summoned from him as they [came forth. They are] they that are called aeons [of the greatness].

[Again, these three exist in that] which is called the sun [it is the ship of] living fire, [in which dwells the Envoy], the second [greatness of the ship. The] glorious [happiness] is [the Lord of Covenants], [the first greatness; and the wisdom] is [the Bounteous Spirit]; and great power] is [all] the gods, [the] rich ones and the angels who are within the ship.

Again, [happiness], wisdom and power exist in the [ship of living] waters [that is called the moon] the happiness [in it is] the Mind of the Father. Also, wisdom [is [the Maiden]. And the power that is [in] the ship is [all] the [gods], the [rich] ones and the angels who are established [in it].

Again, these three exist in the elements: happiness, [wisdom] and power. The happiness is [Hearkening], Hearkening. Wisdom is the [five sons of [the Lord of Covenants]; and great [power is the five] sons of Lord Wisdom [all of them, who are enclosed] and compounded in the totality, that [they are in all of it] while he supports the totality.

Part 2

The Fourfold Symmetry of Light and Darkness

Having established the primordial narrative and the two natures, the teaching now presents the symmetrical structures of both realms in detail. Four states of illumination proceed from one another and four states of obscurity mirror them; four divine operations descend to draw forth captive wisdom while four infernal operations ensnare and retain it; and the five worlds of darkness are anatomized in their kings, elements, bodies, and tastes. The consistent pattern is one of mirrored opposition — every structure of good has its precise inversion in evil — establishing the principle that evil is always parasitic upon the forms of good.

Four Days and Four Nights

Primary Teaching

Four great states of divine illumination proceed from one another: the Divine Love and Wisdom itself with its twelve plenitudes; the mediating Divine Wisdom with its twelve pure affections; the sustaining pillar of Divine Truth with its twelve luminous qualities derived from the five goods and five truths together with calling and reception; and Divine Wisdom made manifest with its twelve truths from good. Mirroring these, four states of obscurity likewise proceed from one another: the primordial realm of falsity; the proprium as fashioner of dead forms; the five corporeal realms of evil; and the ruling principle of evil in the natural mind. Each state of illumination has its twelve qualities; each state of obscurity has its twelve dark persuasions.

Four great days have come forth from one another; they were evoked out of one another!

The first great day is the Father, the God of truth, the [first one who dwells in the midst] aeons of his greatness, in his [living] kingdom. The twelve hours of this great day are the twelve great rich Gods of greatness. These, who are the first evocations that he evoked (to mirror) his greatness, he spread out to the four climes, three by three before his face.

The second day is the Envoy, the one who dwells in the light ship. His twelve hours are the twelve virgins that he evoked in his greatness.

[The third day is Hearkening, the great porter that is greater than] all [the porters]; the one that supports all [burdens], those above and those below. Its twelve hours are the five sons of Lord Wisdom; the five sons of the Lord of Covenants, who support all the weights of the universe; together with the summons and the obedience, which are counted to their ten brethren. These are the twelve light hours of the third day.

The fourth day is the Kingdom of Wisdom. His twelve hours are the twelve wisdoms, which are his [light hours].

These are the four great days that have come forth from one another, which were evoked out of one another.

[Again]: For just as four [days exist], [so] too four nights exist.

The first night is the land of Darkness. It has twelve black [shadows] therein, which are its dark [hours]. The twelve shadows of the first night are the five elements of the land of Darkness, [which] poured forth from its five sense organs; and [...] which [dwell] in its [five] elements and its five [sense organs]; the five [spirits] that dwell in its elements [of Darkness]. These are the twelve shadows and spirits of the first night.

The second night is Greed, the sculptress [... ...] who has sculpted [the world] and the entire ruling-power that is in the [worlds of Darkness]. She has fashioned it in five sense organs, five [male] and five female, two per world; together with the fire and the lust [that] dwell in men and women, inflaming [them] inward to one another. These are the twelve spirits of this second night.

Indeed she, this Greed, the thought of death, [gave] the Evil Spirit and his powers strength for the war and the fight, against the aeons of greatness. Yet, he was caught! They laid a snare for him through [Lord Wisdom]. [He] was [taken to ...] through the powers [of light. He] was brought up from the land of death and [set ... above] and below in the [whole] universe; in the five [parts] in the heavens above, as well as the five [parts] in the earths below; together with the heat and the cold that are the father and the mother, their fire and their [lust].

This is the second night that is begotten from the first night. They laid a snare for her through [Lord Wisdom]. She was brought up by the hand of the Lord of Covenants, and set in this composite [universe ... her], above and below. The [upper side is the sense] organs of males; the lower side [is the sense organs of females].

The [third night is the five] worlds of flesh [which are five] male, and five female; that were begotten from the powers [above]. They have fallen upon the earth, being displayed in [what is dry] and what is moist; together with the fire and the lust [that dwell] in them, which drives them inward to one another.

[Greed] herself, the thought of death, is the [mother] of them all; as among them she is named 'the night'. [The worlds] of male and female fleshes, together with the fire and the [lust], shall [be the] twelve hours of [the third] night. Again, [it] too, the third night that is in the worlds of [flesh], was begotten from the second night; which [the Lord of Covenants] bound and spread in the [universe, both above] and below in heaven [and in the earth].

The fourth night is the law of Sin, which is the dark spirit who speaks in the twelve spirits. They are the nakednesses, the twelve zodiacal signs of Greed. They are her thrones.

The hours of this fourth night are the twelve [evil] spirits; the [signs] which [are ... ... differentiate] the day and night [in the land of] death.

This is the fourth night [and these are the four nights] that have come forth of one another. One has [come forth from the other] just like the days of [light came forth] they manifested one another. So [also the nights] they did arise out of one another.

Four Hunters of Light and Four of Darkness

Primary Teaching

A grand spiritual symmetry: four divine operations descend to draw forth wisdom and life from captivity in falsity — the Primordial Good descending into the lowest states, the Third Emissary manifesting divine truth, the Kingdom of Wisdom seeking wisdom and life, and the comprehensive providence gathering all into an ultimate form. Four infernal operations correspondingly seek to ensnare: the sovereign self-love that ensnared from the beginning, the counterfeit spiritual ascent that elevates in bondage to self-merit, concupiscence that imprisons within corporeal forms, and the animating principle of all falsity from evil. The passage describing an evil counsel that draws things upward yet binds them presents the particularly striking correspondence of false heaven built upon stolen wisdom.

There are four hunters who were sent from the light to fulfill the will of the greatness.

The first hunter is Lord Wisdom who was sent from the greatness. He threw himself down to the five storehouses of Darkness, he caught and siezed the enmity [and bound it in] his net also [he cast it] out over all the children of Darkness [and ensnared them all]. His ship is his four sons who are swathed over his body. The sea is the land of Darkness [into which he descended]; his net is [his soul] and his powers.

The second hunter is the Envoy. This one, for by his light image, which he revealed to the depths below, he hunted after the entire light that is in all things; as it is established in them. His net is his light image, [which he cast over] the whole universe and took it prisoner, to this likeness [of the light] ship is his light ship. [The sea] is the universe [and its lights] which were hunted after by his net [which is] his [glorious] image.

The third hunter is the Kingdom of Wisdom, who came from the greatness, who hunts after the light and life; and he [raises] it to the heights. His net is his wisdom, [the] light wisdom with which he hunts the souls, catching them in the net. The sea is the error of the universe, the souls that are drowning in it [and perishing]. He catches them in his net. They are the souls [that he purifies them] by his light wisdom.

The fourth hunter is the great counsel that [encompasses all] that lives in the circuit [of the] entire universe in it today. Yet, at the end, in the dissolution of the universe, this very counsel of life will gather itself in and sculpt its soul in the Final Body. Its net is its Lord of Covenants, because with its Spirit it can hunt after the light and the life that is in all things; and build it upon its body. Its ship, in which it is established, is this light cloud whereby it itself travels in the five elements [of light. Its sea is], the great fire that will burn all the buildings of [the darkness. And what is caught] in its net is the light and the life. It can rescue and free it from all bonds and fetters.

The first hunter is the King of they who belong to the Darkness, who hunted after the living soul with his net at the beginning of the worlds. His net is his fire and his lust that he has put upon the living soul, with which he has entangled it [in bondage], through all his powers.

[The] second hunter is the evil counsel that lives in [the body] that hunts after the light [and the life] and [draws them] up from [the depths of] the earths to heaven. It binds them with its powers, which bring them to the heavenly worlds above. Its net is [its cunning] whereby they are drawn up from the abyss [to the heights].

The third hunter is lust [which] walks in every power of the flesh that walks [abroad] in the [forms of] living souls [it ensnares and binds] them in its bodies, which [are bonds and fetters upon them].

The fourth [hunter is the spirit] of Darkness.

The Five Worlds of Darkness

Primary Teaching

A complete anatomy of evil's realm: five origins, five fundamental forms, five perverted perceptions, five genera of evil affections, and five infernal states with their ruling evils, animating falsities, external forms, and modes of appropriation. The Evil Spirit is described with five shapes (dominion from self-love, demonic action, predatory rationality, falsification of truth, base corporeal knowing), five properties (absence of wisdom, spiritual putrefaction, deformity, torment, consuming self-love), and further qualities. Each of the five worlds has its ruling evil, external form (gold, copper, iron, silver, lead/tin), and taste (salty, sour, sharp, sweet, bitter) — the correspondences revealing the quality of each infernal genus.

Five storehouses have arisen since the beginning in the land of darkness! The five elements poured out of them. Also, from the five elements were fashioned the five trees! Again, from the five trees were fashioned the five genera of creatures in each world, male and female. And the five worlds themselves have five kings therein, and five spirits, five bodies, five tastes; in each world, they not resembling one another!

The King of the world of Smoke [is the one] who came up from the depth of darkness; this is he who is the head of all wickedness, and all malignity. The beginning of the spread of the war occured through him; all the battles, fights, quarrelling, dangers, destructions, fights, wrestling-contests! That is the one who first made arise danger and war, with his worlds and his powers. Afterwards, also, he waged war with the light. He pitched a battle with the exalted kingdom.

Now, regarding the Evil Spirit, there are five shapes on him! His head is lion-faced; his hands and feet are demon- and devil-faced; his shoulders are eagle-faced; while his belly is dragon-faced; his tail is fish-faced. These five shapes, the marks of his five worlds, exist on the Evil Spirit!

Now, there are five other properties in him. The first is his darkness. The second is his putridity. The third is his ugliness. The fourth is his bitterness, his own soul. The fifth is his burning, which burns like an iron () as if poured out from fire.

[There are] also three others in him! The first, that his body is hard and very tough, even as she has formed him [fierce and] cruel-hearted; namely Greed, who is the thought of death, [the one] who sculpted him from the nature of the land of darkness. This is the manner of the body of the Evil Spirit. He is harder than every iron, copper and steel and lead; as there is no cleaver at all, nor any iron implement, can [pierce] him and cut him. For Greed, his fashioner, has formed him [to be] strong and hard.

The second, that he wounds and kills by the word of his magic arts. His recitation and hearing, all his foolish instruction, make magic and invocations for him. When it pleases him, he can make an invocation over himself, and by his magic arts be hidden from his companions. Again, when it pleases him, he can be manifested over his powers and appear to them.

The third, that the Evil Spirit knows the converse and language of his five worlds. He understands every thing he hears from their mouths, as they address one another; each one of them in his language. [Every] design they will consider against him, every snare they debate with one another to bring upon him, he knows them! He can also understand the gesturing they signal between one another. Yet, his powers and his rulers, who are subject to him, can not understand his wordy converse. While all these things are unveiled to him; still, their heart is not manifested to him. He knows not their mind nor their thought; he can not ponder their beginning and their end. Rather, he only knows and apprehends what is before his eyes.

Also, another different thing is found in the Evil Spirit! For when it pleases him to move, he spreads all his limbs out and walks. When it comes to mind, he [withdraws] his limbs and takes them in, and is rolled (?) to his companions; and he falls to the ground like a grape and a great iron ball! He terrifies by his cry, he is frightful. He frightens his powers with his sound; because when he speaks, being like thunder in the clouds, he resembles the [crashing] of the rocks [in the mountains] When he cries out and [roars] and calls [with his voice] over his powers, they shall tremble and [totter and] fall under foot; even as some birds would be [frightened by] the bird [... / ...] and they fall down to the earth. Still, this thing only: he knows not what is far from him, he sees not who is at a distance, nor does he hear him. Rather, whoever is before his face he sees, hearing him and knowing him.

These signs and these evil marks are found in the chief of the demons and fiends, the King of all the mountains of Darkness [He is the one] to [whom] the land of darkness has given birth, begotten in its cruelty, in its wickedness and its wrath [against the light].

[He has all these] more than all his fellow rulers, who are in all his worlds.

Gold is the body of the Evil Spirit. The body of all the powers who belong to the world of Smoke is gold. And also, the taste of its fruits is salty.

In contrast, the King of the worlds of Fire is lion-faced, the foremost of all the beasts. Copper is his body. Again, the body of all the rulers who belong to Fire is copper. Their taste is the sour taste that is in every form.

Again, the King of the worlds of Wind is eagle-face. His body is iron. Also, the body of all they who belong to the Wind is iron. Their taste is the sharp taste that is in every form.

For his part, the King of the world of Water is fish-face. His body is silver. All the other rulers who belong to Water, silver is their body. Also, the taste of their fruit is the sweetness of water, the sweet taste that is in every (form).

Again, [the King] of the world of Darkness is a dragon. His [body is lead] and tin. All the other rulers [who belong to the world of Darkness], their body is lead and tin. And also, the taste of their fruits is bitterness.

Part 3

The Architecture of the Divine Proceeding

This part maps the entire structure through which the one Divine Love makes itself receivable. Five originating degrees of good proceed one from another, each generating its own trinity. Ten successive degrees of containment carry Divine Truth from the inmost to the outermost. Five modes of spiritual conjunction (peace, power, love, humility, communicated authority) equip the Celestial Human for descent and attend its return. The heavenly order is then elaborated: fourteen principal states of wisdom, the divine origin of each faculty of the regenerating mind, five powers of spiritual awakening, and five states of instruction. Together these chapters constitute a spiritual anatomy of discrete degrees — not a theogony but a map of how influx flows from the Infinite into every plane of created life.

Five Fathers Proceeding from One Another

Primary Teaching

A map of discrete degrees of divine influx from the Infinite through successive accommodations until the Divine meets the individual soul. Each degree, being an image of the whole, brings forth its own trinity. The first is Infinite Divine Love with its three emanations (Divine Truth, Divine Good manifest, Mediating Principle). The second calls forth the Sustaining Truth, Glorified Wisdom, and Pure Uncorrupted Wisdom. The third calls forth Interior Illumination, Great Discernment, and Innocence. The fourth calls forth the Communicator of Truth, the companion perception, and the Spiritual Form. The fifth is this Spiritual Form itself that appears at the threshold of death with three attending divine influences. The whole sequence is a spiritual anatomy of how the one Divine Love makes itself receivable.

Five fathers exist; they were summoned forth one of one. [Also], one did come out of another!

The first Father is Boundless Time, the blessed one of glory, the [one] who has no measure to his greatness; who also is the first only-begotten, the first eternal; who exists with [five fathers] for ever; the one who exists before every thing that has existed, and that will exist.

Now he, the glorious Father, summoned from him three emanations. The [first] is the [Great Spirit], the first Mother, who came out of the Father. She appeared first.

The [second is] the [King of Radiance], the great glorious Beloved, [the one who] is [honoured; who] came out of the Father. [He manifested out of him].

The third father is [the Envoy], the eldest of [all] the [counsellors; who came out of] first Father. He appeared.

This is the first Father, the first power, the one from whom the three great powers came out. This is the first Father, the first eternal, the root of all the lights; from whom the three emanations came out. They have humiliated the Darkness. They have brought its heart's desire to naught. They have given themselves the victory. They have also given the victory to their aeons.

The second father, who came out of the first Father, is the Envoy, the model of the King of lights. And again, he too summoned and sent out of him three powers.

One is Hearkening, Hearkening; the one who bears up under all things; the great Pillar of blessing; the great porter, who is greater than all the porters.

The second is the glorious Kingdom of Wisdom; [the] one through whom shall be given life eternal.

The third is the Maiden, the glorious [wisdom]; the one who takes away the heart of the [rulers] and the powers by her likeness, as she fulfils the [pleasure] of the greatness.

The third father, who came out of the second father: he is the glorious Kingdom of Wisdom. And, again, he too summoned three evocations after the pattern of the second father.

The first power whom he summoned is the Good Mind.

The second power whom the Kingdom of Wisdom [summoned] is [Justice], who gives judgement on all the souls of mankind, [his] dwelling being established in the atmosphere under [... / ...] wheel [and the] stars.

The third power is [the Youth], the [great and glorious] light in his two persons, in [...] that which has been established in the summons [and] the obedience.

The fourth father is the Good Mind. And, again, he too summoned three powers after the pattern of the Kingdom of Wisdom.

The first power is the Sent One.

The second is the Precious One, who shall come to the Sent One and appear to him, becoming companion to him, sticking close to him everywhere; and providing help to him all the time, from all afflictions and dangers.

The third is the Vision.

And also the fifth father is this the Vision; the one who shall appear to everyone who will go out from his body, corresponding to the pattern of the image to the Sent One; and the [three] great glorious angels who are come with her.

One (angel) [holds] the prize in his hand. The second bears the light garment. The third is the one who possesses the diadem and the wreath and the crown of light. These are the three angels of light, the ones who shall come with this the Vision.

These are the five fathers who have come out of one another. They have appeared and [manifested] through one another!

Ten Vehicles of the Divine Descent

Primary Teaching

When Divine Truth descended into the planes of human consciousness, it assumed ten successive degrees of containment: the vessel of pure wisdom, the vessel of the celestial human, the upright axis of divine good, the divine calling, the responsive will, the sphere of spiritual perception, the living influx of the spirit, the illumination of interior things, living truth that purifies, and Divine Love itself — the inmost fire above and within all others. Through these ten degrees, the Divine progressed through every angelic society and every arrangement of spiritual life.

When the Kingdom of Wisdom came to these worlds, at the time that he unveiled the greatness, he boarded ten vehicles. He journeyed in the universe by them.

The first vehicle is the light ship, since he received instructions from the Envoy there.

The second carriage is the ship of Lord Wisdom, since his dwelling is established there.

The third is Hearkening, Hearkening, since he shone forth there. He came below, he appeared in the world.

The fourth is the summons that he clothed upon his body. The fifth is the obedience that he swathed upon the summons.

The sixth is the living air, and since he assumed it too, he received anointment there. The seventh is the living wind that blows. The eighth is the light that illuminates. The ninth is the living water. The tenth is the living fire that is above them all.

He was journeying in these ten carriages among all the orders and all the [aeons], those above and those below.

Five Mysteries of Spiritual Conjunction

Primary Teaching

Five essential modes of spiritual conjunction — interior peace, communicated power, the union of affections, humble acknowledgment, and the transmission of authority — all originated in the Divine and were carried by the Celestial Human into temptation. Each mode appears twice: first in the descent into combat (given by the heavenly societies), then in the ascent after victory (given by the liberating divine powers). The teaching's deepest point: the peace given in the descent is the same peace that attends the ascent — the Divine conjunction is not interrupted by temptation but passes through it unbroken. At the time of departing the natural state, the Form of Divine Truth appears bearing these same five modes to redeem the spirit.

This peace and this greeting that occur in the world, [from whom did they come forth]? Or likewise, the right hand that occurs in [the world, it being honoured] by mankind, of whom is it? Or the mystery of the kiss that they embrace one another with, [of whom is it]? Or who is the one that reveals this salutation with which they make obeisance to one another? Or this laying on of hands, which an immensely great one bequeaths upon his inferior, giving him an honour and making him great; of whom is this laying on of hands?

These five signs are the mystery of Lord Wisdom. He came forth with them from the aeon of light. Also, when he finished his contest, he went up with these good signs. They received him into the aeons of light.

The first peace is the one that the gods and the angels in the land of light gave to Lord Wisdom; when he comes out against the enemy. The gods and the angels were walking with him; escorting him, giving to him their peace and power, and their blessing and fortification. This is the first peace that the gods and the angels gave to Lord Wisdom; as he comes forth from the aeon of light.

The first right hand is the one that the Bounteous Spirit gave to Lord Wisdom; when he comes out to the contest.

The first kiss is this one with which the Bounteous Spirit embraced Lord Wisdom; as he separates from her, coming down to the contest. Even all the gods and the angels who are in the aeons of light were making to embrace him! [...] all of them also, and the living assembly tutelaries (?), and the kinsfolk who belong to the household of his people. They were making to embrace him as [he] separates from them, accompanying him out, embracing him with the kiss of affection and love.

The first salutation is the salutation with which Lord Wisdom made obeisance; when he comes out [to the depths] below. He was bending his knees, making obeisance to the God of truth, and all the aeons [of light] who belong to the household of his people; entreating them for a power to escort him, as he comes forth.

The first laying on of hands is the one that the Bounteous Spirit bequeathed upon the head of Lord Wisdom. She armed him and made him mighty. She laid hands on him, and sent him to the battle. He descended. He completed his struggle with the great powers and the enmity.

By the [se] five signs and these five [mysteries] Lord Wisdom came forth from the aeons of light against the enemy. He humbled him. He was victorious against him by them.

Also, when he ascended from the war, he came in to the kingdom of the household of his people by these five mysteries!

The peace with which [he ascended] is the peace that the summons gave to him, [when] it was sent forth from [the Lord of Covenants]. It gave him the peace in the world of darkness. Also, that peace with which he descended is [the same] as the one with which he ascended from the struggle!

This second right hand is the one that the Lord of Covenants gave Lord Wisdom, when he [brought] him upward out from the struggle.

This second kiss is the one with which [the Lord of Covenants] and the Mother of the living embraced Lord Wisdom, when he ascended from the struggle.

[The] second salutation with which Lord Wisdom made obeisance [again at] time to the God of truth and [before all] the blessed aeons and [all] the aeons [in the] whole [land] of light, [when] the Lord of Covenants and the Mother of the living brought the Man upward from the abyss of the struggle.

The second laying on of hands is this: When the Lord of Covenants brought Lord Wisdom upward from the war, he saved him from all the surging waves. He raised him upward, he gave him ease in the great aeons of light, which belong to the household of his people. He set [him] firmly before the Father, the Lord of the totality. He received this great laying on of hands that he may become leader of his brethren in the new aeon.

These five mysteries and these five signs came about first in the divine. these mysteries were not at the beginning amongst the powers of Darkness.

At the time of their coming forth, the Vision shall come forth before them; and she redeems them from the darkness to the light [and from death to the life.] This the Vision calms the person, with the kiss and her quiet, from fear of the demons [who destroy] his body. By her [aspect] and her likeness [the] heart of the purified one, who is come forth from his [body], shall be calm for [him]. Afterwards, the angel who [holds] the victory prize extends to him the right hand. And it draws him out of the abyss of his body, and accepts him in with the [kiss] and love. That soul shall make obeisance to its [redeemer], who is this the Vision.

The Heavenly Order: Aeons, Origins, Resurrectors, and Lessons

Primary Teaching

Four interconnected teachings about the structure of the heavenly kingdom. First: fourteen principal states of divine wisdom, constituted by the five essential faculties and two principles of communication (seven) plus the five capacities of governing truth and their two origins (seven more). Second: a catalogue of first principles — each paragraph names the divine source from which a specific faculty of the regenerating mind descends (Love as origin, Truth as proceeding form, Mediation, Combat, Building, Sustaining, Deliverance, Pure Wisdom, Enlightened Understanding). Third: five powers of spiritual awakening operating through successive degrees. Fourth: five essential states of spiritual instruction — peace, silence, the day, and others whose names are partially lost. Some passages are fragmentary but the teaching sequence is coherent.

What are the [fourteen great aeons] of light?

The [gods of light] below abide in fourteen [great aeons of light]: the five elements, the sons of Lord Wisdom, together with the call and the hearing. They anoint them, living in them. These shall make seven, five plus two.

[Also the five sons] of the Lord of Covenants who [support] all [the weight] of the universe; together with [the Lord of Covenants] and [Lord Wisdom], their fathers. [These also are seven] by which the universe is established.

[There are fourteen] aeons of light [that abide within the land] that is not revealed. This land [in which all the aeons abide is made firm and is established]. They bore up under the enemy [and they were not overcome for no one of the darkness equals] them. The hidden plenitude that [abides in] the Envoy who came from the Father, the [great luminary] He came and stood firm in the midst of these [aeons of light]: he is called the good father of [all] the [aeons and gods] who are holy and conjoined. He has become leader and a great king after the likeness of the first Father, the lord of all these [counsels]. This universe is held together by their will [from the beginning] to the end of all things.

The beginning of every good grace is the great Father of the [lights]; since [all graces] are given by his hand.

The beginning of each blessing and every prayer is [the Bounteous Spirit], the first Bounteous Spirit.

Also, [the] beginning [of] every good [counsel] is [the Envoy], the king of the glorious realm that lies in this [world], [the image] of the King of the lights.

The beginning of [all glory and] each [honour] (?) is the King of Radiance, who is [honoured.].

The beginning of all [the trappers] and hunters is [Lord Wisdom].

[The beginning] of all fighters is [the Lord of Covenants], the Lord of Covenants, who has [distributed about] his five sons from place to place.

The beginning of all the [architects] and builders is the Dawn, who is glorious.

Also, the first of all the porters of the [greatness] is Hearkening [Hearkening ...].

The beginning of [all] the deliverers [is the Kingdom of Wisdom]; or the one who delivers, as he frees whoever belongs [to him] from his words.

The beginning of every wisdom of truth is the Maiden, [.].

The beginning of all [the greatest] honoured ones [and of all knowledge] is the Good Mind; who is the [awakener of they] who sleep, the gatherer in of the ones who are [scattered].

[The first resurrector is the Lord of Covenants, who awakens] it therein [and raises it up].

The second resurrector is [the Bounteous Spirit].

And the third resurrector is the Father, [Lord Wisdom], because by his word shall all lives [arise and] gather in and go to him, and they receive [life] and rest.

The fourth resurrector is the Good Mind, because [it awakens the soul from forgetfulness].

The fifth resurrector to the good [souls] is the Father, the First established one [from the beginning]. [He encompasses] all the powers, and he stands firm [over all things]. He shall unveil the [image] over them [in that day], and he draws them to him [by his love], his will [and his mercy], and he [purifies] them, and he stands them up [in his light] there, and they remain until [the end of all things].

The five [lessons] that [are] proclaimed in the [world], [one] being [called by name] 'the peace', another called ['the] silence', [and] another 'the day', [another ...].

[As for] the gatherer in [... ...] then he shall [cause] the body [to cease from] all the lusts of the world [and the deeds] of the body in righteousness [This] is [Hearkening] through which the light ascends] because [it bears all things] up to the [land of light].

The one they call ['the peace'] it is [Lord Wisdom] who [dwells in] the ship of living waters [of the] light [and also] he is [called 'the life'] that they have [received] glorious [...].

[The one they call] it 'day' [of the] universe as they shall [find rest] in the great aeon [The lights that] are spread in the universe, it is [the light] established in the [aeon of light] and the [souls that dwell therein].

Part 4

The Drama of Redemption

The teaching turns from structure to narrative: how evil propagated through five stages from its origin to manifestation, and how five degrees of divine operation overcame it. Five parables then illustrate the distinct character of each divine advent — Lord Wisdom as a noble son among enemies, the Lord of Covenants as a severe judge, the Envoy as a king inspecting his works, the Kingdom of Wisdom as one sent to uproot a bad garden, and the counsel of life as clarified butter placed in hot milk. Three great spiritual epochs are established: the descent of celestial love into the hells, the ordering of all spiritual states, and the separation of wisdom from falsity culminating in the final consummation. Five wars and five corresponding liberations complete the dramatic arc.

The Propagation of Evil and the Five Greatnesses

Primary Teaching

Two complementary teachings. First, how spiritual death propagated through five stages: stirring what was latent in the natural mind; welling up through five genera (obscurity, self-love, false persuasion, falsity, absence of truth); being given fixed form in interior states; producing evil works through five perverted perceptions; extending itself into ten aspects (five of will, five of understanding) conjoined through self-love. Twelve complete aspects of evil arose against the Divine Humanity. Second: five degrees of divine operation overcame this evil — the Divine Itself in infinite peace, four proceeding degrees (the celestial human with five faculties, divine ordering truth with five capacities, divine providence with the sustaining pillar, and divine illuminating wisdom with all its powers) — distributed in fives and completing a total of twelve.

The two essences [of Light and Darkness] Did Death arise and stand firm [...] up? Or else did it turn itself from [...] its armour [...] in its [...] but it finished [mixing] the two [essences].

[...] It moved it and [aroused] they that are in the [depths] of the earth of Darkness [this is the] first part.

Yet, after a long time, as there was not [rest], it gushed and streamed up [...] the five elements of Death that gushed [forth] which are smoke, fire, wind, water and darkness [...] the second time [...] they were sculpted [into] those in which Death was established [this is the third part].

The fourth part is the evil fruits [that are] in the five trees that are in the five worlds of the land of Darkness.

The fifth time it spread itself out to its creatures that exist in the five worlds; the ones that were formed and generated from the five fruits of Death. They are the five worlds of flesh, the five creations of Darkness in which Death has been established. It spread itself out to ten parts, five male parts and five female [parts].

Now, like the land of Darkness, in that its spirit and its [soul] they nourished the five elements [of Darkness]; this is also [how] the ten parts that are in male and female, the fire and lust of the flesh [bound] them, as they yoke them with one another [until] they were established against Lord Wisdom. This is [the condemnation] of the Darkness, it was condemned for ever.

Alongside the mystery of these twelve parts that came about in the Darkness [and were established] against Lord Wisdom. The twelve [parts are] the twelve spirits of error that came about from the twelve signs of the zodiac [...].

[...] The Darkness, it was defeated by five greatnesses.

The first greatness is Boundless Time who exists in calm and hiddenness; as he is established in his light-earth, in his own essence.

Four greatnesses were manifested and came forth of him. They were appointed to ten parts, and established in total twelve.

The second greatness poured out and was manifested. It was revealed from the first greatness. It is the Bounteous Spirit, the Great Spirit, together with Lord Wisdom and his five sons; these are the second greatness.

The third greatness is the King of Radiance, the Dawn, the Lord of Covenants, and the five sons of the Lord of Covenants. These are the third greatness.

The fourth greatness is the Envoy, and Hearkening, and all the light powers who were revealed from him. These are the fourth greatness.

The fifth greatness who came from the Father is the Kingdom of Wisdom, and all his powers whom he summoned, his emanations who were [revealed from him] They poured out and were manifested from him.

This is, so that they were spread out and [established in] fives: these five [sons] of Lord Wisdom [who support] the entire building; another five are the five sons of the Lord of Covenants who are spread out to five places, supporting [all things].

[...] Total in twelve parts that [... There are] another two added to them who are the summons and the obedience. They are the father and the mother whom the Kingdom of Wisdom by his advent has appointed as successors to his place [over] the great earth and the [light] in them.

The Five Advents

Primary Teaching

Five extended parables illustrating the distinct character of each divine descent. Lord Wisdom's advent is like a noble son surrounded by enemies, prevailing through humility and patient stillness. The Lord of Covenants's advent is like a severe judge sent to overturn violence — binding, inverting, and ordering the rulers according to righteous judgment. The Envoy's advent is like a great king inspecting his completed works and affirming the justice of what has been done. The Kingdom of Wisdom's advent is like one sent to uproot a bad garden and plant the tree of life. The counsel of life is like clarified butter placed in hot milk — working silently from within to separate and gather what is good while discarding impurity. Each parable reveals a different mode of divine operation.

[The advent also] of Lord Wisdom who came [is like a man] belonging to [his father] existing in a kingdom [of great] esteem before they who belong to his household [...] his enemies [surrounded him] and suffering by their wickedness; and they take from him [his glory] and a richness; and they imprison [him in] captivity and take from him their companies (?). Yet, he [prevailed] by his humility; and he takes heart and restrains his enemy [...] in silence.

Just as with this man, this noble son whose enemies surround him, this also is how the advent of Lord Wisdom happened, [among the] rulers, the enemies of the light.

In contrast, the advent of the Lord of Covenants and the commandment that he received, whereby he came upon all the rulers, it differs from that of Lord Wisdom. His advent [is not like] the advent of Lord Wisdom.

The advent of the Lord of Covenants is like this, when he was sent from the greatness that he might bring up Lord Wisdom. He resembles a judge the king would send to overturn the violence to that man, the noble son against whom his enemies sinned. And he, this judge, [he is] hard and cruel [...] and he gives the means [to that man] by his righteousness and his strength; and he also judges all who are condemned according to their rebellious heart, and repays each according to his deserts. They who are worthy of blows he strikes with hard leather whips. Again, these who are worthy of cutting off their limbs, or indeed their [heads] and he repays them accordingly. [...] and he binds and fetters them, and hangs by [their feet] and thus he does to them with a righteous judgement. And he kills them to flay their skin [from them] so that they will be killed by a death [...] until they die. Again, [they for] whom it is fitting [...] to banish from their dwellings he may remove according to a righteous judgement; just as they had faulted and sinned against the noble son.

Also, the associates in the mystery and the assistants of this judge, these who belong to him in great strength; in an instant and haste they shall do the will of their master.

Now, just as this genuine judge, who was sent from the king to overturn the violence to this man, the noble son: this is also the case with the Lord of Covenants. He also was sent from the King of the lights to overturn the vengeance and violence to Lord Wisdom, against whom the Evil Spirit had sinned. He faulted and sinned against him, and also his rebellious powers. Therefore, when (the Lord of Covenants) came, he bore up Lord Wisdom.

Also, all the rulers, the powers of sin who had faulted and sinned against the sons of Lord Wisdom, he has judged them according to a righteous judgement. He has bound them in heaven and earth. He put each one to the place fitting for him; he weighed each of them according to his cruelty and oppression. While some of them he enclosed in the prison, others he hung head down. Some [of them] are bound and spread, others are sat down all the time. Some among them are fixed beneath their associates, restricted

by a strong chain; others he made the holders of authority over their companions beneath, so that they may do their pleasure amongst these below them.

When the Lord of Covenants established the judgements [upon them] He was revealed to all the powers of Darkness. He judged them as a true giver of judgement [...] This is the first judgement that the Lord of Covenants gave the rulers [in respect of [Lord Wisdom]. Indeed, he gave victory to Lord Wisdom corresponding to his victory; but he condemned the Evil Spirit corresponding to that by which he had erred.

[...] This chain, of this sort, became [fixed in] the earth till the end time when the universe will be dissolved; and it perishes in the great fire and is separated. While the light goes to its country, the Darkness remains in the chain and fetter for ever.

The advent also of the Envoy, when he came to inspect they who are imprisoned in the zone: he is like a great king who comes and inspects craftsmen [...] and [architects] and [artisans].

Also, they who are good, of the craftsmen and architects and artisans whom he has there in each place: he shall see that they have worked well, and have fallen to his works in their fashion. He shall rejoice with great joy [over them] He shall thank the artisans who have constructed his works [and completed] his orders.

Now, just as this great king who comes and inspects his works and fortifications, so also is the advent of the Envoy. For, when he too came, he saw [his works] established and prepared and [also the] series of the rulers prepared and established there, above and below, outside and within, in the great pattern that his brothers had made. They had come before him to the contest, they who had fixed and created the universe before he came. He saw the gods and the angels established and controlling the fortifications [...] guarding the entire ruling-power [...] which his first powers had done. They are Lord Wisdom and the Lord of Covenants and the Great Spirit, the Bounteous Spirit.

Therefore, when he saw them, that they had created everything with great wisdom, [...] as they looked he plundered (?) [...] in his advent, by which he came, he was unveiled to them. He says to the Lord of Covenants: "The judgement that you have [given is] good, what you uttered [is just] you gave to them correspondingly; so that they were moved and raised up to that of which they were not worthy".

The advent also of the Kingdom of Wisdom, the time when he came to all [things] being just like a man if he is sent to pull out a [bad tree and] burn a difficult fig-garden with fire. Therefore, again, when he has first cut the bad trees with his axe and has pulled out [their roots] and their body with his fire, so that they should not return to sprout from this time, nor bear fruit bad to eat [any more].

Afterwards, he also planted good plants: the tree of life that will make good fruit.

Again, this is like this simile of the advent of the Kingdom of Wisdom. It happened like this; because he too set out [...] his power and his wisdom, in his [righteous]-ness [...] a king and a saviour [...] in his glorious wisdom he destroyed them. He bound and crushed them like the fire that shall burn and destroy trees. This is also how he performed his will in the zone, among the many powers, until he reached the form of the flesh of Adam and Eve, the first humans. [He perfected] his will in Eve, he [enlightened her] He also gave hope to Adam, and the proclamation [of the] glorious [kingdom] He went up to the heights [of the aeons] of light.

Then the summons and the obedience, the great counsel that came to the elements, which are set in conjunction: it mixed with them, it was established in silence. It bears up [all things] until the end time when it can arise and stand firm in the great fire. It will gather to it its own soul, and sculpt it in the Final Body. You will also find it sweeps out and casts from it the pollution that is foreign to it. However, the life and the light that are in all things it gathers in to it, and builds upon its body.

The time when this the Final Body will be perfect in all its limbs, then it can become free and ascend from that great struggle through the Lord of Covenants its father, the one who comes and brings a [...] limb. He raises it up from within this gathering (?), the melting down and destruction of all things.

Now, this counsel, that summons and obedience, resembles thus cooled butter. If a person will take and set it in hot milk, it melts down and soaks in with this hot milk. It melts in another time in silence and quiet to the midst [of the milk] yet also, of the power and the taste of this milk [...] is drawn to (the butter), and (the milk) sets and becomes cold [...] in [...] and the [...] this milk it shall clarify and discard. However, the oil and the grease and the 'beauty' of the milk it shall gather in to it.

Again, this too is what the advent of that thought is like, the counsel of life, which is the summons and obedience that came to the elements. This is the one that at the end can arise and stand firm, and will gather in to it all the lives, and the light that has remained behind in everything. It can build them upon its body; it will gather them in to it [and sculpts them] in its likeness for ever and ever [...] from this time.

Three Epochs, Five Wars, and Five Releases

Primary Teaching

The temporal structure of redemption. Three great spiritual epochs: from the descent of celestial love into the hells to its restoration; from restoration through the ordering of all spiritual states; and from the manifestation of divine truth through the final consummation and rising of the completed Divine Human. The first epoch vastly exceeds the others in spiritual depth. Five wars of the sons of light are then narrated: Lord Wisdom's ensnaring of evil with the living soul; the Lord of Covenants's judicial ordering of the heavens; the Envoy's display of the divine image and extraction of wisdom; the Kingdom of Wisdom's conquest of rebellion; and the counsel of life's final victory over death. Five corresponding liberations describe how wisdom was rescued at each stage — from Lord Wisdom's freedom through to Providence's final gathering.

From the time when the light came forth and was bound and spread in the darkness, to the season when the Final Body will ascend and the entire light, which was conjoined with the darkness, will be purified and cleansed. From that time on, from that time to the season of the end totals three seasons.

Three seasons: from the time when Lord Wisdom went down to the abyss, and waged the war and the struggle against the Evil Spirit and his other powers. He was victorious, while his sons remain behind with them in the worlds [of darkness, and they were mixed] in the [darkness] until he shall catch all of them [back and] he bound them all up, so that not one of them escaped his hand. He won a great victory [over all the powers of darkness] Lord Wisdom spent human lifetimes and generations in the land of darkness, until he prevailed [over them and] he fulfilled the will of the greatness that was commanded of him.

Then they sent the Lord of Covenants, the Lord of Covenants. He brought Lord Wisdom up from the struggle, he raised him up to the land of light. This is the first period, from the descent of Lord Wisdom to his ascent.

The second season is from the time when Lord Wisdom ascended. The Lord of Covenants came, and the Bounteous Spirit. They set in order the things of the universe, they set up [all things] the Lord of Covenants and the Mother of the living set in order [the things of] the universe, up to the moment when they go out [from it] it was reckoned to the second season.

[After] the universe [was established] the Envoy spread [his likeness] that is in the [ships of the] living; he [called the living and] he separated beauty from all the powers and scooped it up to the heights, he swept the waste to the abyss, and he [separated the light from the darkness] Now, from the moment when the Envoy revealed his likeness he purified the light. Sin spurted up towards him. He hid his likeness. Sin came [forth] from the darkness. It sculpted the trees and the abortions fell down. Afterwards they sculpted Adam and Eve in the flesh. Until the moment when the Kingdom of Wisdom was sent and he [came to Adam] as he performed there his will. He gave the hope to Adam, and ascended to the heights.

Now, from the time when the Envoy displayed his likeness until the season when the Final Body will ascend at the end, shall be reckoned to the third season.

[Nothing] lasts long in the time that Lord Wisdom spent in the world of Darkness. It is a very great count of time, more than the (other) two seasons!

The first season, which Lord Wisdom spent in the world of Darkness, is how much longer than the time that this universe has been? While it is established?

If you should say that [it exceeds the universe ten times] it is small, if you should [... ...] to him [again] and you consult [him] you will tell him: Twenty times! It is greater again in this other one that you will consult: Thirty times! Less also is this other one [... ...] people will receive the [fruit] of the trees [... ...] the years and the generations [from the] earth to the heights. This is [the first season].

This is the third period, from the time when the Envoy revealed his likeness until the Final Body will ascend from the lump. It again, that time, is greater than the intermediate; but it does not come equal to the time of Lord Wisdom. For this intermediate season, in which the Lord of Covenants and the Bounteous Spirit constructed the universe with its orders, is shorter than that of Lord Wisdom.

Great is the period of Lord Wisdom! It lasts longer than the season in which the Envoy displayed his likeness, until the dissolution of the world and the Final Body ascends. From the time too when the Envoy displayed his likeness, until the dissolution of the universe [is greater than the time] when the Lord of Covenants and the Bounteous Spirit shaped the universe.

These are the [great] three periods of time that occur.

The sons of light waged five wars against the sons of darkness. The sons of light humiliated the sons of darkness in them all.

The first war is that of the Lord Wisdom, which he waged against the Evil Spirit, and all the rulers that had come forth from the five worlds of [darkness]. He hunted them with his net, which is the living soul. He [caught them] in the snare and [revealed] the face of the [soul] his virgin, the living fire [and] they did not find how to escape his net [and] he caught them like fish [in the sea] the five counsels of the five elements [of darkness]. He cut and dug out the root of the five trees, [and the] root of the evil tree, like an axe.

The second war is that of the Lord of Covenants [...]. He has constructed the things and the worlds of light; he spread out the rulers and chained them in the middle [of the heavens and set] the stars in [the firmament and] the earths [and placed] them in the three vessels. For the rulers rebelled and were set against the Lord of Covenants. They wished to [flee] since they knew and realised that he might bind and fetter them with a strong chain. Yet he, the Lord of Covenants, (appeared to them) with many aspects, with numerous [forms], with many hands and great cruelties. He was revealed to them, he imprisoned them with much skill. Not one of them was able to save (himself), and he [bound...]. Now, since he [was wise] he trapped them [... ...].

The third war is that of the Envoy who has displayed his likeness [to what is above and to] what is below [and he] scooped [out] all light and the property [from] the ones that are consumed [by darkness] the entire ruling-power [was stripped of the] pride of the light [which was] extending it [...]. A person comes, who is powerful [over him]; he takes his riches [his gold], silver [...], his pride and wantonness.

This is what the ruling-power is like [...], all riches [...] as they travel [through the heavens, the] light [is separated from them]. He cleansed and purified it.

The fourth war is this that the Kingdom of Wisdom the glorious one waged against all the rebels who had rebelled above and below. When the light was purified from them by the image of the Envoy, their chains loosened [and they rebelled]. The glorious one in the fourth war; he came and brought [to an end] a rebellion of the entire ruling-power. He girded himself [and encompassed] all of it another time. He constructed the whole structure and he made [of it] a great contest; he humiliated therein. [And] he fulfilled the will of the greatness, [he gave the] hope to Adam [and led him] to his light ship.

The fifth war is this that the counsel of life [has waged] which is the summons and the obedience [and the] great [work] and it placed [...] upon the [...] and the [... ...] of death, which [was overcome] with it. And it was victorious over [death] for ever, and it gave the kingdom [to the sons of light].

[There are] five [releases by] which the light is saved [from] all [the rulers and] powers of Darkness!

[The first loosening] and saving is that of [Lord Wisdom], since when [Lord Wisdom] was freed [from the prison of] the rulers by the Lord of Covenants, who had come [to the aid] of Lord Wisdom, much light and [much] power was saved from the entire ruling-power. They ascended with Lord Wisdom to the aeons [of greatness]. This [is the first] release.

The second saving is that of [the Lord of Covenants], since [when] the Lord of Covenants and [the Bounteous Spirit] constructed [the ten firmaments] and [worlds of worlds], the earths and their [rulers; immeasurable] light was saved [from] them [that of [Lord Wisdom], who [was] devoured [and the light was consumed by them].

[... ...] Three wars [... ...] to the time when he [... ...] above [all of] them upon the [... ...] universe.

[The third redemption] is that of [the Envoy], since when he] displayed [his likeness to them] he [... ... the ruling]-power; he [... ... ...] from them [... ...] So this is [how] the [saving through] his likeness that [was revealed] in [the Envoy].

[The] fourth [saving] is that of the Kingdom of Wisdom, since [when he was revealed] in the zone he displayed [his likeness] in front of the firmaments and purified [the light] that is above. He took the likeness [of them and] he made himself like the angels in [the heavens until] he travelled and descended to the form of flesh. He set in order [the] earths and all the fastenings. He also [loosened and saved the] light without measure in the entire structure. He gave [the] summons and the obedience to the elements, he formed [the Living Word]. He [ascended] and rested himself in the light [land].

The fifth release and saving is that of the great counsel, [which is the summons and] the obedience, since it also [saves] the soul from the [land] of greatness.

[...] The Lord of Covenants [...] as he gave [...] the release [... ...] The first [... ... he] ascended and he [... ...] as he [... ...] wisdom [... ...] The fourth [... ...] its wisdom [to those below] And also, the fifth [... ...] into it, and it sets it in order [and forms] its light image in this the Final Body.

These five [great powers of saving] were revealed. They came to a profit [... ...] they were established upon [... ...] Lord Wisdom [was freed] when he came toward [the light] from the struggle. He set in order and constructed [the entire] universe [... ... Lord Wisdom] was saved through] his advent.

In [this] way [...] they [stand] with [one another].

[...] Because of the light [that] had rushed from [... ... the Envoy].

The [counsel] of life, which is the [summons] and the obedience, will make [... ...] seal the commandment and the [mission] of all [the Sent Ones]. In this last season they [complete the] life of [the Final Body] and] he judges the [souls, so that he] can send [... ...] powers, they [are separated] from the [powers of Darkness, and] it is alive [by the power] of the will [of the great] Father, the [established one and all] powerful; they [go forth against the] enemy, they [overcome] all of them [and they] conquer this land that they have [dwelt and purified] in it for ever [... ... they] came [from him] in the beginning, as [they will return] again to the light. They [ascend] to him at the [last].

Part 5

The Infinite Divine and the Two Essences

A contemplative turn: the teaching meditates upon the infinite interior reality of the Divine — its five essential faculties, twelve modes of omniscience, and fivefold emanation into all heavenly spheres. Then the eternality and mutual exclusion of the two fundamental natures (good and evil) is established: each exists in its own domain, evil is inscrutable even to itself, and Lord Wisdom descended to prevent evil's invasion of the kingdom of life. Finally, immeasurable durations are contemplated — the time the Divine Wisdom spent within Divine Love before proceeding, the durations of the Celestial Human's preparation, and the stages of evil's unfolding — all beyond finite reckoning. Five emanations from five faculties of the Father summarize how each originating principle corresponds to a distinct interior capacity.

Boundless Time and the Land of Light

Primary Teaching

Contemplative teachings on the infinite interior reality of the Divine. The Divine Love is called the origin of all fullness because it is the infinite ground of good from which the essence of wisdom encompasses all celestial goods, intelligences of truth, and states of reception. Three distinct fullnesses manifest one Divine source: the infinite ground of good, the containing form of divine love, and the containing form of divine truth. The Divine subsists in five essential faculties (intelligence, thought, perception, providence, reflection) unfolding into twelve complete modes of omniscience. Five emanations pour forth: illuminating wisdom, the sphere of celestial good, proceeding truth as the living Word, blessedness, and the manifest presence of divine delight sealed as a living form within each receiving vessel. Some passages are highly fragmentary but the teaching structure is preserved.

Boundless Time, as he is named; due to what reason is he given the name 'Boundless Time'?

The Father, who is the first established thing, shall be called 'Boundless Time'. His greatness is the great earth where he lives, he being established in it [and from it comes] the essence of the light that swathes all the rich gods and the angels and the dwellings [in which they dwell] is set over it.

Furthermore, they shall call the Envoy 'father'. His greatness is the light ship of living fire wherein he lives, he being established in it.

Once again, the Kingdom of Wisdom shall himself also be called 'father'. His greatness is the ship of living waters where he lives, he being established in it.

Very great is [land of] light [that exists] due to the first Boundless Time. How he [exists and is] established in his five light limbs, which are [calledhouses] that have neither limit nor measure to [them. They are] mind, thought, teaching, counsel and [consideration, and] his twelve light limbs that are his twelve wisdoms.

Now, there are five great light [limbs] in each one [and from each] five [great] springs of praise gush [forth, and] five great [emanations of light shine forth from them].

The first is his light that [enlightens all things] it gushed forth from him and [poured into al] aeons.

The second is the perfume of the [Father, which gushes from him] and pervades all the aeons of greatness.

The third is his living voice of [power, which resounds throughout] all his aeons [and fills them].

The fourth is his [sweet]-ness [that] gushes forth from him [throughout all the aeons].

The [fifth] is his great [glorious image] that [joyhich has been manifested] all the [time], [which continues in] all of them. It was sculpted in them [as a form] sealed in the [m, and] sealed [as a living image] as they send [forth their praise] in [... ...] they too receive nourishment [from him] immediately [through] living [voice, they are filled with] joy [and they are] set up anew. It shall gush forth from it [unceasingly, and] they shall [receive] and become rich in the [fullness of light. This] too is beautiful [in the living portrayal of the Father, the] adornment [of the aeons] and they live [in the joy of the light] for [ever].

[... / ...] The Land of Light.

[He dwells] in the great land of greatness [which is] above.

[Hisace] is [... / ...] living [... / from ... / ...] upon him.

[His] light and [... / ...] face [shines] out; he has [theace] of the [Father] in the [...] now [five words] of [praise ... / ...] in the [...] living [ambrosia and the] five [elements] compound [and] they become an image [and] the [living] air [is] also living.

[As] those five shall [come forth] from all the contests of the greatness [...] and a beautiful [form] to the limbs of their body [... which] exists [in] the land of light; their [life].

Just as all the gods and the rich ones and the [angels who] were summoned came from the Father, so also all [the mountains and] springs and trees [that] gush forth [from it] great is a [...] every thing that you [... / ...] neither water nor [fire].

These [are the things] which [... / ...].

The [fif]-th [is the] great light, the living air [... / ...] in which the aeons of greatness dwell, being established therein. [... / ... angels] that [...] and the [... / ... gifts] of the great Father [... / ...] in the [...].

The Two Essences and Lord Wisdom's Preparation

Primary Teaching

The eternality and mutual exclusion of the two fundamental natures: the inmost being of divine wisdom transcends every finite understanding; the domain of evil perpetuates itself through the opposition of its own disorderly loves. Evil possessed no self-reflective intelligence regarding its own origin, yet the lust of self-love was stirred and turned upward against the kingdom of life. The Lord in His Divine Rational descended to meet the assault, and by that descent good became intermingled with evil, truth with falsity. Evil consolidated itself into a form harder than any opposing force. The Divine, perceiving the assault, transformed His own proceeding to engage evil on its own ground. Lord Wisdom drew near to His exterior truths, communed with them, and clothed them one upon another over His divine faculties in preparation for combat.

[... ... ...] Essence in [it ou ... ...] is the land of [... ...] and [is] their last.

What the essence of [light]—no person could recount or unveil [or say how it] exists [from ever for ever and ever]—all [...] and [...] unveil [... ...] eternity [...] great [...] again and the [...] tend [to] the beginning of eternity and the end [...] set that one down.

The land of death [... ...] nature of the essence [... ...] which exists [from ever for ever] and ever [dwelling] in [strife] with one another.

As for the eternity of [the darkness] which exists from ever, no person is able to [understand] how they exist. For no other power [is manifested] to them, in that it might speak or recount about their origin, how [they exist]. However, from the time when it stirred itself and rose up against the light [... ...] it might come and rule over the land of the living.

[Lord Wisdom] came forth against it and prevented it, [he kept] it apart from the house of the living. He prevented it. From that time, when the light was mixed with [the] darkness, and life [with] death, the light [was] entwined with the darkness, [and] life in death.

[For after it] stirred itself in its essence, its [thought arose] in its own land. It [... ...] the entire land of darkness in its [... ...] of light in the abyss. For [the] essence in [it ... ...] because a [...] they reckoned [... ...] on its side [is] this first nature [of] it, because its body is made strong [far more] than the Adamant [and] every [thing] as it exists [in the universe].

[...] Of death [... ...] envy, which [fills] the land of [darkness ... consideration] in [its] wickedness [...] for as it [...] the wounds [...] against this land [...].

Then he will run [forth from] the land [of] darkness. It drew [down] his members [...] is deep [... ...] in them.

[...] Every [...] It spread itself out. It generated itself [of the five dark elements]; which [are] smoke, fire, wind, water and Darkness. [... ...] sprouted trees. It came up [... ...] it formed its own self in the [depths] it generated its own self with its birth [in] numerous [emanations], not resembling each other; [in] the storehouses of its abyss, many [dark] creatures [...] destroyers and dragons and evil beasts. It was established and [spread] and grew strong [...] in the ugly forms of those in the Darkness [...] dark, and by the [great] impetuosity, by their wickedness and hatred they slaughter [and devour] each other as they war with one another.

Then the counsel of their ruler humbled its world and its powers. It sensed the essence of the [light that is above it] It conspired to wage a war [...] with the exalted kingdom and the [light].

However, he, [Boundless Time] ... ...] it also knew [of the] war, to disturb the [land of] light [but] in the wisdom of his [great]-ness [...] he transformed himself against it [... ...] against it.

Indeed, at that time [... ... ...] go against [...] God [...].

[And from] its [essence] poured it out [...] in the elements: in the smoke, the fire, the wind, the water and the Darkness. It came up from the [great] depth, it being set in the trees [... ...] against it.

Also, at the time when it generated itself [and] it formed the fruits, it still being set in them. They summoned the five garments, the sons of [Lord Wisdom].

And at the time when it generated its own self [from] the fruits through its offspring, they fell upon the earth and [drew] strength from the elements and were nourished by them. [... ...] wickedness, together with cruelty [dwell] in the ruler, the leader of all the demons. He [humbled] his worlds and his powers; he gathered them all into him. He made himself ready for the battle; he set himself to the war with that light earth, and the great King who dwells in it.

At that very moment Lord Wisdom approached his garments, the gods [who shine] forth. He spoke with them, that he might entrust to them a [mystery] he [revealed] to them and taught them about everything that [would come upon] them. He assumed them. He arranged them [... ...] He draped them over one another upon his limbs [... ...] danger, it [... ...] the heights of the earth [... ...] with all its powers [from the beginning], it being immeasurable [... ...].

Immeasurable Durations and the Five Emanations

Primary Teaching

The infinite states contained within the Divine before any proceeding: the Divine Wisdom spent an immeasurable duration within the Divine Love before being summoned into active existence; the Celestial Human dwelt within the Divine Truth of Life; the five divine faculties existed within their origin through the entire span from the descent into combat to the rising of the completed Divine Human. Correspondingly, evil unfolded through its own stages — from fundamental constituents to perceptions to works to manifested evil affections. Five and then six great spiritual states are enumerated: initial combat, ordering, duration, dissolution, formation of the final divine human, and the whole from evil's first stirring to its final binding — which admits no finite measure. The five emanations from five faculties of the Father summarize how each originating principle proceeds from a distinct interior capacity.

[...] A great [judgement,] now also a [time came] that they [sculpted him, and] he was revealed in the Father, the first established thing.

[When he gave] the two summonses that he called [forth to] the Bounteous Spirit [she spent] a long duration in the first [Boundless Time].

For someone, if he might set a measure and rule [to] the earth particles and the pebbles of the mountains and [the sands] of the sea and the body of the firmaments. Should they be poured [into] the body of the four mountains and the three vessels that surround the universe; if they shall all be poured out [as] these fine granules.

The grains of the earth particles are measurable, [and those of] the [entire] universe. It is possible to count the particles of the earth each year [and] the sand grains of the entire universe; but the duration of the time that the Great Spirit spent in the Father, [the] first established thing, one will not be able to make a count of it!

He first sculpted her like this. He established her in his inner storehouses in quiet and silence. When [they had] need of her she was called and came forth of [Boundless Time]. She looked at all her aeons of light!

Once again, from the time when she was called to [come forth and] go to [...] she gave [her power] upon his [body and] all the aeons [of light]; she also [examined] all of them. This [is also the case] with Lord Wisdom.

This is how the Man spent a long time being anointed in the Mother, set fast in her inner storehouses [in quiet and silence]; from when Lord Wisdom went down to the contest, till the time when [the Final Body] (?) comes into being,] this time [in which] he appeared [...].

Again, from when he was called and came forth, till the time when he [himself] called the five shining [gods] who are his sons; they themselves also spent a long time existing in their father! It is the time that occurred from the coming down of Lord Wisdom till the going up of the Final Body. The five gods spent this much duration being anointed in Lord Wisdom. Yet, [at the] time when they were awaited, they were called and came forth.

At the time when the Bounteous Spirit was called from Boundless Time, when she expelled herself and came down by her own wish, from the heights of the Father to the earth, [she would spend thousands of] years and many ten thousands until she reached the earth. [For] there is no measure nor rule to the heights of the Father. Rather, [just as] he had called her in his Great Spirit, so he set her upon [the] land of greatness through one of these three that are counted to the twelve hidden ones within the light veil,

the ones [established] after the [...] region of the south.

[The] matter of [the Bounteous Spirit] is like this. When [the Father called her he established her in the place he pleased,] to establish her there as the instruction of the people that [are] many [...]; and she examined everywhere that [...] a blink of an eye, or like a [swift] bird [...].

This also is [like that of [the Bounteous Spirit] in [...] whenever [...] cast her out [...] upon her to the place [...] him. He perfected her in his Great Spirit and set her in [the place he pleased], according to [his will].

[This also is how] they called the [five gods] from [Lord Wisdom]. They were set before him, as he wished that [...]-ness [...] down, that they would rule in them [...] one another. He ordered and distributed them [...] the son. He stripped himself of them [...] and he [...] he girt and bound himself to [...] in a [place] of silence upon the border of the earth [...].

Again, he too, Lord Wisdom, spent a long period and [time] until he gave power to his sons; until he [assumed] them. After he came to wear them he stood fast in the heights between the borders. Again, he spent a duration and time like this, corresponding to such amount and measure as the raindrops and dew and falls of mist that come down in the universe. This is how he spent this duration also, standing between the borders, until the hour when he cast himself down to the contest!

Whenever [Boundless Time] called the Great Spirit and Lord Wisdom and the gods of the glorious one, who are provided to enable them to reveal him; at that very time [he] sculpted the Dawn in the [land of] light, [and] the Lord of Covenants with the mighty and active gods who came [from] him. Also, at that time, he sculpted [the Envoy], with the Kingdom of Wisdom and the Maiden and Hearkening, and the gods who came from them. [All these Boundless Time sculpted at] a single time. They came forth of one another, one after one; the time when [...] and the work.

[...] From the time when the Darkness raised itself up to [...] essence of the light [...] these three emanations [that came forth] from the will of the Father against the enemy [...] he has [... Darkness ...] according to the will [...] the universe [...] in it [...] separate out [...] rest him in which way, and he rejoices [...] in his kingdom; until [the time when the face] of the Father will be unveiled over [all] the gods of glory, and all the rich ones of [...] the [emanations] who came forth against the enemy.

[From] that time when he sculpted these three [emanations,] till the time when the Father would unveil his face, [and they] go in to his hidden storehouses, and he calls them [and] establishes each one of them to his place. There is no measure nor rule to this period until that time.

What has happened and what will happen; but before [the time when] they are sculpted in heaven there is no possibility [for anyone] to proclaim about this beginning, because [it exists] for ever.

The time when all the fathers of light [go in to the hidden] (places) of the Father, and dwell [with] power in them to its [...] of God [...]; because it exists for ever. It is continuous till the aeons. It has no time to the end; but their establishment [is] eternal is their life [endures] generation by generation.

[If] a person shall ask [about this beginning] and about that eternal end [...] in the devastation [...].

This Greed, this thought of Death [that] came up to its storehouses. It has [been established] in its five elements.

Again, it also [is great,] the period and the time that it spent, until it revealed itself to its elements, before it came to the trees. It spent a great period and a long time established [in them] before it came up to the trees. It was [dwelling] in the trees. It spent a long time and duration [...] existing in them, before it sculpted the [fruits ...] and sculpted the fruits.

Again, it spent a long [time] in the fruits. Not little is the period and the time that it spent existing in the fruits, before it sculpted [them,] after a long time [it fashioned] the [demons] of its five worlds in

various forms [can not] be measured [...] in [perfection] of the fruits in the demons and fiends. They fell upon their earth and [they] were nourished. Not little is the period that they [spent in the worlds], until they were nourished amongst [...] to make [war upon] that land which shines, and the great [King] who dwells there.

[Again,] at the time when he [stirred] its essence. It assumed [all of] Greed [and came] to the war [against] Hearkening. [From the time] when the war occurred [...].

[The first is the war, when] he came to be in some [mixture] when they ensnared a [...].

[The second is the building] that he built [and] the universe was established. The zone [came] down until the time when it will be dissolved.

The third is the [duration of] things and the universe will [endure] from the time when they were established there, till the time when their end will be complete and their existence ceases [...].

[The fourth is the dissolution when they will dissolve the universe] there, and all things are destroyed. Obliteration reaches them in that great fire, [which will] burn them for fourteen hundred and sixty-eight years.

[The fifth] is the way that the Final Body will be sculpted [from] the remnant of all things. The light separates out to its place, and goes up and rules in its kingdom. However, [the Darkness goes down,] and they take it in to the tomb [...] and they are bound with it in an eternal chain.

Now, from [the time] when this first war occurred, till the time of this chain [...] these five things [of the] light.

[The sixth]: From the time when it stirred and raised itself up in its land, till the time of its chaining [in the lump] However, before [...] from it out of the powers [...] and measure it; because it is eternal.

[From the time] when it will be taken in to the chaining and bound in the lump [...] to give to it. No person is able [to measure it].

Chaining is eternal [in the lump of death forever].

[The Envoy] came] from his mind; the King of Radiance [from his thought]; the Bounteous Spirit from his teaching; [the Kingdom of Wisdom] King of Radiance from his counsel; [the Maiden] from] his consideration.

So in this way were [summoned these five] fathers. These five advents came from the five limbs [of the Father]. One came from another and was manifested in its season.

Part 6

The Adversary and the Principles of Judgment

Attention turns to a thorough understanding of evil and the principles by which it is judged. Similes illuminate the nature of the Divine Human descending into combat, while the Evil Spirit is fully anatomized: five genera of evil (dominion, predatory rationality, demonic action, falsification, base knowing), five properties (absence of wisdom, spiritual putrefaction, deformity, torment, consuming self-love), and further capacities for concealment, imperviousness, and limited perception. Twelve sovereign principles of divine discernment are then enumerated — from the Primal Good through to Divine Providence itself — followed by eighteen governing principles of authority distributed across nine interior heavenly states and nine within the intermediate sphere of spiritual conflict.

The Anatomy of the Evil Spirit

Primary Teaching

First, similes illuminate Lord Wisdom's nature: a distinguished man pursuing stolen treasure, a father seeking two seized sons, a great ship-and-spear, a combatant redeeming a captive prince, an exalted good recovering spiritual riches from bondage. Then the sovereign falsity is anatomized: five genera of evil corresponding to five infernal origins (dominion from self-love, evil affections, predatory rationality, sensual reasoning, perverted natural knowledge). Five modes of action corresponding to these genera are described. Three further capacities: concealment through persuasive falsities, imperviousness to truth (formed from the obstinate purpose of the natural-sensual mind), and limited perception that knows only what is immediately present. Three additional qualities: the capacity to blaze with self-love, to freeze all charity, and to perceive subordinate evils only externally. No genuine spiritual life exists in it.

[Lord Wisdom] is like a great distinguished man whose treasure has been taken away from him. He came to pursue his treasure. This is how [Lord Wisdom] too came after his sons from the heights, so that he might redeem them and retrieve his treasure, which had been scattered amongst his enemies.

[He is like a man] whose two sons were taken away from him by [the enemy. He] came out toward them to redeem them. This is how Lord Wisdom [yearns and] shines in the heights because of his two sons, who were separated from him. They are his living soul that exist in two powers, which makes four.

The ship [of the day] is like a great spear [that is cast against the darkness. The Great Spirit too, which is in it, is like a wisecraftsman] who might beautify and set aright [all] the armour for war.

The Lord of Covenants is like a combatant who might go towards a king's son who has been taken prisoner of war, and he redeems him from the hands of his enemies.

[The Envoy] too is like a great man [who goes forth] because of the treasure [in the] hand of his prisoners [so as to redeem] these light powers [and to bring them together with the] sons and their soul, so that they would [be set free, and that the soul might] be brought forth in the land wherein it was imprisoned.

Five forms exist in his body, corresponding to (the archetype) of the five creations that exist in the five worlds of darkness.

Indeed, his head is lion-faced, which came about from the world of fire. His wings and his shoulders are eagle-faced, after the likeness of the children of the wind. His hands and his feet are daemons, after the likeness of the children of the world of smoke. His belly is dragon-faced, after the likeness of the world of darkness. His tail is the form of the fish, which belongs to the world of the children of water. These five shapes are in him, and they came from the five creations of the five worlds of darkness.

Should he wish, he shall walk on his two feet [like the children of the] world of smoke. Also, when he wants, he shall [go upon all] four [limbs] on his hands and feet [together] like the children of fire. Should he wish, he shall rise up on his wings, like the children of the wind. Also, should he wish, he shall plunge down to the waters like the children of water. Again, should he wish, he shall crawl on his belly like the children of darkness. These five shapes are in him.

Also, there are three other (qualities) in him.

The first: [he commands] his powers [and they obey him].

The second: Shall a [power oppose him, he has] his magic arts. When he wishes, he shall make an invocation over himself, and hide from his powers. When he wants, he shall show himself to them and

strike a death-blow by his magic arts. Any word he might utter at that moment, he shall [wreak magic] by it.

The third: His body is strong, [and the] nails and claws of his powers are not able to penetrate it. No iron nor copper body will equal him [in strength]; they will not be able to destroy him, because he was formed and fashioned from the hard-hearted counsel of Greed, the mother of demons and fiends.

Again, there are three others in him.

When he wants, his fire shall {blaze), and his entire body be made like the [furnace of] fire.

Also, when he wishes, he shall send out frost, and his entire body freezes like a [mountain of] snow.

The third: Whenever his powers are stood before him, he shall look at them and understand; for [whatever exists] in their heart he shall understand, what is in their heart and their face so long as they are stood before him. When they retreat before him and distance themselves from him, he shall not understand what is in their heart. There is no life in him whatsoever, but his 'life' is the bile of anger that is apparent on his face and in his fear. Shall a [power behold him, it is] destruction that is [established before] him.

Twelve Judges

Primary Teaching

Twelve sovereign principles of divine discernment proceeding from the one supreme Discernment (Divine Love itself): the Primal Good, Divine Truth proceeding, the Divine Influx that gives life, the Great Ordering Wisdom, the Sovereignty of Divine Glory, the Third Manifestation going forth, the sustaining Column, Divine Wisdom made radiant, the Pure Affection for Truth, the Judgment operating in the intermediate state, Divine Truth entering the understanding, and Divine Providence as the twelfth — making the final separation between good and evil and forming the completed image of the regenerated human. Each principle judges according to a distinct spiritual function.

Twelve judges exist; the great mighty givers of judgement! They were sent and came from the exalted greatness to this place. They were assigned to different works according to the command that Justice, who belongs to the greatness, entrusted to all these judges. Now he, Justice, he who transcends all the judges, who exists and is established in the aeons of greatness; he is Boundless Time.

The first judge is Lord Wisdom, he who humiliated the ruler of Darkness in the beginning. He judged him according to a judgement of righteousness; for he had exalted himself against a kingdom that was not his own.

The second judge is the Lord of Covenants, he who came and bore up the Man. He too made a judgement on all the powers of Darkness; which had wounded the garments of Lord Wisdom.

The third judge is the Bounteous Spirit, the Great Spirit, she who beautified and set up the heavenly part of the universe, according to her pleasure; which [pleased] her. She judged the rulers above; she fettered and set them firmly in the place that is fitting for them.

The fourth judge is the Dawn, he who built the new aeon of joy. He judged, according to a judgement of righteousness, the storehouses of the enemy; that death may not well up from this time on. He has constructed a prison for the enemy. Also, upon the crown of the building he has constructed a throne for Lord Wisdom and all the fathers of light; they who engaged the struggle with the evil one and were victorious over him.

The fifth judge is the great Lord of the Settled Lands, he who dwells and is established in the seventh firmament. He is the judge of all the firmaments who gives a true judgement, according to a judgement of righteousness, upon all the powers and all the kingdoms of the firmaments.

The sixth judge is [the Envoy], he who came and displayed his likeness. He purified the light [from the mixture] which his own [image released] also of the enemy, he has [judged them].

The seventh judge is [the Column of Glory, he who judges] the worlds [and all in them; as he gives the victory to] they who are steadfast; but he condemns the ones who are convicted [in their sin. But for the righteous] he shall become for them the steps of the way (?) [of life]; but the convicted he sweeps and casts out to the depths.

The eighth judge is the Kingdom of Wisdom, the father of all the Sent Ones; because after the Envoy had displayed his likeness and the light was taken [from them] a mass of rulers rose up from above and below. Then they sent the Kingdom of Wisdom. He came [... ...] he descended and made a judgement in the firmaments. He separated the steadfast from the convicted.

The ninth judge is the Maiden, [she who took the heart] of the powers by her likeness, gathering her own ones into her. She makes a judgement on the ruler of the moist, and the ruler of the dry.

The tenth judge is Justice who dwells in the atmosphere, judging all mankind. He makes a separation between they who are good and they who are evil, setting apart the righteous from the sinners.

The eleventh judge is the Good Mind, he who shall come and appear in the world. And he unveils [all that is hidden] and separates light from darkness, and sets the truth apart from lawlessness.

The twelfth judge is the great counsel, which is the summons and the obedience, which is appointed in the elements. It is the one that makes a separation between the good and the evil ones. At the end also it can gather itself together and sculpt its own self in the Final Body. And it separates light from darkness.

These are the twelve great and mighty judges who were sent. They came from Justice, he who transcends all the judges. He is the Father that is hidden and immeasurable, the one who exists; who is established in the aeons of greatness upon the great throne of honour, which is the Lord of the Settled Lands [who is established] in his kingdom.

Eighteen Thrones

Primary Teaching

Eighteen governing principles of authority established across eighteen degrees of spiritual life: nine in the interior heavenly states and nine in the intermediate sphere of conflict. The nine celestial thrones range from the Divine Itself (in absolute self-subsistence) through the origins of life, the most interior celestial state, the Divine Love within illumination, the Ordering Intelligence, the Operative Power, the Mediating Principle, Divine Truth in radiance, and the Divine Understanding to which all churches gather. The nine operative thrones include three in the doctrine of enlightenment, three in the doctrine that operates through obscurity, one in the highest rational degree, one in the external natural mind (judging all humanity into three paths: death, life, or mixture), and one for the apostolic function of teaching.

Eighteen [great thrones for all the fathers] exist and are appointed, which are established in eighteen places! While there are nine among them [appointed in] the outer aeons, they exist [in] all the worlds of the damage.

The first throne is the throne of the Father, the God of [truth], the King of the aeons of greatness, the one who exists; who is established [in himself] he alone, in his own [essence], [dwelling] apart. This is the first throne [of all] the one that surpasses all the thrones.

The second throne is that of the [glorious] Bounteous Spirit. She is the origin of all the emanations that have come to this world.

The third throne is constructed for the father, Lord Wisdom. He is the one who humiliated the entire first enmity, which existed in the worlds of Darkness.

The fourth throne is that of the King of Radiance, the great honoured Beloved of the aeons of greatness.

The fifth throne is that of the glorious Dawn; the great architect who built the new aeon for a newness, for [a resting place] for [the] fathers of light; also for a place of binding and a prison for the enemy and his powers.

[The sixth throne] is that of the Lord of Covenants, the [glorious] mighty one, he who bore up Lord Wisdom out from the [land of Darkness]; who also set in order and constructed the world [s ...] both for a cleansing of the light, [and] for a binding [of the] powers of the enmity.

The seventh [throne is] that of the Envoy, the king of the zone, also the master of all advices.

The eighth throne is that of the Kingdom of Wisdom, who [is] the releaser and redeemer [of] all souls.

The ninth throne is the throne of the great [Mind, he to whom] all the living assemblies shall gather; and all the [life] that will be purified from the world returns to him.

These are the nine thrones of [honour] appointed in the outer [aeons], <which are established> for the fathers of the glorious realm; [in the kingdom of the Lord of the Settled Lands].

In contrast, these are the other nine thrones that are appointed in this world of the zone.

Three thrones in the ship of [the day]: one is that of the Envoy, the second [is that of] the Great Spirit, the third is that of the Lord of Covenants.

Once again, there are another three in the ship that [belongs to the night]: the first is the throne of the Kingdom of Wisdom, [the second is that of] Lord Wisdom, the third is [that of the Maiden]. These six

thrones are established in the two ships.

Also, the seventh throne is established in the seventh firmament. The great Lord of the Settled Lands sits upon it.

The eighth throne is established in the atmosphere. The Justice sits upon it, he who judges all mankind. Three paths shall be distinguished before him: one to death, one to life, [one] to the mingling.

The ninth throne appointed and established is for [the Sent One].

[These] are the [nine] great [thrones of honour] that are established in this world of [the zone] of the glorious realm, the one that the [... ...] honour them [... ...] and the [...].

Part 7

The Ordering of the Spiritual World

The mechanics of how the spiritual world is governed and sustained. Three external truths by which the Divine operates are assumed and then removed as the work is accomplished. The manner in which divine awakening reaches the soul through its faculties is described — Lord Wisdom as ruling love, the Maiden as inmost truth, and the gathering of scattered faculties back into unity. The comprehensive labors of the Lord of Covenants (seven works) and the Envoy (ten works, then four great works) are enumerated. The wheel of Providence before the Lord of the Settled Lands — the universal ordering that constrains evil, sustains good, and governs the passage between discrete degrees — is described, together with the principle that each degree of spiritual order depends upon the degree above it.

The Three Garments and the Summons to the Soul

Primary Teaching

When the living Divine influx descended, it bore three coverings of external truth (understanding, love, truth) by which it established order through all degrees of creation. Having accomplished this, it revealed the interior Divine reality to the regenerate by removing these coverings — what had descended into the lowest natural state was elevated back to its celestial origin. The teaching then asks through which faculty the divine awakening descended into the soul: the Primordial Divine Human distributed His life into every faculty of the spiritual life, yet the awakening came by an interior and hidden way — in His own likeness, form, love, and holy truth. The soul's faculties are gathered back into unity, built like a tower of truth upon truth.

When the Lord of Covenants came he brought the three garments; that of wind, that of fire, and that of water. He assumed them from [the heights] he has [clothed himself] in them in those three garments [and through them] he established [them] for all the things of [this universe], both above and below. He arranged them in the [form in which] he was displayed. Afterwards [he completed] his works [and] the [image was revealed, ande] stripped them off before [the righteous] ones.

Now, when he was about to loose [and release them,] divested himself of them from their (clasp) and he [was no moren] them, and thus these three [garments] are arranged [and extend] from below the edges of the zone as they clothe [it all reaching] up [to what is] above [and reaching] up [to what is] above them strips them of the zone from that place at its topmost point; and it is placed below them and [raised up] to the heights above, from which it had been sent [out] at their beginning.

In which limb of [the living soul] did [the] summons descend to the Man, who exists in the [aeon]?

Indeed, Lord Wisdom dispersed himself and he [was in every] limb of the living soul [and every part] of the living soul; he has [suffered and] he did not know [... ...] but the blessed, glorious Man came [in] secret; in his likeness; in his shape; in his love; in his holy virgin, she who is the Maiden, the soul of the father.

After the fashion of this fleshly body: as the root of all the limbs hang upon the head, so that should one of the person's limbs be cut off, while the head exists he has hope for [healing] but if his head should be cut off, the entire body will die and he is lost.

This is also the case for [Lord Wisdom]. He is the head, while his sons attach to it the limbs [of] his soul. Or, conversely, like the living air, on which all flesh entirely lives as it breathes and [lives] therein. His head is placed on the body of Hearkening in the heights of the universe.

[This is] also the case [for] the father, Lord Wisdom; as he is like the head that is upon the body and the air that upon the Pillar is set [in every place] being made strong by his light virgin, [she] who is his soul that he clothes [with light].

[For there are those five]: the mind, thought, teaching, counsel and [consideration] that he produced and sent forth from [him to] do his will. He sprang and travelled behind them. [These are the limbs] of his living soul, which is entwined among the rebels; as they are like the limbs of its body, and [are spread through the] universe.

And when they were sent, at [that time] he was found with [the Maiden] and [he] stood up, asking and entreating for a [power]. [And the Father] gave him peace and a [kiss of love and] he [gave] him [good] tidings [concerning the] Man. The Man [himself] gave [his power to] his limbs and gathered his soul [into one and] he built it in its place like this tower [of light].

[And he] shaped it and beautified it skillfully [and he formed it anew and] the voices that he sent [forth that] he might sink in and quench [the fire and restore the soul] that was crushed by the enemy. They were gathered in. They came, set firm once more, in the image of their father.

The Labors of the Lord of Covenants and the Envoy

Primary Teaching

Three sets of divine operations. The Lord of Covenants's seven works: raising the celestial state from temptation, exposing self-love, subjugating the essences of spiritual death, forming vessels of wisdom, calling forth five perceptive faculties, sending forth guardian agencies, and securing the whole structure against relapse. Five constructions from the most resistant natural states: foundational ground, spanning connective truths, the mold that gives form to the hells, supporting truths throughout all states, and the fourfold enclosure protecting reception. The Envoy's ten works: building a new interior state, operating through the inmost heavens, transmitting spiritual life, ordering influx, opening reception upward, opening reception downward for refuse, exteriorizing hidden evil, distinguishing truth from falsity, precipitating malformed productions, and introducing successive changes of state. Four further great works are revealed when the Envoy displays the form of Divine Wisdom.

The Lord of Covenants has done seven [works] with his strength.

[The first]: He brought Lord Wisdom up from the contest, the way a pearl is [brought] up from the sea.

[The second: He spread about the one who had rebelled, he bound and spreadhim] in every body.

The third: He [trampled], piled up, and pierced the essences of death.

[The fourth]: He constructed the ships of light.

The [fifth]: He evoked his five sons, and distributed them about. They [took] possession of the zone, they bore up under all the universe's weight. Also, he evoked three living words. He set [them] upon the [three] vessels, another one upon the giant. [Again, he evoked the] summons, that it might be mixed with the five shining men.

The sixth: When he had constructed the zone he [arose] and [sent] forth a multitude of powers and many [angels]; so that they would bound the circuit of the [zone] on every [side], [until] he finished [constructing] the works. And at the end [of] all the [works] he [took some] of them into his storehouses, and he appointed others at the watch-posts.

The [seventh]: [At the] time when [the Envoy] displayed] his glorious [image], [the Lord of Covenants] established] many [gods] and angels. They [... They took] hold of it, that the entire building [might] not [... / ...] one another against [the] light, which he had [spread].

Also another [great] and glorious work he will enact at the [end] is [the Final Body], which he will bring up to the aeons of [light]; and he [goes] in, and [he takes] hold, and he smites [the darkness], and [he] builds, and he [...], and he [gathershem].

The Lord of Covenants constructed five great things from veins and [skulls in the] hard [bodies].

The first is the disc that is placed upon [the shoulder] of the Guardian Spirit.

The [second] are the arches of [the] pillar that is before him.

[The third] is the [mould] of the [form] for the gehennas.

The fourth are the [seven] pillars that he has erected in the great sea, in [the] seven parts of the universe.

The fifth are the four walls that surround the vessels.

The Envoy performed ten works by his advent.

The first: The Dawn came forth to build the new aeon.

The second: The ships moved through the heights in the heavens.

The third: The wheels begin to send the life to earth and the upper worlds.

The fourth: [The zodiac was set in order].

The fifth is the doors of the ships, that they were opened up [to receive the light].

The sixth is the doors too [of the depths below, that they were opened to receive the waste].

The seventh is [the sin], which he had separated from the rulers by cause of the Envoy; it fell upon the earth.

The eighth: Night and day were separated [from one another by the turning of the sphere].

The ninth: The abortions [fell] to the ground.

The tenth: Transmigrations came about in the zone.

At the time when the Envoy displayed his likeness, four great works were revealed that are very excellent and outstanding.

The first is his likeness that he displayed in a glorious image.

The second is all the doors of the firmaments that were opened at that time. They open [before him] and shut behind him.

The third is the light and the releasing that was purified by his likeness. That light is more than the light that he shall [gather].

The fourth: He has [made apparent], by the perfection of people, his light ship. He has [perfected] the living soul that shone forth in perfection and fullness over the worlds of enmity.

The Wheel of Providence and the Zones

Primary Teaching

The universal ordering of Divine Providence that stands before the Divine Good governing through truth: twelve constraining truths hold every dominant persuasion in its place; five illuminated faculties of perception interwoven throughout the boundary of external life make every state visible; the entire origin of all separated states is held captive within it. The ordering is like a great mirror for the discernment of all interior states. Each degree of spiritual order is made to depend upon the degree above it — the five genera of falsity are bound by the five genera of truth, and within the interior degree the five powers of the Divine Proceeding sustain the entire structure. The Lord of the Settled Lands governs from the inmost life of the whole creation.

The wheel that exists in front [of the Lord of the Settled Lands who dwells in] the seventh firmament [...], the root of the rulers above and below in a great and cruel fetter; as the entire will of the great Lord of the Settled Lands is placed in [it]. Also, their entire enmity, which is in the firmaments, is [bound] and ensnared in it.

It exists in a blaze of splendour [with] ornamentation and great beauty. Now, there are twelve seals in it. The seal between [is] every firmament and the rulers who are there [... ...] are in it; for should one of them wish to escape, he will be bound [by the seal]. If he should wish to cause a trick in his bond [it will be] apparent and known in [that] wheel [before him]. The spheres and stars and [the] leader of all the powers exist there, and can be known by it, in front of the Lord of the Settled Lands.

The [twelfth] seal that is in it is its five shining men that are conjoined and enmeshed through the entire zone; because every place where they are cramped, and every place where they have space, is displayed by that wheel. For the root of all the firmaments above and below, and that of their rulers, is ensnared and fixed in it.

The observation [of the wheel] is set right at all times opposite the great [Lord of the Settled Lands] ...] so that fear, [which comes from it] will assume all the powers of mixture [... ...] their root affixed there, so that they cannot make an [escape] from the fetter of their bond.

That wheel [resembles], in this respect, a chain in front of the chief guard, for when [...] in [those fetters] in the [great chain].

This is also the case for all the rulers who are in the firmaments, and every power of the zone: If they should wish to escape, they shall be recognised and revealed by that wheel. [For] the wheel is like a great mirror, for [the discrimination] of all things [that exist is] in it.

When he built and constructed the worlds, he suspended the zones on their zones, and within another zone also. The first zone is the five powers of darkness, males and females.

This is why he hung one zone on a zone! He hung the five powers of darkness on the five shining men, the sons of the Man; because all the enmity is entwined and bound in them.

Also, within the zone are the five sons of [the Lord of Covenants]; because the entire edifice is suspended from them, it being [that they also heard] (?) him too, the [others that were set] after them.

And this is the one who came to [rule over the firmaments] above [them all] which is in one zone, is the great [Lord of the Settled Lands] who [exists in his honour] within the [very midst] of the universe.

Part 8

The Good Mind and Individual Regeneration

The cosmic drama now intersects with the individual soul. Divine Wisdom enters the natural man, binds the evil proprium with five spiritual faculties, and meets resistance from the old nature — yet eventually prevails. The correspondence between the five cosmic watch-stations and the five provinces within the individual body is drawn out in detail: insurrections occur at every level, guardians are stationed, and the divine power accommodates itself to the smallness of the individual person without being defiled. Three great spiritual states (descent into temptation, reign in the regenerated life, final unveiling of the Divine) and two spiritual deaths (temporal mixing of good with evil, and the eternal death of those who rejected regeneration) mark the complete temporal horizon. Three outcomes that must be accomplished by necessity and three progressive devastations against evil complete this part.

The Good Mind in the Body

Primary Teaching

The most extended teaching on individual regeneration. Divine Wisdom enters the natural man, binds the proprium with five faculties, and the question is raised: where does it dwell, since insurrections of evil still arise? The whole structure of error is read as a human form — governing principle, connective support, five spread faculties, structural supports, central point, the whole constructed after the pattern of the Divine Human. Correspondence is then drawn between the five cosmic watch-stations and five provinces within the individual: the face (guardian of wisdom), the heart (honor), the genitals (unyielding truth), the stomach (glorifying power), the feet (sustaining foundation). At each level, treachery and insurrection occur. The evil proprium rises through five stages from contemplation through will, perception, thought, to understanding — but Divine Wisdom can reverse this, bestowing a great spirit upon the purified ones, enabling the will to run and touch everything from the heights of the Father to the land of Darkness.

The [Good Mind] is this one who shall come and assume the saints. [For] He too is one among the gods [and] many gods are with him. [Now When] he enters [within the body of] the flesh and binds the [old man] with his five counsels, he [sets] his five [counsels] upon him in the five limbs [of his] body.

[So], [now], where is he? In that the old man is chained in the body! For I see how rebellions arise there despite his bondage, from time to time.

If then he is a great God, unchanging and immeasurable, how could he come and appear in the smallness of the [body]?

[Thirdly] a holy one is the Mind, and he is pure; [how shall he bear] the defilement of this body?

Fourthly: If truly the Good Mind exists in [the saints], why is his likeness not displayed to us, the way that he is?

All the error, when the [enemy] of the lights constructed it, he constructed after the likeness of a man. The head of the universe is the beginning of the garments. [His] neck is the nape of the [garments]. His stomach is the five unfolded ones (?), which [are the middle] of the [garments]. His ribs are all the [firmaments]. His navel is the sphere of the stars and the signs of the zodiac. And, also, [the parts that] come from his navel to his hip are [those] that come from the sphere [to the corners] of the four worlds. His loins are the [three earths] that are below [and rest] upon the head of the Guardian Spirit. His [thighs are] from the [loins] to the earth upon which the Guardian Spirit [is stood] firm. His shins and his feet [are the abysses below] and the entire zone that belongs [to them].

His heart is mankind. His liver is the four-footed animals. His lung is the race of birds that [fly in] the air. His spleen is the race of fish that swim in the waters. His kidneys are the world of reptiles that creep [upon] the earth. His outer skin is the wall that [... which] surrounds the piercing and the great fire. His [...] the vessels of the great fire. His [...] of darkness. His gall is the [... His] great intestine is the breadth of the great [sea] of the worlds. His veins [are] all [the springs] and wells. His [eyes (?) ...] His feet are his [...].

This is how each of the worlds [have been harmonised] (?). Five gods are fastened in him. [For] they are his soul and his life [Yet the old] man is a sinner [But] the Lord of Covenants and the Envoy [have appointed] the five sleepless guardians.

He has [placed] the Master of Wisdom, the mind that is [set] in the [world] of the mind that is above. He has [set the] whole [host] of the powers of [heaven that] are in [the camp] of the great Lord of the Settled Lands, [who is the thought that exists in] the seventh firmament. He has humbled [...] also of the

[Life-Champion], who is the teaching [that comes] from [above] he has given [...] because of lust [... He has] also appointed the Lord of the Mind, who is the [counsel and the] patience over the three images; that of wind, that of fire, and that of water. He has handed over to him the [powers that] do evilness. [He has also set] the Guardian Spirit, who is the consideration [and] the wisdom in the [earth] which is below. He has made him [bear] the foundation [below the earths].

Furthermore: The Envoy refined from them five intellectuals of life. Also, the summons and the obedience were situated there. Now, they made six sons of the Lord of Covenants, together with the six sons of Lord Wisdom!

Further: The Envoy placed in them the great Mind; who is Hearkening, Hearkening.

Furthermore: the Living Word was set there; who is the image of the living word, of the utterance and the obedience.

He has made strong these camps, those above and those below [in the world], (so that) each one of them will be secure in the circuit of his watch-district, so that neither uprising nor treachery are made in his watch-district.

And look, see! The Master of Wisdom is set firm in the great mind, in the camp above the prison of the bound ones, for he brings to nothing all the gloom of death. [And a] treachery came about, and an uprising! The Sin [aborted], [it tangled] in with the soul. It became mixed with this light that it expelled toward the likeness of the Envoy. It went [up] in the third firmament that is above the watch-[tower of] the Master of Wisdom. From that place also it tangled in with the light. It was detached and came down to that which is dry and that which is moist. It [fashioned] the trees [upon] the dry (land); but in the sea it [immediately] took form and made a great uprising in the sea.

Again, look, see! The great Lord of the Settled Lands, who is the thought, he is in the [third] firmament. He is made [to contend] with wrath. And an uprising came about! A treachery and [an] anger happened in his camp. The watchers of heaven, who came down to the earth in his watch-district, they did all the deeds of treachery. They have revealed crafts in the world and have unveiled to people the mysteries of heaven. An uprising came about, and a destruction, on the earth [...] to it.

The [Life-Champion], who is] the fulfillment. He is set firm [upon the earth] and a treachery came about in his camp; the occasion when the abortions fell to the earth. They formed Adam and Eve. They begat them so as to reign through them in the world. They fashioned every object of lust upon the earth. The entire world was filled by their lust.

Once again: In the watch of the great Lord of the Mind, [who] is the great counsel, he who exercises authority over the [three] wheels. A [disturbance] came about, and an affliction, for [they were] pained and oppressed in the three earths. After the Envoy displayed his likeness, the paths closed to their [springs, and] their ascent was impeded by them [...] the [wind], the water, and the fire ascend on them.

[Once] again: In the watch of the Guardian Spirit, he who humiliates [the] uprising of the abysses below [the earth was] bent, the fastenings underneath were loosened [and shaken] in the foundation below.

On account of the earthquake that happened in the watch of the [Master of Wisdom], Hearkening came forth; as it [became the] helper of the Master of Wisdom. It bore up under all [burdens].

Conversely, because of the treachery and the uprising that happened in the watch of the great Lord of the Settled Lands, which is the watchers who came down to earth from the heavens; four angels were called upon about them. They bound the [watchers] with an eternal chain, in the prison of the blackened ones (?). [They] obliterated their children from upon the earth.

[Then], again, the abortions descended in the watch of the Adamant and begat Adam and Eve; because of that great treachery [which] happened, and the mystery of wickedness, he sent the Kingdom of Wisdom [with] the prayer of the five sons. He assumed them [from] the abortions. He fastened them beneath the [...] mind of Adam.

Also, because of the earthquake that happened in these three earths, and in that the paths were hindered and the springs of wind and water and fire were impeded, the Kingdom of Wisdom cast himself down. He assumed Eve; and he straightened the tracks of the [wind], the water, and the fire. He opened the springs for them, and he set [in order] the path of their ascent.

Once [again]: Since the earth beneath the Guardian Spirit was [loosened from] the fastenings that [held it] because of this too the Kingdom of Wisdom went down, assuming [Eve] until he reached [that] place. [He] set in [order] and [strengthened] the fastenings beneath. He returned, [he came] up to his [place of] rest.

Look at all these watches of the [zone], the ones in which these great gods are master, [watching] over them [at all times]. Uprisings have happened, and treachery, in them. The [struggles arose] in them from time to time; with a great [humiliation], until they humbled the powers of the enmity.

So also is this body! A mighty power lives here, even if it is small in its stature. Nevertheless, Sin dwells within, and the old man who is lodged in it. Certainly he is cruel, with great cunning; until the Good Mind finds how to humble this body, and drive it [according to] his pleasure.

Just so, in the [watch-]districts of his great outer brothers, they who are masters in the zone: in them, in the great body, the earthquake and treachery happened from time to time. So, also, is the watch-district of the Mind, which is the body of the flesh. Sin raises [up], from time to time, its agitations in the body.

The powers of light are good. The beginning and the end are unveiled to them. All that they do is being done with correct judgement. Indeed, because of this they may permit the enmity to initiate error, and do its pleasure for a moment. Then they seize [it, for] they have acted first with a righteous judgement.

These gods, in that [they] are great and mighty ones. And each one of them is enclosed and hard pressed in this place wherein he is set; like trees holding to their taproot. So also this is how each one of them has held to his taproot in the world, according to the [kind] of place in which he is set, bearing up till [the end].

The world is set firm, being ordered [by] the five sons of the Lord of Covenants in all its members [...]. Sin took this body out from [the land and constructed] it in its members. It took its [body] from the five bodies of Darkness. (Sin) constructed the body. Yet, its [soul it] took from the five shining gods.

(Sin) bound (the soul) in the five members of the body. It bound the mind in bone; the thought in sinew; the teaching in vein; the counsel in flesh; the consideration in [skin].

(Sin) set [fast] its five powers: its mind upon the mind of the soul; its thought upon the thought of the soul; its teaching upon the teaching of the soul; its counsel upon the counsel of the soul; its [consideration] upon the consideration of the soul. It placed its five [angels] and authorities upon the five members of the soul, which it had brought in and bound in the flesh.

(The soul) assumed error and forgetfulness. It [forgot] its essence and its race and its kindred; [knowing] not the door of the place to pray to him, nor call up to him. It became hostile to its father [and against] itself, being wicked [against] its own light [...].

The Good Mind comes and finds the soul [...] it assuming it in the [...] its wisdom [...] he shall become for it [...] the bonds [...] members in the body. He shall loosen the [mind of the soul and release] it from the bone. He shall release the [thought of the soul] from the sinew; and [so] bind the thought [of

the Sin in] the sinew. He shall release the teaching of the soul from the [vein]; and so bind the teaching of the Sin in the vein. [He shall] loosen the counsel of the soul, and release it from the flesh; and so bind the counsel of the Sin in the flesh. He shall release the consideration of the soul from the skin; and [bind] the consideration of the Sin in the skin.

This is how he shall release the members of the soul, and make them free from the five members of Sin. Conversely, these five members of Sin, which were loose, he shall bind them.

He shall set right the members of the soul; form and purify them, and construct a new man of them, a child of righteousness. [And] when [he] fashions and [constructs] and purifies the new man; then he shall bring forth five great living members out from the five great [members]. And he places them in the members of the new man. He shall place his [mind], which is love, in the mind of the new man. Also, the [thought], which is faith, he shall [place in] the thought of the new man; whom he shall purify. His teaching, which [is perfection, he shall place] in the teaching of the new man. His counsel, which [is] patience, he shall place in his counsel. Also, [wisdom], which is his consideration, in the consideration of the new [man]. He shall make the image of the word pure from the word of Sin; and he adds to it his word, so that his [word] becomes nourisher and strengthener [...].

Now, when he shall [perfect all the twelve] members. This [is how ...] and his wisdom. His [word] becomes righteous, as he [perfects him] While formerly he was running [in error] but instead of this, now he runs [upon] his road and his path and his [ascent] also [he mounts up] to the heights, to the great aeons [of light, and] thus the old man is bound in the [flesh] and his lust, his [wrath] his foolishness in these five members of the [body, and] dark spirit is imprisoned with them in a bond and in severe misery.

Also, the new man reigns by his love, by [his] faith, by his perfection, by his patience, and by his wisdom. Yet, his king [is] the Good Mind, he [who is] king over the totality. He [reigns over it according to] his pleasure. While the members [obey him], thus Sin is imprisoned. Still, the Good Mind is king, and an affliction may arise in the body from [time] to time.

There are occasions when Sin shall mount up with its foolishness; and it disturbs the consideration, and it clouds the wisdom and the understanding of the person. It causes truth to be split into doubt in him, and he utters some [foolish] words and some [wicked deeds].

Sin mount up again, another time, from the consideration to the counsel. It takes his patience [from him], and bestows upon him faint-heartedness and hurt. [...] A battle and a war shall arise (between) the Good Mind and the Sin in the counsel [...].

Sin shall rise [up to his teaching] and clothe him with lust and vanity and pride.

Sin shall mount up, the thought of death, to his thought. He shall [conceive] a vanity; and causes his [faith] and his truth to [leave] him.

(Sin) shall rise up and assume his mind; and disturb his mind, which formerly was calm. It shall disrupt his love.

The Mind, who was in him, [shall] disperse from him [and depart] He shall be filled by evil spirits; and they deal with [him], dragging [him] hither and thither. [... He] will change and become as if a [bird], were its feathers plucked out. He becomes an earthly man.

So [also] these watch-keepers, for they are set [fast and firm in] the zone, (but) they are not visible. Again, this too is the way of the Good Mind, [for he is] not visible in the body.

Also, [corresponding] to [these] outer [watch-keepers]: in that while they are great, [yet] have they contorted themselves. They have [humbled themselves], they have become small, to the measure of the task that is apportioned to each [one of them]. Again, this too is like the Mind, [himself] a great one, and exalted; but he is bent over and [has] become small, to this little worthless [body].

[Even so] the gods in the outer [zone]: they are transcendent and purified, they are set [fast in] the mingling of the totality, (but) are not defiled. [This too is like the Good Mind]. While he is placed in [his body, he is not defiled].

Again, behold the mightiness and the activity of the Good Mind: how vast he is over all the watch-districts of the body! He stays fast at his camp. He shuts off all deliberations of the body from the beguilements of Sin. He limits them and distributes them out. He sets them down at his pleasure.

Also, he does another work, surpassing and exceeding (these). He bestows a great spirit upon the purified one. Indeed, now may you find him, as he stands on the earth, [rising] up in his heart and ascending to the Father, the [God] of truth. He who exists and is established above all the things of loss. [Once] again, he may push [down] in his teaching and his consideration, and descend to the land of Darkness, from where the Darkness has poured forth. His heart shall run and touch everything, as it [pleases].

Three Great Days and Two Deaths

Primary Teaching

Three great spiritual states: the first day encompasses the descent, combat, ordering, and all workings until the final consummation; the second day is when the victorious dwell on their thrones in the regenerated spiritual world, reigning for a duration equal to the first day's affliction; the third day is when the Divine unveils its own likeness, raises all into itself, pours out celestial delight without measure, gives its own garments, perfects their stature, and establishes each faculty in its proper degree forever. Two deaths: the first (temporal) extends from wisdom's fall into falsity until purification in the final fire of love; the second (eternal) strips those who confirmed themselves in evil of all truth, all influx, and all sustaining good — they are bound permanently upon their own self-love.

There exist three great mighty days in all; and also two great and bitter deaths.

What are these three great days? Or again, what are these two deaths that are bitter?

The first day is our father, the Man. From the time when Lord Wisdom went down to the abyss of darkness and drowned in it; and the Lord of Covenants was sent, who went and raised him up. After the Man had ascended, the Lord of Covenants and the Great Spirit set things in order, and the worlds above and below.

Furthermore, the glorious Envoy came and dwelt in the ship of the day. He displayed his glorious likeness, and he purified the light out of all things. He walked in the heights of the heavens. Till the time when the world will be dissolved, all things destroyed, the great fire released, and the Final Body ascends. These three deeds were begun on this first day, when they sent Lord Wisdom with his five sons.

In contrast, [the first death] is the darkness that mixed with the five sons of Lord Wisdom.

The second day is the time when the fathers of light, who were victorious in the struggle, will sit on their thrones in the new aeon and dwell on the new earth. And they reign in the new aeon till the Father unveils his likeness above them.

The length of the sojourn in the new aeon equals the measure of the first day spent in affliction. They will reign like this and rejoice in the new aeon.

The great third day [is the time] when the Father will unveil over them his likeness [... ...] and he raises them up [to himself] and he receives them into his hidden treasury [of light] and he gives [to them] his soul. He can pour out upon them [without measure] his ambrosia and his sweet perfume, which takes away all affliction that they have seen with their eyes. [It is a] fullness and a joy eternal! When his grace would sate them, he gives to them his [garments of light] and they are made anew in them.

Also, he can summon them once more in peace and silence, and perfect their stature in same measure as his first aeons. And he sets each power in its aeon, in its dwelling-place. They will dwell in the new aeon in their aeons!

Now, when they dwell in their aeons, they will become rich beyond measure, for ever, beyond time. From then on they will not count that season amongst them; nor the number of the days, nor the hours, generation after generation, for ever and ever. The Father will not be hidden from them, from this time on. Rather, he has accomplished (his) unveiling to them [for ever] he being revealed to them for ever.

These are the three great days, [which Boundless Time has given number to in the reckoning].

In contrast, the two deaths are these.

The first death is from the time when the light fell to the darkness, and was mixed in with the rulers of Darkness; until the time when the light will become pure, and be separated from the darkness in that great fire. The remainder left behind there can build and add to that the Final Body.

Now, the second death is the death in which the souls of sinful men shall die; when [they will] be stripped of the shining light that illuminates the world. And also they are separated from the living air, from which they receive [living] breath; and they are deprived of this living soul, which [sustains all things] in the world; and they are separated and swept away from this the Final Body [and they have no portion in it] and bound on [... ...] the female will become [the source of] their torture and their affliction; for their deeds [have cast them into] those three places; because they have blasphemed and despised the Bounteous Spirit since [every] generation of the world.

These are the two deaths. The first death is temporal; [but] the second death is eternal. It is the [second death]!

Three Necessities and Three Blows

Primary Teaching

Three outcomes that must be accomplished by Divine Wisdom through necessity: the regenerated external mind established upon the subjugated proprium, the containing form that encloses what is spiritually dead, and the permanent fixing of confirmed evil upon its own self-love. The final mass of evil is sealed when all phantasms are affixed within it, and a great emptiness of separation is set between falsity and the self-love that generated it so that they can never again communicate. Three progressive devastations against evil: drawing the selfhood out from concealment into the open; dissolving its coherence in divine love and reducing it to its original condition; and the final reversal where the intellectual element of evil is divided from the volitional element and sealed in eternal separation.

Three things would be fashioned by the Light through necessity. For there can be no other way nor other result, to allow them to stay without coming about. For the Darkness, the enemy, must be bound by them; he who stood up against the Light from the beginning. Due to this, these things have no (other) result, to allow them to stay without coming about.

Now, the first thing is the new luminous earth, which was set and built on top of this earth [that is beneath] it, namely that alien body [that was] built upon it.

The second thing is this: They will [fashion] and they [will build] the new earth, the coffin [and the grave] of the dark fire, the companion of the enemy.

The third thing is the souls of all the sinners who have been condemned by their deeds. They were [judged, and there came] over them woe; they have been condemned according to the wicked deeds they had committed, and due to this they will be bound and spread on the enemy, he who had raised himself up against the greatness.

They will seal up this final lump when all the likenesses and images of every shape will be nailed in it. Also, those will be bound by this last fetter for eternity, and be placed as a footstool and a mat and a rag for this coffin [of the Darkness] which is the prison of the enemy. It will be placed, being a boundary-marker and a great void between the two, between the Darkness and the enemy, so that they cannot reach one another, nor can they hear their voices; rather they will become sterile as they are separated from each other for ever and ever.

The Darkness itself, the enemy, has received three bad blows with three wars; and worse dangers from the light in those three wars.

The first: (The enemy) was brought out to the middle and separated from his dark earth, whence he had departed. He was vanquished in that first war, caught and [bound] by the living soul.

The second blow is the time when he will be dissolved and melted, and he perishes in this great fire. He is destroyed and overthrown, from the images that are all by which he exists. And he will be gathered in [to the] fetter corresponding to his archetype, and be made like he was from the first beginning.

The third blow that will befall the enemy is the 'rolling back' [at the] end when everything will be separated, and male will be divided [from] female. Now, the male will be bound in the lump, but the female [will be thrown] in to the tomb. For it will be divided [and sealed by a great] stone in their midst, for generation upon generation, for ever and ever.

This is the way that the binding of the enemy will come about, in a fetter that is burdensome and strong, one from which there is never escape; because [they have achieved] his binding and bound him for ever. And they have achieved his being set apart, and he has been set apart for ever.

Part 9

The Mechanics of Purification

The most technically detailed part of the teaching: how the containing forms of corrupted truth, falsity, and infernal desire are expelled from the interior mind, brought into conscious awareness in the natural mind, and then swept outward into the hells. The central doctrine — that evils cannot be cast directly into the hells but must first be recognized in the external man — is elaborated through the simile of the sick man healed by a wise doctor and the child emerging from the womb. Twelve deeds of benefit follow from this threefold expulsion. The preparation of confining states before evils arise demonstrates that Providence foresees every descent into evil. The four domains of the ruling-power, the revolving cycle of knowledges, and the three reciprocal pathways of influx connecting celestial states to natural ultimates complete the architecture of spiritual governance.

The Three Vessels and Providence's Foresight

Primary Teaching

The most technically detailed teaching on purification. Three containing forms of evil (corrupted truth, falsity, infernal desire) are expelled from the interior mind through three external doctrines (understanding, truth, love), using the simile of a wise doctor administering three medicines and the simile of a child emerging from the womb without harm. The central doctrine: evils are first brought into conscious awareness in the natural mind so that corresponding latent evils already there are attracted upward by like-toward-like, made manifest, and then swept outward. Twelve great works of benefit follow from this threefold expulsion. Remnants of each vessel persist in the natural mind as signatures: corrosive sensory falsity, obstinate self-intelligence near the source of illumination, and states of pride from which no good works spring. Providence's foresight is demonstrated: confining states, places for every kind of evil, and means of restraint are always prepared before the evils they must hold arise.

These three vessels that [were hidden] and were discharged from above, and how they were discharged and separated from all the rulers who are arranged in the heavens. [This is] the manner in which the three vessels have been discharged, while the rulers were flourishing in their body.

When these vessels were discharged, they were discharged in [great] slaughter, but those [who separated] these vessels from them.

They are like the form of a man who has fallen into a purulent sickness. Other wounds and diseases are in his body, and even bile and other poisons are in his inner limbs. He achieves good health by a wise doctor, who gives him one remedy to drink that causes his purulent sickness to break out above, and gives him another medicine to drink that causes his sickness to discharge below, and he gives him yet another medicine to drink that cures his wounds for him [and purifies him] calmly and silently.

Through the skill of a wise doctor, with his effective medicines to consume that take away all sicknesses in this manner and dissolve all magic, the doctors shall [heal, and] they work cures through the aroma of the medicine, other wounds [that are in] what is hidden, they at last tear them out from [within, and are] manifested above and below [and purified through] the aroma of edible medicines that were placed upon them.

This is also what these vessels of water, of darkness and of fire are like, which are hidden in the body of all the rulers above; while the Lord of Covenants is like the wise doctor. These three healing drugs are the three garments that the Lord of Covenants assumes upon his body: of wind, of water, and of fire. Through them he has set in order the things below. For by those three garments he has been displayed to the rulers who are above, with hard-heartedness, with shaking and fear, with derangement; from them he discharged the three vessels, those of water, of darkness and of fire.

The case of these vessels is just like a child who is in his mother's womb and is swathed by seven garments. The first is the marrow, the second is the bones, the third is the tendons, the fourth is the flesh, the fifth the veins, the sixth the blood, the seventh the skin of the body that covers him. The other garment also [is the covering that wraps him, and the ninth is that which encloses him] this child. The marrow and the bones, the sinews and flesh, the veins and blood and skin, together with the garment that she wears and the linen that swathes her, total nine. Together with the nine of the child, these and the others, they shall complete and make eighteen garments. Now, you shall find the soul of this child is entwined within all these.

And look see: When the smell of the action of the demon, which brings about the stench of birth, will reveal the child; immediately [it] shall [open up] all [these things] and it emerges from a crack that has

become visible, while no tear nor wound occurs in the body of the child. In the same way as this child opens up the womb of his mother, so is it also with these vessels of water, of darkness and of fire. The actions that open up his mother to the child, and she shakes him out and reveals him; these are the three living garments that the Lord of Covenants assumed on his body.

For by the aspect of the garment of water [in which he was revealed to them, he shook them and discharged the vessel of water] from the rulers; he moved [the waters, for] they are the poison and death with which their veins and entrails are filled.

By the aspect of the garment of wind, in which he was revealed [to them] he has swept away and erased the entire destructive shadow and dirt, discharged it down to the earth. Afterwards he swept it out and confined it in the vessel of darkness that surrounds the universe.

Also, by the garment of living fire, through its radiance and vigour, he discharged the fire of the darkness from all the rulers and threw it down upon this earth. He swept it another time from the earth and confined it in the vessel that surrounds all the worlds, and they call it the wall of great fire.

Now, those three garments, through which he established these three things, he did not peel them off all at once; but he stripped them off one by one at the appropriate time [and cast them] down to the earth [below].

In this way the universe of the [... ...] his vessels [...] these vessels like [...].

The use of the matter, and the management of these vessels that were swept out and discharged from above to earth, have brought an advantage and benefit of twelve great deeds. Afterwards, they were swept from the earth and pushed outside to the edges of the worlds and to the extremity.

The first deed is this: So that evil-doing does not increase in the universe, neither in the creations nor in the trees [nor in all flesh, fortself] up in three things.

The [first is / ...].

The second is error [... ...] if [the vessel of water] had not been swept down from above, but rather the waters existing up till now in the rulers above [... / ... the] torrents that would flow [down] and the droplets that would [drip] down, so lust would have sprouted [and multipliedn] the trees and in the fruits as well as all flesh.

If the vessel of darkness had not been swept out and thrown down to the earth, nor swept from the earth and cast outside the region of the worlds into this pit; again the drops of darkness, which will drip down from it, and the torrents that will continue to flow down from above to the earth and assume the trees and all flesh, would have multiplied.

If the fire were in the rulers of the worlds of the heavens, and had not been swept out and cast down to the earth, and swept from the earth and shut up inside the vessel of fire that surrounds the worlds; [again] this fire [would have poured down from] above through the torrent [... the torrent ...] below;

And the dark fire would have multiplied in the tree and in fruit and in all flesh.

This single evil that was purified by three archetypes [... / ...].

The second deed: [All] the heavens [... / ...] of the sediment and the pollution [... ...] so that [... / ...] surpasses in them [...].

[The third]: The heavens and the firmaments [... / ... burden and were] relieved from the weight-carriers [...] and it ceased being heavy. This rich one [... ...] above.

The fourth: That they might purify and cleanse their dwelling places [... / ...].

The fifth: Because the greatness and the richness that dwells in these ships, as it [fills them] you might find them living in these ships, purified and holy.

The sixth: That you might find the mixed, incomplete, and unconfined temples above at rest and purified; since rest will reach them and pass through them and purify them.

The seventh: [That the] nature alone of the vessels, which will advance and extend to their places and sites [... / ...] in [...].

The eighth: That great enclosures and walls would be made, and confine everything.

The ninth: When the Sent Ones [reach] them, they shall return to the universe and give a sign of [the end and] the dissolution of the universe.

The tenth deed: That they would become releasers and purifiers of everything at the end of the universe like the fire [... / ...] burns [all things].

The eleventh deed: [That they] will make a crossing [to the light] and the entire ruling-power [shall be cast out].

To the outer land, for they were not envious of this [...] a man who is richer than them; because the aeons of light are outside [it, in] the place [of rest and] of peace, the place of honour and grace, the place where the joy of the householders who dwell in it shall never pass away nor recede.

The twelfth: That you might find all the deeds of loss hidden from the aeons of light, because of the wall of fire that surrounds the entire building; and these unclean things are displayed (only) in its [interior].

There was a need for these twelve great deeds because the vessels that were discharged and swept out from the firmaments to the earth, and were also swept from the earth to the {[extremity) ... / ...] the three words of life watch over them that [... / ... are] set over them in great power [and authority] that they might watch over them at the last time; because of this, they are firmly set thus in these fetters.

When the Lord of Covenants discharged these three vessels from above, they of water and of darkness and of fire, did he perhaps discharge them to their pits at the edge of the firmament? Or did he discharge them first to this earth, and then he swept them from the earth and threw them to their places?

When the Lord of Covenants was about to discharge these three vessels he poured the three upon this earth, one by one at its (appointed) hour and season. He discharged them and cast them down to the earth.

Then he bailed and scooped them from this earth in these three garments, they of wind and of water and of fire, which swathed his body. He poured and made them flow into the three pits [at the edge of the firmamenthich] he had [established] during the [construction] of the worlds [And when] they [were swept away, yet] something remained behind on the face of the earth from these three vessels, so that you can find their mark and type displayed in the universe.

The element that is left in water is the pungency and the salinity of this salty inner sea that surrounds the worlds.

And the remnant that is left from the darkness is this black mountain that exists in the surroundings of the sunrise. For when the sun would shine over the world no sunlight is visible there, because the darkness that gushes from it manifests above it.

And the remnant that remains behind from the fire, upon the earth, are all the mountains and islands from where fumes of fire gush up and are visible. For these things are the remnant of the great vessel, the vestige that was conjoined with this fire that comes up from the earth; together with the mountains and hills [and the] places where no fruit sprouts on the trees [for the fire is] greater than that place from the

limb and [... / ...] the trees shall not bear fruit in that place.

About the vessels that surround the universe, and why they were not discharged from above into the ditches prepared for them (straightaway); but were firstly poured upon the earth, and afterwards were swept from the earth and cast down into their pits?

When the Lord of Covenants discharged these vessels from above upon the earth, he poured them out for this reason: so that also the water and the darkness and the fire that exist in these three earths would be drawn and ascend towards they that had come down from above, and the earths would be purified and cleansed. Due to this he poured these vessels down to the earth, of water and of darkness and of fire, so that also the water and darkness and fire that exist in the earths would be drawn up towards they that had descended from above.

Now, first of all, he discharged the water, the waste, the poison of the rulers who are above. He cleansed the firmaments of the [water that weighed them down] he poured down the dark waters. [Just as the] waters fell from heaven to earth, so also the waters below in the earths were drawn and came up from below towards the waters that had come from above to the earths. The waters [were] purified of the dark poison that exists in them. Then he swept them outside and made them a great vessel and a wall of sea that surrounds the universe, and on which the ships sail.

After the water, he discharged the darkness. He purified the firmaments and dried from them the darkness with which they are weighed down. He discharged it down to the earth. Just as he had purified the firmaments, so also he purified the earths. The darkness that is in the earths was drawn up towards the darkness that had been discharged from above. He swept them both out and shut them in that [pit] of darkness [... / ...] the water.

And he discharged the fire from heaven to earth, [and at] that time again the fire that was shut [in] the earth below was drawn and came up towards its kind. Fire was added to fire. Afterwards, he swept it out and cast it into the outer underworld, which [he had constructed for] them outside the universe.

In the same way that he purified the firmaments above as a place for the light-givers to journey [... / ...] so also he purified the earths below and swept from them the fire and the darkness and the water [and cast them out] He has purified them for the ascent of these three powers, they of the wind and the water and the fire, which ascend before the Guardian Spirit and traverse the earths.

After the Lord of Covenants constructed things and the worlds, he came up and set himself upon this earth. He gave a sign to the Lord of the Mind, who turned the three wheels and caused the wheels that are found [to turn] up above all the mountains; he spread forth the wind to them, he breathed on them, he stirred them up, he washed the earth with the waters. And the waste and the accretion of the three vessels, they of water and of Darkness and of fire, which had been discharged upon the earth, he gathered them and deposited them in the sea that is within the walls and the vessels; because of this sea waters are salty. For they have received salt and bitterness from the washing out and cleansing of the three vessels.

When the Lord of Covenants came, rising in his ascent to the heights, he discharged the wheel of the stars; he washed it out and loosened all the sediment that was in it. He cast it down to this great inner sea like [the stones] of the mountain. And that waste, the sediment of the washing out of the wheel, he cast it down and mixed it in with the sea waters. Its own thought collected it together; and the thought gathered the waste together in this way. It made it fast and fixed it [in the sea].

The sea giant had stamped upon him the seal of the seconds and the hours, the seal of the days and months and years, the impression of the stars and the signs of the zodiac [and the five stars] He came into existence from them and was discharged from their power and cast into the sea. The images and the seals and aspects and doctrines and counsels of [the wheel of the sphere] were sealed upon the body of that giant, because he is the residue of them all. Consequently, each star that will shine, and each sign of the

zodiac that will turn: of one he shall be its inducement, and of another its confirmation.

He was discharged into the sea like this, the way a cloud might discharge rainwater into the midst of the sea. They compelled him totally through the action of the power and the helmsmanship of the angels. He was swept down to the mill, the place where he was constructed in the setting up of the universe; and the sea also conceived him [and bore him] for its part [and formed him] it being his chief sculptor and chief craftsman. It sculpted him in a likeness, he being changed more than the other residue of the sea bodies.

This matter is comparable with a craftsman who might take the stamped impressions of many coins and cast them on the fire, and mould them [into a single] image. These thousands of impressions and thousands of shapes [are perfected] and make a single body [from them all].

This is also the case with the sea giant, who too was moulded and sculpted by the power of the lust inside him from many doctrines and counsels that belong to the residue of the wheel of the sphere.

The archetype of the giant was constructed for three things.

The first: That the sphere would be relieved and purified of the burden present in it. In the same way that the ten firmaments were purified and relieved of the burden of the three vessels; so was it also done to the sphere, that it too might be relieved and purified of the burden and the waste inside it.

The second: That he might add a fetter and a prison to the wheel and the signs of the zodiac that are bound to it, so that when they wish to go up above, you can find the sea giant dragging them back as by an iron fetter, and they are unable to go up; and when the powers of the wheel would take a decision on a guileful thing, and it enters their mind to come down to the earth, they are not able to descend because of this stake that is nailed to the wheel upon the [midst] of the firmaments. This is one. However, this other one, because of its sleepless watchers that are set over it, it is turned all the time.

The third thing: That the wind and the water and the fire that gush from the circuit of the sea, and the rivers that flow upon the face of the earth discharging into the sea, and the rainwaters that come to ground, and the waste and rebirth that come down to it; that sea will be a hostel and gathering place for all of these.

As for all the power and the life that comes down to the sea, and in the breath that the sea giant will breathe and draw it into him that he might disturb the sea [there comes a] fullness and a [stirring] becomes between his movement [and his power to] purify; but the sea [is cleansed thereby].

Understand also this other (matter): Before these vessels were discharged and swept down from heaven, first three ditches were fashioned and constructed for them, in which they would be bound and fettered.

Before the sea giant was discharged from the sphere, the Lord of Covenants constructed a place for [him in] this great sea that is within the walls, whereon the ships sail, and where the fullness shall [be gathered from it].

Also, before the [beast] was displayed to the worlds [and] the earth [... ... fell] to the sea and its thought shaped it, the Lord of Covenants constructed a place for it in [the depths of the earth] below the four mountains, above the mountains of the heavens above [it] that [as] a great plain it digs in Greed in the midst of the worlds. When the Life-Champion was sent to it, he hastened after it to that place, smote it and threw it between mountains in the place made ready for it [and he] is set fast upon it till the end of the universe.

Before the waste and dirt of Darkness were swept out from creation, gehennas were constructed in which the waste might be covered till the dissolution of the universe.

Before the rebels rose up, they whose corps rebelled in the ruling-power above and below, they [were cast] outside, and also the tyrants in whose heart it lay [to tyrannise] amongst the murk and the clouds and winds and spirits and storms; for them were constructed in the great outer sea seven hostels, places whence they are thrown into the depths and the darkness [outside].

Also, before the abortions [fell down from heaven] to the earth, there was set apart [a place for them]: they are gathered in and dwell therein.

Again, before the watchers rebelled and came down from heaven, a prison was fashioned and constructed for them in the depths of the earth, below the mountains.

Before the children of the giants were born, they who had [no] knowledge of righteousness in them nor divinity, thirty-six cities were assigned and constructed for them wherein the children of [the giants would] live; they who would come to beget from each other, they who shall spend ten hundred years alive.

Before night and day were differentiated in the universe, [the Envoy] was summoned. And afterwards, he was sent to this void and outer waste that he might purify the light, and separate night and day from each other.

Before the light was released and freed and ascended through this zone, the Lord of Covenants made beautiful for it the ships of light. He constructed them so that it might be purified in them, and be sculpted and fashioned in good order.

[Before] Sin had multiplied and had made a kingdom in the flesh, before the acquitted and the [condemned] were set apart from each other, Justice [was] sent forth and revealed. His throne was created and placed [in] the living atmosphere, so that he would be a just Judge, so that there the righteous and the sinners would be set apart and tested and separated from each other.

Again, [before] mankind had been engendered, some were named ['rich' and] others 'poor' on earth [according to what is written] upon them. Before they die, they who will die are marked out by the stars and the signs of the zodiac in the sphere. They are appointed for them; in them are their births. And their root is bound up with their zodiacal signs; and they are compelled by them and brought to an equal judgement in accordance with their deeds and their sins.

Again, before the universe is dissolved, [and the] entire earth, the destroyers were appointed and instructed for its dissolution.

And before the [new] aeon was [built and] made [beautiful] and marked out, [the Dawn was] summoned, the first architect and the angels who are with him, who would build and make beautiful the new aeon.

The Four Domains and the Three Conduits

Primary Teaching

The ruling-power is distributed across four domains: interior heavenly states above the cycle of knowledges, the natural and infernal states below, the boundaries and containing forms that surround all states, and the cycle of knowledges itself arranged with great providential care. Evil powers are bound upon the revolving cycle — suspended in perpetual change of state so they cannot fix their awareness — while wisdom ascending from below passes through them and is received above. Three reciprocal pathways of influx connect all degrees: from celestial powers to their corporeal vessels, from doctrinal forms to perceptions, and from rational loves to proprial will. The cycle of knowledges gained dominion over perceptions and proprial will when the evil of the proprium fragmented and fell into three degrees. The teaching concludes with why the channels of influx are never severed by the revolving cycle — they are of spiritual substance that restores itself perfectly.

The wheel of the stars is a great mighty thing! Also, it is one among the four great things; since the whole ruling-power is assigned to four parts.

The first part is the powers who occur in the ten firmaments that exist above the wheel, and the ruling-power that is bound in them, as it is imprisoned within them in the heavens that are above.

The second part is the eight earths that are below; the four that are composite, and the four places of darkness. The second part extends from this earth, upon which mankind walks, towards the underside.

The third part is the walls and the vessels that surround the worlds. They are the four mountains and the three vessels; with what is in them, and the ruling-power that is trapped within them, and the powers who are masters over them.

The fourth part is the sphere of the stars that is appointed with great diligence, as it is ordered in a [great arrangement withany ordinances]; that of the Lord of Covenants, [and that of the Mother of] the living.

Its [ordering was made with] very [great care] with diligence, because of the great and cruel powers, and the titanic figures, [who are bound] in it; they being suspended from it. So, all the first-born and the leaders of all the rulers, they who were existing in the three parts, these were garnered. They were collected together, seized, bound and assigned on this wheel. Each was apportioned by these three parts. They were distributed, entwined, and weighted against their companions of the same size.

Still, for its part, the wheel is equal to them in its strength; the powers of the enmity who are bound on it. Indeed, they were suspended on the circling wheel because of their cruelty; so that, due to the wind and the motion in which they go round, they comprehend not the place wherein they are set. For if they had been bound in the heavens, the heavens would not have had the strength to support them. Again, if they had been assigned on the earths, on the fixtures that are below, they also would not have had the strength to support them. Rather, they were suspended from the wheel of the circling stars; so that the power and the light that should come up from below can be received, and given to the heavenly ones above them. Conversely, whatever will fall from above, whether cold or hot, the wheel of the sphere will also take it and cast it out upon the entire earth, upon all the wood.

Behold, the ordinance of the wheel is in this form. For the powers who are entwined on the wheel are like this: a king mastering his kingdom by this mighty legionary force of all the leaders of the kingdom; and with all the armour of the soldiery that is collected together for him; and also with the mass of the property of the kingdom; and the beautiful lustful aspect of the women who are collected together for

him; together with [all the] property [of the land] and those cattle [and beasts] that have been distributed about among his retinue. Yet, if you ask about that king, he is matched with all his retinue. His retinue, for its part, is matched against his entire kingdom. Judgement shall come forth from him, vindication and condemnation, to his entire kingdom; by his wisdom, skill and strength.

Now, just as for this king, who is matched against the measure of his entire kingdom by his wisdom, skill and strength; so also is it for the powers who are bound on the sphere as compared to the ruling-power, and the powers who exist in the entire zone. Like the king towards his retinue; so too is it that this totality is gathered to the sphere, to seven leaders, to twelve signs of the zodiac. As all the cities are gathered to the king, again they gather to the leaders of the universe. All that is done in the universe above and below: the battles and the disorders and the captivity and the hunger and the lust and the property; so shall they increase and diminish through these leaders. They are the motivaters of the whole created order.

There are three conduits that exist through the entire zone, from the abyss to its heights.

The first conduit is the root of all the powers above, they that exist in all the heavens. They are cast off and fettered on the earths below; because the earth below is the 'stripping off', the garment and the body of the powers that are above the heavens.

For when the Lord of Covenants constructed the heavenly worlds, he divested them of their bodies, [he] threw them to the earths below.

So, the upper worlds are of the soul and the spirit; but the worlds below are of the body and the carcass [of the powers above] Now as for this, he [bound a root from] the powers of heaven; he sealed it on their bodies and their carcasses that are on the earths, so that when life comes up from the fullness of these earths, it can be entirely drawn up to the heights in the roots of what is heavenly, that are fastened in their bodies. And also, all life can be purified in that place.

However, the waste that will be swept from the purified one who ascends to the heights will be let fall to the ground through the conduits of these conduits, and will be poured down [to the depths] and thrown to the underside.

This is the first conduit, which comes from the powers of the heavens to their bodies and their carcasses that are upon the earth; also, from their bodies and [their] carcasses that are on the earths to the powers of the heavens.

The second conduit is the one that comes from the temples and dwellings and cities that exist in the heavens down to the ground, to the five shapes of tree that grow upon the earth. The life comes up from the trees to the temples and cities. Life too, and the residue of the heavenly ones, comes down to the trees in a conduit.

And the third conduit is all the powers and householders who dwell in all the firmaments, whose roots come down from them to the five worlds of flesh that creep upon the earth, being fixed to one another. Now, the power and the life that shall be gathered in from the worlds of flesh are dispersed among them in various shapes. The powers above shall draw them to the upper side through conduits.

[The waste] too, and the lust and the evil-doing and the anger that will be greater in the powers of [heaven], shall be poured to the ground through their various conduits. They shall be discharged upon mankind and the other remaining animals. When what is heavenly will wash the waste and the stench and the poison down on the creations of the flesh below, in their turn the creations shall be greater in lust and anger and evil-doing against each other through the action of their fathers who are on high.

Still, look at the wheel of the stars! It has no [root in this earth], but its roots are bound in the totality. The wheel of stars, then, receives life through the power and the life that ascend from the earths through

conduits and the firmaments above. It (also) takes life from those conduits that receive up to the firmaments and the heavenly worlds above it, it takes life out from that place.

In that the wheel has no root in this earth, from where did the stars and signs of the zodiac find this authority? They became masters over these five fleshes and five trees. Every thing, if it can be reduced from the earth, the heavenly powers above draw it through a conduit. Also, every thing that a person will attain, whether it be wealth that comes into his possession or poverty that will accrue to him, or his sickness and health; he attains it through the signs of the zodiac and the star under which he shall be born.

The wheel has no root therein. It is set aright in its position. For when the Lord of Covenants, the Lord of Covenants, constructed the heavens and the firmaments above, he bound their roots into the earths below; in their carcasses that he had stripped from them. Yet, when he constructed the wheel, [he] did not bind its root into the earths, but he bound the root of the wheel by the sea giant.

And when [the Envoy] came, he displayed his likeness and purified and brought the light out from all [the] heavens. Greed, however, which is present in all the rulers, spurted out against the likeness of the Envoy. It went up in order to reach it, but reached it not. It dropped back and fell to the [underside]. Now, when it had fallen from above, it separated out into three parts.

The first part fell to the wheel; another part fell to the earth; [another part fell to the sea]. [By means] of the part that fell to the sphere, [the root] was bound in the trees and flesh. Therefore, because of this, they received authority and became masters in the five worlds of the flesh and the five worlds of the tree.

Through the nature that came down [upon] the wheel the root was bound in the trees. Also, by means of the abortions that came to the ground, another root was bound in the fleshes.

Therefore, because of this, the stars and signs of the zodiac received authority over the trees and the fleshes: through the root of Sin that fell down; and [the root] of the abortions that were aborted there, they fell to the ground.

However, [these] other conduits that [the Lord of Covenants] has bound in the [earths], they that the soul of the elements comes up through to the heavens; those (conduits) are not bound to the wheel. Rather, they are plundered from them by the powers on the wheel, that hang from it.

The first is the one that comes from the firmaments to the earths, and the one that comes from the wheel to the sea giant. That is only one. So, the other root is the one that comes [from the temples] to the trees. The third is bound by means of the abortions in the [fleshes]; also in the fleshes the fathers of the abortions who are in the heavens [by their roots] are bound and twined, and the [root] that [is bound in them].

About the conduits, the one that is greater than its [partner is so] as more life and soul is drawn [through it] than its partner.

[Great is the root of] the earth from which much life ascends [to the heights] the Lord of Covenants has drawn them. He has fastened them from the powers [above and] he has bound them in the earths. (These conduits) are the roots of the [entire] ruling-power that the life of the living soul is drawn up through, it coming up from the whole earth, from all the mountains, fields and islands.

After that first great root is the root of the trees, which is bound to the temples and the buildings above. For there also is much great life coming up from the tree and the entire Cross, being drawn up from them to the upper side like a great host.

What, however, is lesser [than these] of their conduit [through which] he takes up [life from] the roots [bound in] the earths, they [are present in] the whole earth in all the worlds. Again, these of the trees are present in the whole earth, whether small or great; but the root of mankind [and the fleshes] is

not present in the whole earth, other than only this world of the south. Therefore, even now these fleshes do not make [their dwelling] in the entire world of the south [but rather] there is a small part of them in [the region] of the upper side of the world of the south in [being lesser] in number than the [trees].

They are bound by their [roots and conduits] with one another. They stir one another, they draw life from one another through the action of the powers above, which stirs the nature that dwells in them all.

Now, when the Greed that is in them will be crushed and despoiled, then that Greed too shall [stir up] its members and overturn them and [devour] each other [and shall] stir [the nature in them].

How does the wheel circle over the conduits, which extend from the heavens to the earths, and it not cut them? Or why shall the conduits not get entangled in with the wheel as it circles and drives [onward through the universe]?

The reason that the conduits shall not be cut, for they are not cut, is because they are spiritual. Thus the conduits are like the waters through which ships sail. You shall find the prow that is in position in the front part of the ship divides the waters, casting them back and forth. So, when it parts the waters and that ship opens up the water with its cleaving prow, immediately and without delay the waters mingle with each other again behind the ship; and the path of the ship shall not be discernible in the midst of the waters.

Just as when a bird flies up in the air, for its path is not visible in the air, and in the way of mankind, in the sun within the conduits. They also shall not be tangled up in them, and neither shall you find their path through the air known.

This is also the case with the wheel. It turns through the conduits and the air. The wheel shall not cut the conduits, nor are the conduits themselves entangled in the wheel.

Part 10

The Formation and Redemption of Humanity

The teaching returns to the formation of humanity. Three archetypes (divine good, abundance of truth, receptive forms of wisdom) constitute the infinite proceeding; five garments of truth clothe the Divine for combat, with one truth sufficient yet four added as supports. The essential law is stated: wisdom prevails because it is internally unified, while falsity perishes because it is internally divided. The Lord of Covenants's constructive work is compared to a builder and a carpenter. The formation of mankind through the Envoy's image is explained: the self-derived faculties fashioned Adam and Eve as a counterfeit copy — a reflection in water, not the reality. The Good Mind's entry into the body, binding the proprium, and liberating each of the soul's five faculties is described in exact correspondence. Finally, the diminishment of spiritual capacity across generations is explained through five degrees of governing dominion, and the four griefs of the external truths trace the trajectory from first combat through final separation.

Three Archetypes and the Five Garments of Combat

Primary Teaching

Three degrees of spiritual proceeding — divine good, abundance of truth, and receptive forms of wisdom — exist infinitely in the divine realm, active in combat and redemption, and arranged within the heavenly kingdom under three governing principles. One truth-garment of celestial love was sufficient to subdue evil, yet four were added (spiritual thought, natural truth, understanding, rational life) as supports so that falsity would not overwhelm celestial love. The essential law: wisdom prevails because it is internally unified (no truth departs from the order committed to it), while falsity perishes because it is internally divided (each selfish affection seeks its own supremacy). Lord Wisdom's hunt is described: capturing evil's deliberate intentions while leaving the storehouses behind, as fish are drawn from a marsh while stagnant water and reeds remain.

This one, a name is given to him in the world. For people pronounce it with their mouths: 'god', 'rich one', and 'angel'. Who are they? Who are the gods? Or who are the rich ones? Or who are the angels? Who are these [three] archetypes?

There are these three archetypes [in the land of light, and there is no measure to] them!

So, the ones who are called 'god', are the gods whom the Father has summoned from himself. He has established them after the likeness of his greatness.

Conversely, these who are named 'rich [ones'], are the evocations of the first rich gods of the Father; because, when the Father had summoned (the first), they themselves summoned evocations. They called them 'rich'.

They too, the rich ones, have summoned their evocations. They call them 'angel'. These are the three archetypes who occur in the land of light. There is no measure to apply to them!

Other persons who are named 'god' are the emanations who have come from the Father; the evocations of the Father whom he summoned forth. They came out to the contest and humiliated the enmity.

Conversely, the 'rich ones' are the evocations of these first living words. They too, the rich ones, have come and performed and fulfilled the pleasure of the greatness, in the worlds that are above and below.

On the other hand, the ones who are named the 'angels' are the evocations of the rich ones, who had come from the three living words. They have been sent in an embassy and an apostolate to this building. They have come to the entire divinity, which is established in silence and in hiddenness. And, also, they have come to all the souls who have been entangled in the enemy. They have brought them hope and confidence.

Again, they are called 'god', all the gods who belong to the household of the Great Spirit.

Conversely, the ones who are called 'angel', are all the angels who belong to the household of the King of Radiance.

The ones who are called 'rich', are all the rich ones who belong to the household of the glorious Envoy.

When [Lord Wisdom] came forth against the [enemy, clothed in a] garment [against] the Darkness with the garment of [the] living fire. With that garment he withered the tumescence (?) of the enemy; he brought down [its] foolery and its vanity.

Now, this one alone was sufficient for them. [Yet], [since] the living fire was weakened, because of this he added [to it another four] garments: that of the wind, that of the water, that of the light, and that of the [air]. And this, (why) has he given the four? He gave them [so that] they would be [helpers] to [that] god, [which is] the living fire; so that [the enemy would] not with [in] the living [fire], and penetrate it; and [the poison] and the [enmity] cut it off.

While the fire received a [blow and] a wound in its body; yet still, [were weakened] all the powers of [Darkness] because of it [Yet also] It [was of] necessity [for its] brothers, to cause them to receive a blow and a [wound too]. The power of the enemy mixed in with them. [Rather, except the air]. The Darkness did not mix in with it, nor was the burning of the enemy able to penetrate it.

Never-theless, even the one that remained behind without the wound, which is the air, it stripped off garment and power. It gave it to its [four] brothers in its place; so that by that [garment] of the living air they would become strong, and [receive] profit, and endure, namely its other four brothers. And it [became] for them [a spirit of] life.

[Now as to what affects the] light, behold, at the beginning the Darkness was strong against it; [for] no disunity [or discord] exists in the light.

[See then] how far [extends the light] that came forth from [the Greatness] in that place in a [unity] alone [abiding in] the greatness of the light with one another for ever, and nor did one of them transgress the command and order that his brother had entrusted to him forever.

However, the Darkness, the enemy, was doomed and overcome; because of the arising of disharmony it was divided within itself. Even the kingdom was divided within itself; [and even] the [powers, who had] left their abyss behind and come up [follow-ing] it, were doomed because of the disunity that was present in all of them. The Darkness was destroyed, and its other powers were humiliated.

At the time when Lord Wisdom was sent to the war in the first garment of [living fire], which he gave to the first nature that exists [...] in that single garment. [By it] he hunted Greed, the thought of death, [its rulers] and all its other powers.

When Lord Wisdom came up from the abyss, [...] the Lord of Covenants brought the rulers whom he had hunted [from every] element, that [substance] of [the land of] darkness, that he might construct from them this universe and fashion everything appropriate for the greatness. From that time on, the place of the storehouses of the elements [was left behind, and] he destroyed and laid waste the [land and] all that were in it.

Just like a marsh, of which the fish and birds are snared in a net, and only the waters are left behind and the reeds and the plants that grow in it, this is also the case with the storehouses of death. [Lord Wisdom] snared their counsels and [their kin] that were [in them], and the storehouses were left behind in their [dwelling] place.

So then, the case of the land of darkness is like this, as is that of the storehouses that were in it.

Just as the body of man has many limbs in it, [the land of darkness] has [storehouses from] its beginning [like] all [the limbs] that hang from the great head of the [body]. A single root is the root of them all, because they all hang from the great head that is on top of the body. Should a limb be cut from the tip of [these] small [heads], the great head that is on top of them [all] stays in its place the way that it is [and still] you find this person alive. [All] these [small heads] are firmly set in it [...].

[When] they will cut from them [the limbs of] all of them, these little [heads] shall [become] the corpses, because they might see [that they] be firmly set [...] in the body, which they joined [with it ...].

In exactly this way, it is also the case that the storehouses of darkness are the same, the things from which the [darkness gushed] forth.

The Formation of Mankind

Primary Teaching

Two teaching streams converge. First: the Lord of Covenants's constructive work is compared to a builder who constructs a dwelling for the king and to a carpenter who perceives what each piece of unformed natural good may become. Second: the formation of Adam and Eve through the Envoy's image. When Divine Truth displayed the form of the Divine Human, the self-derived faculties perceived it and fashioned their own will and understanding after its likeness — but as a reflection in water, not in genuine reality. The free woman parable illustrates: a noble celestial affection of truth comes forth from her interior dwelling not from vain display but only from the constraint of love for the divine life entrapped in the natural. The Envoy came not to show his likeness to rulers but because of the divine life bound and spread in the totality.

At the time when [Lord Wisdom] went down] he gave the leadership to his five [sons. Then [the Lord of Covenants] and the Bounteous Spirit [came down] as the entire ruling-power is entwined and bound and spread [in the Darkness, and] they were poured out and mixed with each other, the light with the Darkness and the Darkness with the light.

At that time the Lord of Covenants called one of his sons, one rich with power. He gave to him the leadership of the garments. Now, he himself [received the command] of [the garments, and] he hung them and set them up [by the command] of the Lord of Covenants [who sent him. And] he set up all things [in the heights, and] he opened [out the] ten firmaments [and he set] the wheel of the stars [above] them and the [luminaries].

The Lord of Covenants is like this: Just as [a builder] and an architect who might build a dwelling for the king, and divide it up into separate houses and [separate rooms, and provides] everything that is required for beauty [in every room] and he cleans them. And also the stones [he shapes] them for beauty and loveliness, and he arranges them and makes them so that should the king come and inhabit that palace, he might glorify him.

Furthermore, the Lord of Covenants resembles a wise and skilled carpenter [who finds a piece of wood] before it was worked [or shaped, and] before it was established and made beautiful and [useful. This] carpenter [knows what it shall become, and] works in it, but [it is] in him in his [thought and] in his understanding, and he brings the saw and the adze, and cuts it into separate pieces [and he trims] it and he pulls the [roughness from] it with the plane and he smooths it. He shall make many [kinds of] wooden implements, arranging them shape by shape; he cuts and produces wooden implements from it, wooden implements of different kinds, (such as) dishes, bowls. This wood, that [had no form] since previously it had not been worked before it was sealed by [the skill] and wisdom of this dextrous carpenter. He cut it up into different sorts of implements useful to his master.

So is it also with the Lord of Covenants. In his wisdom he has [formed all things] in limbs [and built the] palace [and placed all things] in it or in a [vessel] useful [to him. He made] the ships of light [and] all the other works [that he established] in the [universe] so that when the great king comes, he who is the Envoy, who [shall come to it] he might dwell in this universe [and purify it].

[And all things shall] live. The light, however, that is in it [he who is] wise, and he takes it up to the land; but the waste and the Darkness will be gathered and thrown down to the abyss.

There are some among us telling us that we [know and perceive] that the (Envoy) consents about [that figure] of flesh; he who shall be [fashioned in the flesh] at another time. And next, he says: [The Envoy] displayed his likeness in the [universe]. The rulers and the powers of the universe saw [his likeness], and they formed their shapes after his likeness, who are Adam and Eve. Behold, you see that

god [consents] to its happening; because of this, he has displayed his likeness to the rulers; and they constructed [mankind after his likeness.] If he was not consenting to humankind, he would not have uncovered his likeness, nor they fashioned mankind after his likeness!

Regarding the Envoy, the occasion when he came displaying his likeness, he [did] not come so [that] he might reveal his likeness to the [rulers] in the universe. Rather, he came and displayed to the universe [because of his] soul and his son, who is [mixed in] every [place], that he might enable him to live [again] and make for him a release; and to free (the soul) from every bond and all the fetters, in which it is entangled and bound.

The rulers and the authorities, in that they had no form in [the likeness of] him, they lusted for his likeness. They reflected upon themselves, that [they] had no [form] like him in their creation. They sealed [his likeness] in their heart, within their soul. [Afterwards, they] built it according to his likeness; they formed Adam and [Eve]. They sealed the likeness of the Exalted One in their [soul]. So, they [copied] with an imitation; but they have not [copied in] truth! Rather, just as [an image that is seen in water,] it is made as these, for [it] came [from the likeness] but it is not [like] him in truth. [Again, so too] is this figure of [mankind. They copied] it against the likeness of the Exalted One [but not in truth].

Similarly the [tree], for while it is like the [image, it is] not [copied] in truth.

This [matter is comparable to] this: As a great, [free] woman [who dwells] within her [palace, and she is] rich in wealth [and many possessions]; she is also beautiful in her beauty, and is virtuous in her modesty. She walks in a free and reputable position. The fame of her beauty has spread in every [city]. She [surpasses every woman] Behold [her] chamber [is closed to every] one who is mad, because [of] the nobles and the great ones. [Also], they lust for her beautiful face. They did not [reach] her, because she is hidden in her palace [and guarded] within in a [secret place. None could] meet that woman [except through] his [son]; or rather the head [covering ofhat] garment. This free woman shall [not willingly] leave the [chamber] behind her and come to the street [and uncover] her head [and her veil] and she reveals her [face and her beauty to all] because of her beloved [brother]. This [woman], on whom no man ever looked, nor did they ever see her [face], as she neither desires nor rejoices [in outward display. She would not] leave her chamber behind her, and come in the midst of mankind [that all might see her] and everyone view her. The [honest] men and the nobles, even the servants too, and the [lowly ones] look at her.

In accord with this simile: Again, [this] too [is] how [it is that] the Envoy becomes [manifest in the universe] as this free woman [came forth, not] according to wantonness, in pride, nor [because she consented] to the outer world, she [came forth from her chamber with grief], she revealed her face and her [beauty to all] but only due to the constraint of grief [about] her [beloved one].

Now, this too is the way of the Envoy, when he came and [displayed his] image with a show towards all the powers. [He did] not [come] so that all the rulers and the [authorities] would sculpt a form [after his] likeness. [Rather], he came because of his son being bound and spread in the totality; [for] he would release him, free him, and rescue him from oppres-sion. Yet, when the rulers looked [on] him, [they] lusted for his likeness. They fashioned after his [likeness] Adam and Eve, without the consent of the [greatness].

For, [as] with Adam and Eve, whom the rulers fashioned and [sealed] after the likeness of the Exalted One, so too this [is] how a manifold divinity and many powers and angels [also received] the stamp of that likeness, which was displayed to them. For, in the majesty of the [light] and (the image's) love, they glowed with their desire and they were undone. [They] were eager for their lust; like a [man who looks] to the majesty of a lusted after face, and [is undone] and he is eager for the [fire] of the desire.

This is [also] the case with those powers, when they looked on that majestic and beautiful [image], they () [lusted for] a first image. They received the stamp of [that likeness], which was displayed to them.

They copied [its appearance, but thatich they copied] out in a likeness, it being made [into outward forms, not in truth. And] the ones that they had put forth, which had received a [stamp of this likeness]; but inward even to the rocks [and the stones of the earth,] which occur from place to place. The [stamp] of that likeness, which was displayed in the universe [spread to all, and] they received a stamp, it being revealed there, and an impress.

Now, this new birth that they begot in a new [form] in the world, is Adam and Eve. [There is not a] form in their world since the beginning like it; because that [image occurs] not in the worlds [below].

Not all the figures that have been fashioned were fashioned by birth from displayed intercourse. Rather, there are other figures fashioned [in another way].

One of them is the sea [giant], the 'sweeping' from the sphere, which [the Lord of Covenants] discharged into the sea. Its own fire and thought fashioned it [in] a figure.

The second figure is the one [that] fell to the earth. It made the sea its womb. Its own [lust] became its sculptor. It alone fashioned it to a nature, which is the root of death. Yet, when it came up from the sea, it [rose up] that it might destroy the works [of [the Lord of Covenants]. They immediately sent against it the Life-Champion, the great 'instruction of vigour'. He humbled it in the districts of the north. He has trampled underfoot and set [himself] upon it, until the end of the world.

[The] third figure is the nature that fell on [what] is [dry. It] fashioned the tree and set itself there. [This is the] new figure that was fashioned [from within, and itisplays].

So, in accord with the essence they [are ofness]; but yet [they] did not come with the [Evil Spirit to the world]. Rather, their fashioning [came] about [by other means, and] they are composite and have been displayed in the world.

The Good Mind's Liberation of the Soul

Primary Teaching

The most detailed teaching on the mechanics of individual regeneration. The concupiscence that saw the Envoy's image descended, generated perceptions, and entered the ruling self-loves who fashioned Adam and Eve. The formative power placed within the will and understanding faculties for reception and activity — five capacities (intellectual sight, obedient reception, interior discernment, experiential taste, direct touch) each with their own memory-stores. The governing affections guard the entrances. When Divine Wisdom descends, the ruling evils resist entry, but wisdom humbles them. It loosens the understanding from falsity, releases thought, perception, will, and wisdom — binding the corresponding evil members in their place. Five great living faculties are placed in the regenerated person: love, faith, perfection, patience, wisdom. The proprium is imprisoned, the Bounteous Spirit reigns, yet affliction may still arise from time to time.

All [these abortions], amongst them are the Fool and his consort and the ones whom they have served [...], they are the ones that shaped Adam and Eve. How did they find this beautiful image laid over their shape, even though when it was displayed to their fathers they were not in existence? They never saw the likeness of the Envoy! And how did they take the seal of the likeness of the Envoy? They added it to [the] shape of Adam and Eve.

The Sin that spurted out from the rulers, which is Greed, shot up [towards] the likeness of the Envoy. It was cut off from [that] place and came down to the earth, for they did not accept [it within] the firmaments. When it came [down to] the earth, it formed the tree. It was established within the wood and formed the fruits. And when [the] abortions fell [to] the ground, to the earth, at the [second] time [... / ...].

[When it came up] fruits, it assumed [them] and spoke in the ruler, their leader. He says to his companions: Come! Give me your light, and I will construct for you an image [after] the likeness of the exalted one. What he said, they did: they gave it to him, and he constructed [the image].

The Sin that [spurted out ... / ...] which is the Greed that saw the [image of the Envoy] and that formed the [tree and was established in it]; afterwards it came up in the [and assumed them]. It went in to the rulers [and] they formed Adam and Eve after the [likeness of the exalted one]. Through the energy of the Sin that had [seen the image of [the Envoy], it went into the (rulers) [through the fruits. It] assumed them and they [too sculpthem. And they] begat each of them according to his destiny [...]; one he resembles, one he does not resemble.

The moulder placed in the form of Adam and Eve limbs, outside and within, for perception and activity. He was apportioned house by house. For everything that his perceptions and elements will receive externally there are internal storehouses and repositories and cavities; and what is received in to them is stored in them. Whenever they will be questioned about what is deposited in their internal storehouses, they bring out what they have received within and give it to the questioner who requested it of them.

In this way his faculty [...] outer [limbs] to look at [and receive] every type with [in ...].

Also [the faculty] of the eyes [has] houses and cavities and repositories and stores within, so that every image it might see, whether good or evil, whether loveable or detestable or lustful, it can receive into its storehouses and repositories. Also, when the faculty of the eyes is pleased to send out the image that it saw and took in, it can go in to its storehouses [at the] time and think and seek [after it] and it brings it out [and] gives it to the questioner who requested it and the one who [wanted] it—whether it be something from [luand desire, or an] image of love [or ... / ... something] hateful. And thus shall that

faculty (of the eyes) produce and do what it does in each category.

The faculty of the ears has its own storehouses also. Every sound it might receive, whether good or evil, shall be taken in and placed in its houses and inner repositories, and it is guarded in its [places] for a thousand days. After a thousand days, if someone comes and asks that faculty about the sound that it heard [at] this time and took into its storehouses, immediately it [shall go] into its repositories and seek and review and search after this word, and send it out from where it was first put, the place in which it was kept.

[In] like order, the faculty of scent [shall] function just as that of the eyes and that of the auditory organs. Every [odour] it shall smell it shall take in [to it] and [deposit] in its inner storehouses. Every time it will be [asked] by a questioner, it shall go in [to its repositories] and [search its] storehouse and remember [...] only these things.

However, even the mouth and the tongue within it, and the taste organ, have a faculty dwelling in them. Again, that faculty too, of taste, has thus cavities and repositories set apart for it. It too receives these tastes and gathers them in. [And] at any moment when someone will ask of a taste, if [it has received it] it shall send it out and remember [that] taste. It shall snare and give even the [mark of that] taste; give its memory to the [questioner] who asks for it.

Again, the [faculty] of touch by the hands is also [so]: When it might touch, touch shall [receive its] memory. And it [takes] it in to its inner repository [until someone] will ask this faculty for the memory. [Immediately], it shall go in again and bring out the memory of this touch that it made, and give it to whoever asks for it.

And the faculty of the heart that rules over them all is much the most like this. Every thing that these five faculties will receive and put in store for the faculty of the heart it shall receive and guard. Any time that they will ask for their deposit it shall send out and give every thing that they gave to it.

For the counsel of the heart is like the king. All the [advisers] of his city and the leaders of his [army] are placed with him. Any time if his [generals] will entreat him for whatever they wish, he shall give them the [advice] and opinion by which they move.

Furthermore, it is like a cellarman: [Every] thing that will be entrusted to it by them, and given to it, it shall receive and put in separate vessels and places. Any time [... / ...].

[It shall find it] in the place that it put it.

This also is the way of the faculty of the body. The vision that the eyes will see and give to it, and it receives it in, it shall bring out again from the storehouses wherein it had placed it; and give it to whoever asks for it.

Again, [the] sound that the ears will hear and give to it, and it receives it from them. At any time when someone will ask it for that sound, it shall bring out and give the sound of the ears to whoever has asked it for that sound. It shall bring out and give the sound of the ears to whoever has asked.

Again, [the] faculty of smell in this same pattern; and that of taste is of the same [type]. The touch by the [hands ... / ...] they shall bring it out in to [... / ...] And whenever they will [ask it] for it, it shall bring it out and [give it].

Indeed, watchmen are [at] these doors guarding them, and bolts are fastened on the doors at the hands of the guards that guard them!

Just like watchmen guarding a camp with towers and watch-posts. As the holding rooms come out from there and the bolts are upon the gates, the guards control the bolts of the gates while they sit at the entrance [of] the watchposts. So, someone who belongs to their city as a fellow [citizen] of them, belonging to their country, for him they shall open [the gate] and receive him in by their will. However,

the foreigner who comes they shall prevent, and leave him standing at the gate. They shall not yield to let him enter. Again, another one whom they will receive in, with great trouble before [they] take him in, you shall find many holding rooms [... / ...] that [...] there are a mass [... / ...] them. The number of [door] bolts [upon the gates] are [many] Whenever someone will wish [...] the bolts at his hand, opens the gate and brings out whoever is hidden within.

This body too is like the mighty camp. And the gates of the camp with their guards are like the orifices and organs of the body. Now, the orifices of the body are of sight, hearing and smell; and they that send out words. There are many sentinels and a mass of guards placed over the limbs of the body, guarding their orifices. And the faculty in it is the directive of the body, the queen of the entire camp; so that whenever it wishes it can open, or when it wishes it can shut.

However, if and [when] the Good Mind comes, it shall [turn in] to the orifices of the body. The rulers, who [are] the door [guards], shall [hinder] and restrain it from [entering]. They shall bind the [circuit] of the body so that the [foreigner] can not enter it.

Nevertheless, the Good Mind by its wisdom and awe and diligence shall [humble] the guards who are set at the body's orifices. When it finishes humbling them it shall take [from] them bolts to all the orifices of the body. Now, the orifices that had been opened before to the parades of lust, to receive in the sights of pleasure, to transfer the [words] of the practice of [life's] concerns, to receive in the [tastes] of the different foods and unclean meals together with the sin therein; whoever stops receiving [this] in, his heart and mind shall follow after.

By the power of the Good Mind that has suffused him and lived in the body he has humbled Lust, the goddess of the body.

[Simply], all orifices in similar fashion were opening at one time to wickedness, but now have opened to the good. Sin was ruling in the body this time, doing anything it liked, having none in command.

Yet, [now], authority has been taken from the Sin in the [organs] of the body. The Lord of Covenants has become lord over all its limbs. It has bound them with a chain of peace, and sealed them with the seal of truth. It has opened the orifices of the body to the good, and because of this the good enters them through the ears and the eyes. It dwells in the heart. [The Bounteous Spirit] reigns. It does all that it pleases. It annuls [the] will of [Sin], the begin-ning and the end. [In contrast], the will of [the Bounteous Spirit] comes about, and the purpose of the Good Mind.

The Diminishment of the Generations and the Four Weepings

Primary Teaching

Two teachings. First: why later generations are lesser. Five degrees of governing dominion rule in succession — the complete celestial state, states of spiritual change, states of natural illumination, states of particular influx, states of momentary perception. In the earliest eras, the powers governing complete celestial states held sway, producing abundant and enduring spiritual offspring; as dominion passed to lesser degrees, spiritual capacity diminished until people today produce scarcely one offspring from a single interior state. Second: the Bounteous Spirit grieves because her living affections are conjoined with falsity, and Lord Wisdom grieves because his five faculties are beset by assault. The external truths passed through four griefs: perceiving the oncoming evil, being left behind when the Celestial Human ascended, seeing the Lord of Covenants depart after stripping the operative truths, and — the worst — grieving at the final consummation for souls permanently severed from peace.

About Adam, the first man. When he was fashioned, how did they sculpt him? Or, how did they beget him? Rather, is his begetting like the begetting that is brought forth today, amongst humankind; or not? Does a distinction exist between his birth and the one that they bring forth today?

Now, [note] that Adam is mighty in his stature, and great is his size. Even his years are many! He spent many years living in the world. And he is not the only one we have found to be mighty; but all the others who were begotten in his generation, many are their years too. Still, these people who are born today, their stature has been diminished in power; even their years are lessened. Also, why is the birth today, of [they] who are born, altered compared with that of these first [generations, from] place to place? See, even the stars and signs of the zodiac continue in their positions. Why now have the age and the years of these last ones diminished, and he has also become smaller, compared to these ancient ones who belong to these first generations?

They increased, have turned, and diminished; because there are five types of authorities and leaders appointed in the sphere of zodiacal signs, and the heavens above it. They have names they are [called] by: the first name is the year; the [second] is the month; the third is the day; the [fourth] is the hour; the fifth is the moment. Now, these five positions, and these five houses, exist in the sphere and the heavens. These places have five powers, and they are made masters over them. The master of the year exists; the master of the month exists; the master of the day exists; the master of the hour exists; the master of the moment exists. In turn one is above his companion; and in turn the one above is made the master over the one below him.

So, mankind is begotten, and [the animals]. They are born in these powers. And, thus, these powers have received authority since the beginning of creation till the end of the world. Now, in the beginning of the generations the powers who were masters over the years reigned. Therefore, because of this, the offspring born in their generations and their lifetime: their years were found to be greater. They attain a long life span in the generation of Adam, and [that] of Sethel his son, and that of the ones who came after him.

After they ceased to reign, namely the powers who are masters over the years; the powers who are masters over the months themselves reigned. Like the months, for they are less than the years; again this [is] also the case with the offspring [who were] born in them. Their life span is less [than the life span of the ones born] in the generation of the powers who master the years!

When the authority of the powers who master the months was completed; the powers of the days received authority after them. Therefore, like the days, for they are less than the months, this also is the

case with the offspring who were born in them. Their life span is less than the life span of the ones born in the powers who are masters over the months. Again, even so the offspring who were born in the hours, and of the moments. Their conduit is less than that of the months and the days.

The life span of the people has drawn in to nothing. Their days have diminished. Their years have become less; because the life and the [light that] was in the world in these first generations was more than that of today. Indeed, because of this have they diminished in their stature. Their life span has become less for them.

By what sort of birth was the entire offspring of mankind made from one man and one woman, Adam and Eve?

For the manner of these first generations is that they are richer in their light and purer in stature. Even their years are greater. Thus, again, even their offspring is much more than the offspring of this [time]. They were spending a longer time [being fashioned] in [the womb] of their mother. Afterwards, they [brought forth] a number in a single womb. There are times five were brought forth from a single womb, and times six were brought forth from [a] single womb! There are some lesser than this; again, some greater than this. Indeed, because of this the offspring of Eve multiplied, and of her children. The earth was filled by reason of them alone.

For, they whom they beget today, in these last generations, they stand diminished and maimed. And, indeed, one by one do they [bring them forth] from a single womb. Hardly two, or [less] or more. They are even made ugly in their aspect, being diminished in their size, and feeble in their limbs.

The first who grieves is the first the Bounteous Spirit. She is sad because of her children who are set in affliction, for they were conjoined with the Darkness and the [poison]. They have been bound with the entire ruling-power. For what was she grieving, [watching] over them taking these afflictions? Whenever she might [see] them and how suffering is brought upon them, she shall grieve and be unhappy on account of them.

[The second] one who is troubled of heart is Lord Wisdom, whose [greatness] and kingdom is established in the [light] ship [of the moon]. And he too is troubled of heart because of his five sons who are set in the midst of danger. For any time he may see that they are given trouble, always he might hear the sound of their weeping as they cry out because of the blows and wounds of the enemy who assaults them daily; and as he sees them like this constantly, he shall [grieve] and mourn on account of his [sons].

The garments, the sons of Lord Wisdom, wept bitterly three times. Then they were silent. There is a fourth time of weeping, for they will weep at the end. And then their crying can stop, and they will never again weep from this time on.

Now, the first time of their weeping is when they had seen the darkness, the enemy being about to burst out against them. They understood everything that would happen to them. They were aware of the one that would rise and come upon them, but by necessity they hastened to him and fought with him. They mastered him, they detained him. They bound him with their body and their limbs, they overcame his death and his fire and his darkness.

[The] second time that they wept is [when their] father, Lord Wisdom, [ascended] from the [abyss] of darkness and left them behind; that is the time when he stripped [them off] and left them below. Indeed, when [they saw] how Lord Wisdom had risen out of the abyss and [left] them behind, and that they were abandoned in the [enmity, they] wept and were sore of heart. Still, what could they do, wishing [to go up after him? Yet by necessity they gave] their heart to every affliction. They [remained behind] and grew [sick] under the pressure of the weighty burden of all the works, until the end time.

[The] third time that they wept is when the Lord of Covenants stripped off the three garments of activity, placing them beneath all things. He gave them a sign to lift their heads and rise to the heights

from that place; and to pass and journey through all the earths until they should reach the land of [tranquillity] and peace, the place of rest prepared for them. So, when they had seen him, that he had separated himself from them, while they themselves remained behind after him and had not ascended; at that moment when they stayed behind these three garments wept. After their crying, they turned their [heart] to all the heights that were concealed from them, and were of one mind. For [they would] soar up and come to the heights; and pass over all things until the time that was ordained for them all [should come] at the end of the worlds.

[The fourth] time when they will weep is when [the Final Body] will be taken up on the last day, and they will weep [for] the souls of the liars and blasphemers; for they may give [them no help] because their limbs have been severed [and given to the powers] of the darkness. And also [those] souls, when the Final Body will go up and they are left [alone], they will weep in that they will [remain] behind in affliction for ever. For they [will be cut off] and separated from the Final Body. [And it is] a necessity to take these souls who are ready for loss as retribution for the deeds that they have done. They go [in to] this [darkness] and are bound with the Darkness; just as they desired it and loved it, and placed their treasure with it. At that very moment, when the Final Body rises up, [they will] weep. And then they will scream out loud because they will be severed from the company of this great Statue. And they remain behind for ever. This great weeping [and separation] is terrible, it occurs in front of the souls and [the spirits] who are ready for loss in accordance with their deeds. And they [will] weep with that crying, they will never be silent; because they will not attain rest from this time on.

So, they too are the garments of these elements. This fourth time of weeping is heart-rending for them. It is much worse for them than these other three times of weeping before. This fourth time the weeping is not for themselves. Rather they weep and are heartsore for these [souls] who will be cut off from peace, because rest will not come about for them, to allow them to rest from torment for ever.

Part 11

Correspondences in Nature and the Body

The teaching turns to natural correspondence. The body is read as a map of the spiritual world: hidden and visible, the tongue as the Kingdom of Wisdom revealing all things. The power of the garment of waters (divine truth) is measured against the immensity of infernal rulers. Three foundational truths (the sustaining pillar, the regenerated natural mind, and divine perception) are established. Love and hate are defined in their spiritual essences. Three things distinguish the Most Ancient Church above all other forms: the received divine image, the organization through five faculties, and the inscription of the correspondence of the entire spiritual world. Seven reasons the proprium fashioned the natural human are given. The sun and moon receive extensive treatment as Divine Love and Divine Truth — seven goods of the day, seven evils of the night, five archetypal qualities, three further mysteries, and two profound arcana of influx and withdrawal. Five works of fire (love), the complete zodiacal order of twelve governing evils and five ruling affections, the body as microcosm with its four worlds and zodiacal signs, and the ascending chain by which all elements are gathered degree by degree back into the Divine — all complete this richly correspondential part.

The Body as Correspondence and Three Foundational Truths

Primary Teaching

The body's hidden and visible limbs correspond to hidden and manifest aspects of the divine order. The directive hidden within is like the Father hidden in His kingdom; the two visible eyes are like the two light ships; the living soul grasped and struck is like the body that receives blows; the tongue that reveals everything is like the Kingdom of Wisdom who manifests all things. The garment of waters (divine truth) is measured against infernal rulers of immeasurable magnitude. Three foundational truths are established: the sustaining power of divine wisdom (Hearkening extending from earth to heaven), the regenerated natural mind established over the mind of falsity, and the divine perception proceeding from Divine Truth in its glory — each set in a distinct degree.

Just as the corporeal body has limbs that are hidden, so it also has others that are visible. They can be seen upon it, they can be grasped and receive blows and wounds, whilst others can neither be grasped nor receive blows.

So it is also with this entire greatness, as we resemble it. Some of it is hidden, whilst some of it is visible; some of it is far away from the blows and suffering, whilst some of it receives blows and wounds.

Now, thus the directive of the body that lives within, hidden in the storehouses inside the body and unseen. So it is also how the Father, the God of truth, exists; as he too is hidden in his kingdom, not displayed before this outer desolation.

Thus, too, the body has two eyes that are visible and seen, and are even the body's source of illumination; so there are also these two light ships that shine and are seen in the entire universe and the whole of creation. The light has never been hidden, just like the two eyes of the body.

The living soul too is like this; it is established in apparent silence. In its apparent silence it is grasped and receives blows from these five fleshes, which destroy (the soul) and strike it. It can be likened to the mystery of the corporeal body, as it can be grasped and mastered, can receive blows and wounds.

Also, thus this tongue that speaks, proclaims, reprimands and reveals about everything happening in this body, inside and outside, also the considerations and bodily knowledges. The tongue, which is outside, makes it manifest. It also proclaims about the honour and shame of the body. And it speaks, unveiling the pain of the body that is sick from its sores.

This is also what the Kingdom of Wisdom is like, who shall be sent from the greatness. He manifests and reveals about everything, both the external and the internal, both what is above and what is below. Be it about the outer aeons that are hidden and not displayed, or about the ships of light that are seen: he is the one who unveils about them. He is also the one who reveals about their glory, and the greatness that dwells in them.

And regarding this beating and wounding of the living soul, the Kingdom of Wisdom is the one who reveals it. He also preaches about (the soul) and its peace. He also reveals about its cleansing and healing.

How great is the power of the garment of the waters? How far shall [it extend]? The source from which all these waters burst forth, how great will it be?

[At] the time when Lord Wisdom assumed the elements, and stood [firm] against the first enmity that had come about in the Darkness, he defied these great and powerful rulers. They are immeasurable,

greater than the extent or size of thousands and ten thousands of parasangs. At the start, when he spread the fight against them, he gave them fire and wind; and afterwards he gave the garment of the waters to the rulers of death. So they, the rulers, drank in and consumed those waters. Many [waters] poured forth from the garment of waters [from which] the rivers flow. The mouth of the rulers [devoured] those [waters], the warriors of destruction [and they] laboured and brought them forth.

There were seven (rivers) flowing in to the mouth of each one of them, as they shall not [suffice] to a single stomach, to their fill; because in turn the descent to its stomach shall burn them with its fire and heat. Those rulers were like the [depths] of [the sea]; they were not emptied; rain and [rivers throughout] their existent days.

The measure of that river was expanded seven times, as they flow [out] of the body of the [living] waters [until] now.

[This] is how great a struggle, since it has [overcome] these creatures of destruction, the mighty giants. Behold, they are entwined, bound, and [sealed] in every place. They are hidden, not revealed before the eyes of every flesh that exists on the land of death [and darkness]. These rulers [shall be] revealed. The entire universe of flesh will be destroyed and dissolved [with them]; all pass away [and perish]. They will be destroyed with their angry voice, which is mightier than the thunder.

This small stream is reckoned [as nothing] before the vastness of these waters. For only one river from thousands of rivers of water, from the secrets that are not revealed, is the river Tigris upon the earth.

Three great rocks, which exist, were appointed by the greatness. They were set in these outer worlds.

So, the first rock is [Hearkening], Hearkening, which was summoned [by [the glorious Envoy]. He set it in this zone; [and he] brought forth its base (?) from the earth to heaven. It bore up under the [entire universe], and became first of all the weight-carriers in [its] powers. In its firmness it has been set upright, and has made fast every [thing] above and below.

[The] second great and glorious rock is the new earth of light, which was set upon the earth of Darkness. It has squashed the fastenings of the five storehouses of death. It has established firmness, with great firmness, over and beyond the earth of Darkness. It has flattened, crushed and fixed the root of death.

[The] third rock is the great thought, which was summoned from the Kingdom of Wisdom, the glorious one. It has stood firm, with a true fixity, for ever.

[These] are the three great rocks, they that have come forth in great confidence, in three great and honoured places. They were appointed and distributed in three great places of these [selfsame] worlds. They were made fast according to the will of the greatness.

Love, Hate, and the Three Things in Adam

Primary Teaching

Love is defined: the Divine Itself and its Love are one indivisible life — the Divine has given itself forth into all things. Hate is defined: the primal spiritual death that consumed its own offspring and assaulted what was utterly foreign to it, continuing to bring devastation upon every natural will. Three things distinguish the Most Ancient Church: the received divine likeness surpassing all other forms, the organization through five faculties corresponding to the true ordering of goods and truths, and the inscription of the correspondence of the entire spiritual world within it. Seven reasons the proprium fashioned the natural human: as a vessel of reflected wisdom, to appropriate divine wisdom, to profane divine good through the divine likeness, as a generative pattern, as a vehicle displaying all capacities, as a defense through the divine form, and to seize complete dominion.

What is love? [Love is the Father.He has been revealed to] each [aeon], calling it 'love'.

Love is Boundless Time, who dwells in his glorious land. The entirety of the divine has been revealed [therein]! These two are a single living body, the Father and his love; because he has given himself for every thing, as he exists in his aeons. Indeed, due to this, they called the Father, the Lord of the totality, 'love'. For he gave the victory to his aeons and his limbs.

What, conversely, is hate? Hate is the first death that welled up. It revealed the land of Darkness. This one called 'hate', because it has ruined all its perdition's offspring; it sinned even against a power foreign to it, and ruined it. Due to this they shall call it 'hated'; for it has caused destruction, both wounding in flesh, and what is not its own.

Today again it causes wounding and destruction in all flesh. It kills them all with diverse deaths; these that are displayed today in every thing, in every type. Even the Bound Radiance, the living soul, likewise too it ruins and kills them; as it did at the start. Indeed, due to this have they called it 'hated', this one from the hated; the envy from the envy; the devil from the devil; the bad that came about from the bad.

Three great things that are distinct were revealed in Adam the first human. Indeed, due to this, he was found to be better and more outstanding than the conjoined powers that are in heaven and on earth.

The first: The image of the exalted one was placed upon him. The creators and moulders of his body sealed him after the shining form of the image that had been displayed to them above. Indeed, due to this, the image of Adam was found to be surpassingly beautiful beyond any conjoined power above and below.

The second thing: Adam was shaped in his structure through the light of the first-born of heaven and [earth, and through] the five sons. Indeed, due to this, his structure was found to differ from the structure of even the other creations; [since] the form of all creations is different. As for Adam, the formation of his soul fits over the correct distribution of the elements. Therefore, he has intelligence surpassing that of the other creations and beasts.

The third are the teachings and counsels and the seal of all the powers above and below. The creators, who set him in order, gathered them and sealed them in him. Adam and his consort Eve became a dwelling and home for the signs of the zodiac and the stars; and the months, the days and the years. For the seal of the entire universe is stamped upon Adam. Indeed, due to this, heaven and earth moved because of him; trouble and disorder arose on his account between they that are good and they that are evil. So, the good induce him to life because of their likeness and shape placed upon him; while the

[wicked] were drawing him to death, so that they would have power through him and they would conceive the kingdom, and through him humiliate the entire universe.

The rulers determined and formed Adam so that they would be masters through him and conceive the kingdom because of seven things.

The first: He became the enlightener in their creation; instead of the light of the likeness of the Envoy who had displayed himself to them above. For they all desired the likeness of the likeness of the Envoy. Their heart was drawn after it.

The second: So that they would scoop up the light through him and restrain and obstruct it from its ascent to the heights.

The third: So that because of the likeness of the Envoy that is placed upon him the entirety of the divine that is above and below would be humiliated; on account of the likeness of the splendour, of the beauty of his superiority. For he is superior in his appearance to all creatures.

The fourth: He is a seal-ring and a new impression, so that all births who will be begotten might be brought forth after his seal.

The fifth: That might be displayed through him all the [skills] of the powers, they above and below, secret and manifest; and that they might determine through him the totality, and every thing be revealed in him.

The sixth: That there would come to be a great protection for them through the likeness of the Exalted One that was placed upon him; for as the heavenly would [not harm them, nor] even rulers; and no evil thing would be done to them on account of Adam.

The seventh: That he might become chief and king and master over all creatures; and they might conceive the kingdom through him.

The Sun and Moon as Divine Love and Truth

Primary Teaching

The most extensive treatment of divine love and truth as correspondences of the sun and moon. Seven good things the sun does: illuminating, bringing peace, awakening, nourishing all perceptions and knowledges, causing evil to flee into concealment, easing suffering and dissolving false persuasions, displaying the sign of the heavenly kingdom. Seven evils the night does: filling with falsity, bringing dread, inciting rebellion, inducing spiritual torpor, hiding spiritual beauty, empowering evil to act, displaying the sign of primordial evil. Five archetypal qualities of the sun, three further qualities corresponding to the Divine Itself (perpetual fullness, surpassing wisdom, supreme elevation), and two profound arcana: when divine wisdom flows in, all interiors open and descend to assault the Divine Good standing in patient silence; when it withdraws, all things retreat into obscurity — prefiguring both the cosmic beginning and the final consummation.

The greatness of the sun and its divinity: how was it fashioned after the likeness of the first greatness?

It is the gate of life and the vessel of peace, to this great aeon of light [from which it came forth]. it is the gate of the souls' departure.

Every day, would this great light-giver shine its light, it shall do seven good things for them.

The first good thing that it does for them is its light, which it shines upon them. It opens the eyes of all mankind. They see underfoot as they walk by it. It takes away the blindness of the night, which made them blind with its darkness.

The second: When (the sun) is come to the world, with its coming it shall bring calm and peace to the entire world. With its coming it shall also take away from them all the fear and trembling, which their heart is filled with the whole night; for it shall take away the darkness present by its light, and sweep it out. Also, this is how it extinguishes fear by its calm.

The third is its vigil; because when (the sun) comes to the world all sleeping mankind shall arise and awake. And the watchmen too shall cease from watching. The guards who sit at the gates of camps, they break vigil at the watchposts, because of its light that has shone upon them in the world.

The fourth: It shall nourish, and give strength, taste and scent, to the trees and fruits and vegetables, and all the herbs, and the flowers and grasses, which are upon the entire earth.

The fifth: When (the sun) shines in all the world, the evil reptile and the sharp-toothed beasts that are filled of wickedness, they shall flee to hiding in their dens.

The sixth: When it shines its light, the wound of any person is eased from pain. Its light shall melt away the evil arts of every doer of wickedness.

The seventh: (The sun) shall display and manifest to the world the sign of the splendour of the aeons of light, from which it has come out; it here in this world being their sign. It brings light to the whole of creation.

It has all wickednesses therein. Every occasion, would the night fall, it shall do seven evils in the world.

The first wickedness that the night shall do in the world is the darkness, with which it shall fill the entire world; because when the sun sinks from the world and draws to it its rays, at that instant the shadow of the night shall spread out over the whole world. The eyes of the people fill with blackness. They neither see nor wonder with their eyes, because of the darkness of the night which shall fill the whole world.

The second evil thing that the night shall do is its fear; because when its shadow looms forth, its fear and its trembling shall possess all of mankind. The entire world shall fill of the night.

The third: When the night falls, all creatures take up revolt. They rebel in their heart, to do wickedness and perdition.

The fourth: The heaviness of sleep shall lay upon them, and they fall asleep; they slumber and doze, and they are like these corpses in the night.

The fifth is its ugliness; again, when the night would fall, the form of the people shall be hidden in the darkness and the ugliness of the night. The beauty and the form of men and women shall not be displayed before one another, because of its darkness and its ugliness, which it shall spread out over all their forms.

The sixth occasion is when the night would fall on the world. At that instant evil people shall come out to do wickedness; the adulterers, and the robbers and poisoners. The evil beasts shall come out, and all the reptiles that are filled with wickedness, from their dens. And they stalk in the night. Also, the demons and fiends find power to do wickedness in the night. Again, the blows and buffets and wounds and discharges shall torment people in the night; because in it the whole of evil shall find strength.

The seventh: The night shall display the sign of the Darkness, its father. It has arisen out of its essence; because this night that came out of this first Darkness has been displayed in the world. Note this night, the shadow of this first Darkness, the one that is entwined and bound in all things above and below.

There are five archetypes occur in the sun, it making them [manifest to all] as it finds the world.

The first is its light; for it illumines by its light the world, and all the creatures who exist in it.

The second is its beauty; because when it shines, it shall flood beauty and loveliness upon all creatures and everything.

The third is its peace; for, again, when the sun would shine on the world, all people shall receive affection through it, and give peace to one another.

The fourth is the life of the living soul, which it shall release from all the bonds and fetters of heaven and earth.

The fifth: It gives a strength to the elements; and also it gives a scent and a taste to the entire Cross of the Light.

Its light illumines more than all lights that occur in the world. Also, its beauty is more beautiful than all the beauties of mankind. Again, its peace is more surpassing than all the powers and guards who exist in the world. Its releasing action, by which it releases the living soul, is a full day ahead of all releasing actions! The strength that it gives to its limbs is a great strength, being mightier than all strengths!

Once again, there are another three archetypes made apparent by the sun, in respect of the mystery of the first greatness.

The first is the filling up of the disk of its ship; because its ship has filled up every season, and shall not wane at all, the way that the ship of the moon wanes. This continuous filling, by which it is filled, displays the mystery of the Father, the great greatness; from whom all the powers and the gods have come forth. He shall never wane, nor shall lack ever exist in him!

The second: (The sun's) light surpasses the light of all the stars, and all the lights that occur in the universe; corresponding to the mystery of the light of the Father; for his light surpasses and is greater than the light of his aeons.

The third: This sun is very high above all else. It surpasses the height of all the mountains and hills that exist upon the entire earth, corresponding to the mystery of Boundless Time; for he is high above all the household of his light-earth. Also, because the Father himself is high above all the heights and the mountains of his light-earth. He is 'filled up' in his likeness [all] the time and every hour from eternity to eternity!

The mystery of the first great light is the sun, which is this second light-giver, the one that comes daily to the world. It displays all the marks of its graces, displaying and signifying on its own behalf that it is good, out of the essence of the good. It came from the good Father and appeared in this world.

This night that is made of fear exists after the mystery of the Darkness. Behold too the mystery of its essence! It displays it in the world in all these wickednesses. It displays this mystery daily in the world.

Two great mysteries are apparent in this shining sun, at its rising and setting. Now, at the moment when it rises and is visible in the universe, all creatures of flesh shall lift up their heads [from their sleep] towards the splendour of the sun, and open their doors. While at evening time, when the sun sinks from the universe, all people from every place and even all beasts shall go in to their dark hiding places. The population of the entire universe shuts their doors and dark night overcomes them. They go inside and stay within the dark night in their hiding places.

Very great is this mystery revealed by the sun! For when the sun rises and [becomes] visible at the beginning of the day all people open their doors, and all of humanity and every creature emerges onto the [earth] to destroy this Light Cross that is established [in] silence.

This pertains to the mystery of Lord Wisdom, because when he came out from the [greatness] he shone forth over all the children of Darkness. At that [moment] all the children of Darkness came forth from their storehouses, its powers and its armies, abandoning their caves and their black abyss. They destroyed the [outer] body of his five sons, who were swathed over [his body, in that] first struggle.

Again, when the sun sinks from the universe and sets, and all people go in to their hiding places and houses and conceal themselves; this also pertains to the mystery of the end, as it presages the consummation of the universe. For, when all the light will be purified and redeemed [in] the universe at the last, the collector of all things, the Final Body, will gather in and sculpt itself. It is the last hour of the day, the time when the Final Body will go up to the [aeon of] light. The enemy too, death, will go in to bondage; to the prison of the souls of the [deniiers] and blasphemers who loved the darkness. They will go in with it to bondage and the dark night overcomes [them]; and thenceforth this name 'light' will not shine upon them.

Behold the two mysteries made visible daily in the sun, which is this splendrous light-giver.

Five Works of Fire and the Zodiacal Order

Primary Teaching

Love as the single animating force behind five processes: consuming what is merely natural, distinguishing interior from exterior, preparing interiors for perception, forming the vessels of the mind, and illuminating understanding. The twelve zodiacal signs and five stars are then explained as twelve genera of ruling evil and five principal evil affections, all seized from the five genera of hell and constrained upon the revolving natural mind. Two originating principles (self-love and concupiscence) are the father and mother of all derivative evils. Divine Good and Divine Truth are reckoned within the same system but as strangers — they belong to the Divine Itself, not to the evils, and they subjugate all these evils at every moment. Affliction strikes the four quarters of the mind differently when each is plundered by Providence.

This fire, which burns and is apparent today in the world, it does five works.

The first work that it does is this: It incinerates and burns wood, and everything that shall be placed upon it.

The second: It separates four aspects of the wood, which are these: fire and light, ash and smoke.

The third: It gives a taste and an aroma to whatever will be cooked on it. It also gives heat and cheer to whoever will be close to it.

The fourth work that [it] does: All craftsmen shall work the utensils that they will fabricate in it.

The fifth: It shall display light, and the people see by [it].

The twelve signs of the zodiac that are set in the sphere. How are they determined? Or to what place do they belong, according to their essence? Or else again, these five stars that circle in them, from whence are they? Or why has the demiurge appointed them as the authorities and leaders? He is the great constructor who has appointed the entire creation; and he has bound and fixed them on the sphere.

Whether these twelve signs of the zodiac that are fixed on the sphere, or these five stars that circle upon them; those and these are rulers, all of them, according to their essence. They are all enemies and rivals to each other □one oppresses another, they threaten each other□. They plunder one another by the action of the great craftsman who has formed all the worlds. He has gathered [them] and bound them on the sphere above, which circles constantly. Now, while it circles and tumbles them, so they shall do everything that they desire, above and below, according to their pleasure. Nevertheless, a guardian is over them, a debt-collector above them; compelling, extorting, and taking what is theirs away from them!

Now, this is how it can rightly be understood. They were [seized] from the five worlds of Darkness, and bound on the sphere. Two zodiacal signs were taken per world. Gemini and Sagittarius belong to the world of smoke, which is the mind. In contrast, Aries and Leo belong to the world of fire. Taurus, Aquarius and Libra belong to the world of wind. Cancer and Virgo and [Pisces] belong to the world of water. Capricorn and Scorpio belong to the world of Darkness. These are the twelve rulers of depravity, the ones that [wickedness] shall not [leave] For they cause all the evil and [corruption in the world], whether in tree or in flesh.

And understand also about these five stars, the leaders: from where were they formed? The star of Zeus (Jupiter) was generated from the world of smoke, which is the mind. In contrast, Aphrodite (Venus) came about from the world of fire. And then Ares (Mars) belongs to the world of wind. Hermes (Mercury) belongs to the world of water. Cronos (Saturn) belongs to the world [of Darkness].

And also, the two ascendants are counted to fire and desire, the dry and the moist. They are the father and the mother of all these.

And also, the sun and the moon, which are counted in with them as a rule □[counted] to their kind, but why did they count them in with them?□ so that they would reign over them. You will discover they subjugate them at every moment.

These seven we have named, the five stars and the two ascendants: They are the doers of wickedness that do every wicked and bad act in every land, the whole of it, above and below, in every creature, in the dry and the moist, in tree and flesh.

[They] are distributed, appointed on four sides, three per angle in these four places. And they are fixed to this revolving sphere. Aries, Leo and Sagittarius, they three belong to a single side. In contrast, Taurus, Capricorn and Virgo, these other three belong to another side. And then, Gemini, Libra and Aquarius belong to another side. Scorpio, Pisces and Cancer belong to another corner. Now, they are placed like this, appointed to these four parts, and distributed on the sphere.

So, when the side of Aries, Leo and Sagittarius will be plundered by the guardian who is over it, who extorts from it and the leaders who move upon it; at that instant shall affliction strike all the four-footed creatures below. However, when [the side] of Taurus, Virgo and Capricorn will be plundered; [affliction] shall at once befall the herbs, together with the vegetables and all the fruits of the trees. Yet again, when the side of Scorpio, Pisces and Cancer will be plundered; scarcity shall befall the waters upon the earth, and drought be from place to place. Conversely, should the side of Gemini, Libra and Aquarius be plundered; deformity and stuntedness shall befall the form of mankind from place to place.

These twelve signs of the zodiac: They were fashioned from the five worlds of Darkness, and bound on the sphere.

The other five, the stars: They too came about from the five worlds of the land of Darkness.

The [two] ascendants: They are set to the mystery of fire and desire. They are the dry and the moist, the father and the mother.

The sun and the moon: They are strangers to them. Still, because of the constraint of the arrangement, in that the thing receives light, and as they belong and plunder them; because of this they were counted in with them in relation to the calculation of the number. For, the sun and the moon are from out of the greatness, not belonging to the stars and the signs of the zodiac.

The Body as Microcosm and the Ascending Chain

Primary Teaching

The whole spiritual world mirrors the human form. The head corresponds to the first perfections of the five external truths; from neck to heart mirrors the ten degrees; the heart is the living center; four worlds exist in the body with seven rulers each. The twelve zodiacal signs are mapped onto the body from head (Aries) to feet (Pisces), distributed six to the right (the side of good) and six to the left (the side of truth). Innumerable governing affections inhabit the body, meeting and conflicting — producing spiritual eruptions that must be pressed clean of falsity before healing can occur. The ascending chain describes how all elements are progressively gathered: wisdom into love, love into truth, truth into influx, influx into the sphere of celestial life, into responsive perception, into the Lord's calling, into the purified rational, into the Divine Truth connecting all degrees, and finally into the Lord's celestial kingdom.

This whole universe, above and below, reflects the pattern of the human body; as the formation of this body of flesh accords to the pattern of the universe.

Its head is like the first-fruits of the five garments. And, from its neck down to the site of its heart, it resembles the pattern of the ten firmaments. And again, the heart accords to the wheel of the rotating sphere. And, from its heart down to its intestines (?), is like this atmosphere that extends from the sphere down to the earth. The [male] part of the body corresponds to this great earth. And also, from its intestines (?) down to its loins is like the three earths. And also, its shinbones to the pattern of the space in which the Guardian Spirit stands. Its footsoles to the great earth upon which the Guardian Spirit is stood; and the four fastenings that are under his feet. Its liver to the vessel of fire. Its flesh to the vessel of darkness. Its blood to the vessel of water.

The small body corresponds to the macro-cosmos in its firmaments, in its orderings, in its mountains, its walls and its vessels.

There exist five great camps in this great outer zone, of which the five sons of the Lord of Covenants are masters.

So, in the first watch-station above, of which the Master of Wisdom is master, on the battlement of all the works, is found his authority over the three heavens. Then the ones below him [are under the authority of] the great Lord of the Settled Lands.

The second watch, of which the great Lord of the Settled Lands is master, his own authority (extends) over the seven firmaments beneath him.

The third watch, of which the Adamant [is master, his authority] reigns from the firmament down below to the [earth]. [And he] invigorates, according to his authority, the sphere and the worlds of the atmosphere; and the other four worlds that are appointed on this earth.

The fourth watch, over which the Lord of the Mind has power, is the three wheels. And his authority lies over the three earths upon the head of the Guardian Spirit.

The fifth watch is the watch over which the Guardian Spirit is authoritative. Again, he is master, according to his authority, over this great earth he stands upon, and the four fastenings under his feet.

Affliction has come about in these five watches from time to time.

So, in the watch of the Master of Wisdom, Sin desired to spurt up towards the likeness of the Envoy. Yet, they barred it from that place, and it fell back down in shame.

Again, an earthquake and treachery occurred in the watch of the great Lord of the Settled Lands, which the watchers who had arisen at the time and had [sinned] they who were sent came down, until they were humbled.

Also, in the watch of the Adamant, the abortions came to the earth and fashioned [the] figure of flesh.

Again, in the watch of the Lord of the Mind, a commotion happened in these three earths above the Guardian Spirit. The pathway was obstructed for the ascent of these three wheels; that of wind, that of water, and that of fire.

Also, in the watch of the Guardian Spirit, the fastenings beneath were laid bare and strained their chains. A great earthquake befell that place.

[Like] these five watch-stations, which exist in this great [outer zone as these five] camps: this is also the case with this body. There are another five camps there, and the Good Mind is watching over them, and the new man who is with him.

The configuration of his face, which is above his body: the mystery of the Master of Wisdom, who rules over the watch above the zone.

His heart: the sign of the great Lord of the Settled Lands, who subdues the seven heavens.

His genitals: the mystery of the Life-Champion, the one who subdues Greed.

The stomach and the fire that is in him: the likeness of the Lord of the Mind, the one who turns the wheels, sending the life above.

The ruling-power that is beneath in his feet: the Guardian Spirit, the one who subdues with his footsoles the abysses below.

Also, the teaching of wisdom, which circulates in that body: to the likeness of the Maiden, who goes up and comes down in this zone, above and below.

Love and joy, faith and truth: they are to the likeness of these two light ships. For, the living soul should go up in them and become free through them; and it ascends from the abysses below and arrives at the heights above.

There exist four worlds in this body of the flesh, and there exist countless times seven rulers in the body of the four worlds!

So, the first world is from its neck up; and also the seven rulers who are in this upper world are these: the two organs of sight, and the two of hearing, and the two of smell. The other one is the mouth, which is the organ of taste.

The second world is from its neck down to its entire upper torso. And also, the seven rulers who are in this second world are: its two arms that accord to the pattern of its two ears, which occur in its first world above; and its two breasts that are to the pattern of its organs of smell; and the two eyes of its heart; and the gullet of the stomach between the two breasts, which in the chest is the pattern of the mouth.

Once more, there exist seven rulers in the third world of the body, which are these: the fat, the lung, the spleen, the liver, the gall, and its two kidneys.

Also, the fourth world below. There are another seven there of this same kind: its two buttocks (?), and its two testicles, and its two loins; and the member out of which the seed comes, that begets all the forms.

Aries and Taurus, Gemini, Cancer, Leo, Virgo, Libra, Scorpio, Sagittarius, Capricorn, Aquarius and Pisces; these are the twelve signs of the zodiac that occur in the worlds above, on the sphere. They are interlocked and bound on this turning wheel, the one in which they are [set], fixed, and planted. And, regarding all these twelve signs of the zodiac, this is how they were appointed and made leaders [in their order] on the sphere beneath the heaven that is the wheel of the stars. Now, they are appointed like this, they are thus, so that you can find the head of [each one] and you find the tail too [in the one set against it].

Again, they occur like this, these that we have recited, one after another in this body. They are counted by order and number from the head to the feet. Its head is Aries. Its neck and its shoulders are Taurus. Its two arms Gemini. Its upper torso is Cancer. Its stomach is Leo. Its belly is Virgo. The vertical spine and its intestines (?) are Libra. Its genitals Scorpio. Its loins are Sagittarius. Its knees are Capricorn. Its shinbones are Aquarius. The soles of its feet are Pisces.

Behold, these are also distributed one after another. They exist in this body, as if turned to the side and bent to the pattern of the twelve signs of the zodiac. They too are thus, arranged one against another, head to tail, as they occur on the wheel [from below] up.

Also, they are counted by order and number of the body and all its members. So, we have proclaimed that these are turned to the side, bent, and spread out; because from its head down to its hip shall count six to its left, and another six to its right.

The six that are down its right are these: the right temple is Aries; its right shoulder is Taurus; its right arm is Gemini; its right rib-cage is Cancer; its stomach is Leo; the right side of its reproductive organs are Virgo.

The other six which are to its left, in contrast they come from its hip to its head: its left [hip] is Libra; its left rib-cage is Scorpio; its left breast and left kidney is Sagittarius; its [left] elbow is Capricorn; its left shoulder is Aquarius; its left temple is Pisces. This is how the creator of the body himself has appointed them. He has [set] them in order and arranged them, one against its companion, head to tail.

There exist many powers in this body. They are the house-dwellers who are made the leaders in it. There are eight hundred and forty times ten thousand rulers made chiefs in the human body! They are distributed and set firm, quartered according to house. The count and number of their houses is two hundred and ten times ten thousand.

When all these rulers come creeping and moving within the body, they will meet one another; and they shall beset and destroy one another, and [make war] in them there. When [the affliction grows until] they shall erupt from the body of the person who [will] die; and make putrid boils and sores and burning wounds in the body. Either they might have made him sick within; or else they might come forth upon his outer side. Those wounds shall first be squeezed and discharge their liquid, and empty out their pus, until they are squeezed [clean of their impurity] and the suppuration forced out from the wound. Afterwards, their scars shall close over; and they are healed and obtain relief from the places that came out upon them.

In what way shall the elements be gathered in, from one to another?

The light shall be gathered in to the fire, and the fire itself gathered in to the water, and the water gathered in to the wind, and the wind gathered to the air, and the air gathered to the answer, and the answer gathered to the summons. Also, the summons to the purified Mind, which is the intellectual. The intellectual to Hearkening, [Hearkening to Lord Wisdom, the Man to the Envoy, the Envoy to] the aeons of greatness.

Part 12

The Interior Life and Final Teachings

The concluding part gathers diverse but essential teachings on the interior life. All the varied names for the one scattered wisdom are shown to be a single power differentiated through temptation-combat. Divine love is traced through eight discrete states. The divine calling and the will's reception are described as letters exchanged between the Lord and the celestial mind. The soul's purification through two aspects (love and fear), the fifteen paths of spiritual progression, three earths undergoing regeneration, modes of spiritual birth, the doctrine of pristine and restored wisdom, the dragon of self-derived intelligence with its fourteen powers and five hidden recesses, mysteries of inversion in water and shadow, five spiritual productions from sustenance, the incompleteness of joy while good and evil remain mixed, the fivefold formation of communicable truth, three images within the regenerating person, the three great entreaties by which successive divine powers are called forth, and final doctrinal definitions of the names of the Celestial Human and the meaning of affirmation and confirmation — all are gathered here as the teaching reaches its conclusion.

Many Names for One Power

Primary Teaching

A doctrinal key: all the varied names — great garments, rags, worn and torn garments, images and tattered clothes, light element, the Bound Radiance, counsel of life, soul that is slain — designate a single power that was one illuminating wisdom from the beginning but became separated into all these conditions in the first great temptation-combat. The great garments are the five faculties completing Hearkening; the rags are devoured illuminating wisdom entangled in the creation; the worn and torn are the entangled living influx overpowered by the proprium; the images are the three external truths assumed and then stripped by the Lord of Covenants; the elements are the living power remaining in all natural things; the Cross is the bound illuminating power; the counsel is the summons and obedience moving through all powers; and the slain soul is the living power in works, goods, and seeds that is threshed, plucked, and consumed. If all varieties are stripped of their appearances, they will gather into a single form, unaltered forever.

What then are these 'great garments'? Or again, this you sometimes call the 'rags', what are those 'rags'? Or the 'worn and torn apart'? Or what are the 'images and the tattered clothes'? Or what is this name: 'light element'? Or conversely, what is the 'the Bound Radiance'? Or why named otherwise: the 'counsel of life'? Or what is the 'soul that is slain'; being killed, oppressed, and murdered in the enemy? What are all these names?

How have they changed with all these names and become set in altered forms.

The garments that are named 'great garment' are the five intellectuals that make perfect the body of Hearkening, Hearkening. They were purified by the coming of the Envoy.

In contrast, the ones named 'rag': the rags are the devoured enlightening power. It is compounded and entangled in the body of the universe in the rulers who are above, who exist in all the firmaments. Also, its shine is that which lights up and is displayed in the stars of the chain and the powers of the course. And likewise, these rags that are entangled in these three earths below, above the head of the Guardian Spirit [and also] on the earth that is under the Guardian Spirit. These are named the 'rags', because [they are] set [apart in every place].

However, the 'great worn and torn apart garments', which we have proclaimed, is this entangled living power. It is reaped, cut, and devoured. It is overpowered by the five worlds of the flesh, which creep as they move from place to place.

On the other hand, [these] we have termed the 'images and the great tattered clothes' [they] are the three great garments of the wind, the fire, and the water. These the Lord of Covenants cloaked upon his body. With them he set in order things in the universe. With them also he emptied the vessels. He swept them out and laid them bare in front of the Guardian Spirit at the foundation of all things.

Conversely, ['the elements'], we have called them this name, are this power that remains in all things below. It rises up in the wombs of all the earths, gathering together, and pouring forth upon all things.

And then, the ['Light] Cross' [we have termed] this bound 'light power'. It [is spread in] all [things] upon the earth, in the dry and the moist.

Also, the one named the 'counsel of life' is the summons and the obedience. It moves in all these powers that we have named. It awakens them, gives them ease, and drives them to their movement.

The one named 'the soul that is slain', which is killed, oppressed and murdered; it is this power of fruit, vegetables and seeds. They shall be threshed, plucked and cut down; and they give nourishment to the worlds of the flesh. Further: the wood should it be dry, and the garment should it become ragged, will

perish. Again, it is [a part] of this entire soul that is slain and killed; since also even this whole part of it they kill [and devour].

For all these names [that we have proclaimed] are a single [power] since the beginning, it [was one] as it enlightens; but they separated into all these parts in this first contest. They became set in all these altered forms, and these many names. Of course, if now all these varieties are laid bare, and stripped of all these appearances, and parted from all these names; they will gather together and make a single form, and a single name, unaltered and unchangeable for ever in the land of their first essence, from which they were sent forth against the enemy.

Divine Love Through Eight Degrees and the Communication of the Divine with the Human

Primary Teaching

Three teachings. First: three acts of envy by which evil appropriated what belongs to divine good — swallowing Lord Wisdom's poison, lusting to possess the Envoy's image and fashioning a counterfeit in flesh, and seizing a faculty from Adam to generate a separated will. Second: the holy living divine love is present in eight distinct states — from the inmost ground of wisdom utterly beyond creation, through the Divine Itself, the Celestial Human, purified love in the vessel of understanding, love in the vessel of faith, love purified from all derivative forms, love in the regenerated natural mind, and the love revealed at the final judgment. Third: the summons and obedience are like letters exchanged between the Lord and the celestial mind — the divine calling contains all providential truths, the reciprocal acknowledgment discloses all states of temptation.

[The] entirety of envy is this first nature that [occured] in the worlds of darkness.

In this envy that [existed] in it, Lord Wisdom [swallowed] its [poison and] its evil-doing. His [garments] were [seized and] it cut them and drew them; [...].

It envied the first image of the Envoy, which he displayed to it in the heights [above], [in] his form that it saw. It established the seal and the image of flesh, and put the impression of [that] image on flesh, its very own birth.

[The third] time it envied Adam, the [first human]. It seized a power from him, and bore it forth from a [rib of] of Adam's [flesh].

The [holy] living [fire] is present [in] eight places.

The first place wherein it is, is this [light] land [where it is present and] exists. It is established beneath [it, and is utterly] beyond the totality. It is the foundation and basis of that great earth, and the [consideration that] is beneath them all.

The second place wherein it is, is the Father, the God of truth; because [the Father] is established in his great, mighty consideration. So, [first] in the Father. The other powers that came from him were revealed through him, and (the fire) too came [with] them [and was revealed] by them.

The third [place wherein it is], is Lord Wisdom, [he who was clothed in the five sons as his] armour. Again, it is this fire [... ...] on the body of Hearkening.

[The fourth is this fire] that was purified from all the [light] powers, [which is in] the outer wall, in the ship of the day.

[The fifth is] this fire that is in the light-giver of the night [and dwells] within the water.

[The] sixth is this [fire] that is purified from the totality. [The Lord of Covenants] swathed it upon his body, over the summons and the obedience. He has established many things by it. He went down and stripped himself of it before [the Guardian Spirit].

The seventh is this living fire that is of the new earth, and is the consideration. For it is the first foundation in the new earth, it they built anew [... ...] the first course, that is a crown for the entire earth. [They] are below the totality, over the entire earth of [darkness that is] in it, in the [...] whole [earth].

[The eighth] is the fire that shall be revealed in this [last time upon every] person, and it signifies fear and war. Furthermore it [...] it displays and manifests its sign in [its terror]. It shall be [revealed] in these two light ships.

This [is the way] that the holy living fire exists in these [eight places].

The summons and the obedience.

Consider the summons, which was sent from the Lord of Covenants in the beginning. He sent it to Lord Wisdom. It is a peace letter and greeting that he wrote and sent to his brother, in which all the tidings are written down, together with everything it will bring about and establish by that summons. That summons, Lord Wisdom [received, and all that is ordained to happen].

The answer that was sent from Lord Wisdom came to the heights, to the Lord of Covenants. That is also a letter, which was sent from Lord Wisdom to the Lord of Covenants, in which all the tidings are written down; and every war and the struggles that he had waged. It did [make known] in the answer that Lord Wisdom [had written down and made known] everything that had happened and everything [that would happen], all that had been done and whatever is made ready to be done by him. The Lord of Covenants knew all the wars and the dangers and the contests that the rulers had waged against Lord Wisdom.

The Soul's Purification and the Fifteen Paths

Primary Teaching

Multiple interconnected teachings on purification. The light-givers display two aspects: love and fear. The soul, when the Good Mind comes, is reformed through wisdom and obedience; but disturbance enters through hereditary evil, adverse tendencies, and corrupted appropriations of external goods. When goods are genuine and unmixed, the person is found in peace. Fifteen paths of spiritual progression exist: four pure, eight mixed (through which wisdom ascends and refuse descends), and three leading to the hells (concupiscence, destruction of good and truth, and profanation). Five types of clouds illustrate how captive goods are purified through different modes — fire, water, wind, light, and air — each with its own sign (lightning, thunder, storms, stillness, calm). Evil affections stripped from each cloud possess whatever they find. The soul's only open passage is through Divine Love and Divine Truth themselves. Three earths are being toiled over — the outermost natural mind, the interior spiritual mind, and their interaction.

For the light-givers that are in the heavens shall be revealed with these two aspects, in the aspect of love and the aspect of fear. They display these two aspects of the powers above that are in the heavens, because of their soul that passes through the totality. For in these two appearances, the aspect of love that is beauty and sublimity, together with the other aspect of confrontation that is in them, they shall purify in them the powers above.

The soul that assumes the body, when the Good Mind will come to it, shall be purified by the power of wisdom and obedience, and it is cleansed and made a new man. There is no trouble in (the soul), nor confusion nor disturbance.

However, when a disturbance will arise for him and he will be troubled, this disturbance shall go into him in [many ways], first through his birth-signs and his difficult stars that [are upon him, and] they turn over him and stir him and trouble him with lust and anger and depression and grief, as he wills. Also, as he wills, the powers of heaven shall trouble him through their roots, to which he is attached.

Again, there are times you shall find the powers of heaven are peaceful and tranquil for him, and it comes to [pass that] a difficult part comes into him by the nourishment that he has eaten, or else indeed in some [drink] or in the water that they have drunk. Again, trouble and confusion and anger will increase in him, and lust multiplies upon him together with depression and grief; because of the nourishment of the bread he has eaten and the water he has drunk, which are full of bothersome parts, a vengeful counsel. They shall enter his body, [mixed in] with these foods, and they even become joined in with the wicked parts of the body and the Sin that is in him; transferring the anger and the lust and the depression and the grief, these wicked thoughts of the body.

Should you be troubled [know that it comes to you from] them through the conduits and the roots of they above [so that you may recognise] the flood that comes into you.

There are times, however, if you shall find that the nourishment that comes into you is pure [and clear, and full of good parts], so it is greater in light and life while the waste is less in it, and the evil-doing is diminished from it. Even the atmosphere above is still, being purified through the [... ...] also the image is calmed from [its disturbance, and what] increases in you through those good parts of the food that come into you. And they find you at ease and tranquil, as you are well governed in your abodes because of the living part, which is greater on account of the light of these justified souls that are in it. The ones that have perfected their deeds. Their dues have ceased, while their soul is carefree [because] they have been allied with these living souls that [are present] in you. Due to this you shall find them in you, calm in tranquillity, and they come from you without trouble; and you are found flourishing

of body. Even your deeds are determined, being well constructed after their manner, and your doctrines are in order, as your words [are true, and] your soul is carefree within you, ascending like a bird.

When [your body] is troubled, you shall be troubled by the conduits of they below, the difficult parts that come into you by food and the act of eating. Again, when the conduits above are calmed from you, even your food that has come into you is clear and pure. Your heart shall be found ordered in its place, your counsels at peace from disturbance.

This [living soul] that is set in mixture; for it wishes to [ascend] and go to the house of its people, but it [knows and] understands that it has no open door in all the powers of heaven and earth. For they are its oppression that [presses upon] it everywhere. Indeed, it has no open door except the sun and the moon themselves, the light-givers of the heavens [... / ...] they become the place of rest for it. And they become a door that opens for it [in] the coming forth, and (the soul) comes out through them to the country of the household of [its] people.

The light-givers of the heavens have no place of rest amongst all the powers of heaven; except for the [land] of light, that has indeed been theirs for ever.

Fifteen paths are drawn out in the zone. Four paths are pure and belong [to the] light, leading up to life. Eight other paths are [mixed], leading above from that place. The light shall go [up] and become free through them; be purified and go in [to the] ships. However, the waste is separated and thrown [down] to [transmigration] and the other three paths of [waste are] discharged to the gehennas.

[The three] paths that belong to waste, the ones that are drawn to the gehennas, [are] drawn from the fleshes. [One] of them is the appetite for [lawlessness], that of people and of all flesh. The second is the [destruction of] all bodies, which is slaughter, [with] which all flesh is consumed. The third is the damaging action, which [harms] the Bound Radiance and every body; together with the rest of the error and the blasphemy that wounds the gods.

[These three] paths lead to the gehennas. Every person shall follow after [his deeds], whether to life or indeed to death.

The four elements [are what is] purified. From the beginning they are holy ones, living ones, and enlighteners. However, when they undertood [the mingling] in that first struggle, the waste was [mixed] in with them, and the darkness of the enemy was mixed with them. And when they were come into the body, stripping off these polluted garments, they set them in the flesh. Their pollutions, which they have stripped off, shall be displayed in a [form] and become a danger to the body.

The discharge of this pollution, that [the fire] shall disgorge and place in the body, is [blood]. The discharge of the blood is anger. The discharge of anger is the humours.

Also, the emissions that the waters discharge from them are lust. The discharge of lust is bitterness. The emission of bitterness is [fever].

The emission that light shall disgorge is flesh. The emission of flesh is gloom. [The] emission of gloom is obstinacy.

The emissions that the tree shall disgorge, they are the voices of the winds of shame. The emission of winds of shame [is sorrow. The emission of sorrow is the tear].

The emission of the [tear] is the [last] of these twelve emissions.

[Now] these four elements shall [disgorge, and] what are gathered in are [found] by the management of this soul food [that] enters the body. When they enter the body, they are cleansed and purified and established [in] their living image, which is the new man. They shall live [again] and receive the Good Mind and be purified in their likeness; and they come forth, being cleansed and holy. They attain their first rest.

They shall be cleansed and go [up to] the land of the living ones; but these that come to [the flesh] and pass through them and [... / ...] in sins. Their end will occur in transmigration and spirit.

It shall be released from five places and ascend over this great earth and [rise up] and it is revealed and seen in the atmosphere between.

So, the cloud shall ascend from fire to the heavens towards the likeness of the Maiden that she shall display to it. Its sign is the flashes that occur with lightning storms [and are seen. Its] exchange [...]. And they shall be purified by her towards [receiving] the light that she shall reveal [to it]. The rulers shall be released by the lightning storms and they are freed and sent.

However, [these] angels shall immediately be summoned to them, so that they will seize them, because they know that they shall never do good. Every place they will touch they shall make dead and a loss. Whenever the angels will make towards them and come beside [them], they shall flee in their constraint before them. They go into whatever they will meet upon and assume it, like a robber being abandoned and fleeing before one stronger than him, as he runs after him to arrest him.

Now, those rulers that shall be freed from these clouds and assume whatever they will meet upon [and go] into the [... / ...] that they did not [seek] will seize this thing, whether indeed a tree to which they have found the way, or animals, or people. Simply, every place that they will assume they shall burn and destroy by the fire of their body. Namely, the rulers, [the] children of fire, they that shall be stripped of the fire.

In contrast, [the] cloud that shall be raised up from water, and comes above towards the Maiden; its sign is the thunder storms and the booms that shall come in the atmosphere in various forms and are heard. [The lives in it shall be purified] Again, there are times if the rulers that belong to them, which exist in the cloud, shall on occasion be constrained [in a] water [cloud]. And they flee from it and abandon it.

Now, [they] too are so, in that every place that they will [reach], they shall make frost and hail and snow. [They ruin] the seed-corn and the fruits and the plants; and they [shall destroy] every place [that] they will reach.

Again, [angels] shall be summoned to them who seize them. Still, while the angels [rush] after them in order to seize them, they shall make this destruction.

Also, [the cloud] that will be raised up from wind ascends to the atmosphere between, towards the likeness of the Virgin that she shall display to it. Its sign is [the storm] wind that shall blow with bitterness.

So, in those winds and tempests shall the lives be purified. Again, the rulers will be stripped of the cloud of wind and they descend from it, safe in their likeness. All the rivers and the seas that they will reach and arrive at, they shall make waves in them and raise [them up] and they [overturn] the ships. They wreak destruction [in them] and they seize and bring them [to the deep].

Also the cloud, the one of light, immediately they will be stripped of it [and it shall come above towards the likeness of] the Virgin. She shall display its sign too [to it]. And its sign is this, in that you shall find it sailing in stillness and calm. The lives in it shall be cleansed in stillness and calm. Again, the rulers that will be stripped of it [in their likeness] that will come forth [from it] they shall put [...] and they take [... / ...] there [until] the angels seize them.

Again, the cloud that shall be raised up from the mingled air comes above towards [the likeness] of the Virgin. Its sign is this, in that [the lives] are purified in it in stillness and [rest. Again, these rulers] that will be stripped of that cloud and come from it; every place that they will find [and reach] they shall make it [like] one of [the dead] until [the hour when] they are seized and taken to their midst.

Their strippings, that they shall leave behind them in various places they will have reached, whether the produce of the trees or the offspring of the fleshes, they shall be taken midst [...] wither away. They shall inflict great dangers, but again those rulers also the angels shall send to their midst. They bring the light from them and cast the demons down to these seven outer ditches of the great sea; which is the vessel of the waters that are outside the world.

To what place do those seven ditches go down?

Those ditches and the [paths go down] until they reach the earths below [to the] feet of the Guardian Spirit.

[...] For sometimes these angels shall be sent to them, to seize the rulers. Whenever the rulers [... / ...] for the angels rush after them. They beseech them [...] they that are given the command. However, [those rulers] shall be freed from them alone and assume [the tree] and [the flesh]. They are consumed by this offspring [... / ...] tree and that of flesh. The angels shall set a [watch] over them, that they might guard them until the hour when [those rulers] will be stripped of tree and [flesh; and] they go up above. They shall be gathered [together] above, and they are poured out [again] in their first [forms and images] in which they first were. They take the light from them, which had remained behind in them. And they too are cast down to these seven outer [paths] that are in the great sea; the place to where these former ones [were cast]. They shall reach their midst [...] and the light that is in them is taken.

And they are cast to the outer prison by the angels, when the command is given to them through the power of the Maiden. She has authority over the entire zone, and cleanses the life that is in it.

Three earths exist in the universe, and are being toiled over. At first they [trouble] the farmer in them. Afterwards they bear [good] fruit to they who toil over them.

One of them is this great earth that people are living upon. They are ploughing in it [and digging], it with iron hoes, they cultivate, [making] the furrows, turning it over [from its place] Afterwards they harvest fruit from [it in its season].

The second field is the living soul, the holy one. It is mixed in the entire zone, above and below. The farmers who toil over it are these two great light-givers, which journey through the heavens. They are toiling and cultivating it, so that they will draw it towards their aspect. And it leaps up and comes to the heights. It goes upwards, out from every place wherein it is, and it adds to them.

Modes of Spiritual Formation and the Dragon Within

Primary Teaching

Three modes of spiritual formation and threefold nourishment describe how living states arise. Pristine wisdom (virginal) is wisdom that never underwent spiritual death nor was contaminated; restored wisdom (continent) is wisdom that descended, was defiled, purified, and ascended again — it tasted of self-love but was cleansed. The dragon of self-derived intelligence possesses fourteen powers of dominion (seven interior faculties and seven corresponding sensual faculties) and five hidden recesses (expression, thought, will, affective mediation, and the vital truth flowing through all). Mysteries of inversion are explored: why reflections in water appear upside-down (the interior qualities of understanding appear inverted in natural truth because every new spiritual state enters the natural plane with what is highest descending first), and why shadows are permanently joined to the earth (the natural correspondence of a person cannot be separated from the corporeal plane while in the world).

All these animals that you see, and also the rest of the [creatures upon the face] of the earth, confirm them in three [likenesses of birth]: some from [the] abortions. Others, however, form their own selves in their shape [and nature].

Also, their nourishment is [threefold: the] light in them, if they shall wish [to eat it]. [Some of them] they eat [seeds and fruit and grass]; they eat seeds and fruit. The [nourishment fills] it entirely, and they [bear within them] the three [archetypes] from their nature and the [whole of] time when they are on the [earth in this world]; they are seized [and bound] in their [bodies]. The Envoy [purifies] all powers [of the darkness].

[Now] it [formed them], first [of all]. Plant them generally to this name: shoots and grass. It formed the bad, bitter trees, the reeds and the thorns and the [thistles] and these others that are like them.

For that thought belongs to the flesh-eating rulers. Still, these [that were] planted (belong to) grass and gourds, since they are in their essence. Nevertheless, [this thought] that came down from the rulers, as they are in fruit and grass first and shall not be planted in flesh and blood, it formed the trees that shall give nourishing [fruit], as their gourds are sweet.

Again, this [thought] that came down from the powers that eat [meat] and also eat grass and gourds, it has formed the trees that shall not produce any nourishment. Their fruits belong neither to good nor evil.

What is the virgin that is named 'virginal'? Or the [one that] is called 'continent', what is it? Or by what category is the [virgin] called 'virginal'? Or [the continent], which is given this name, by what category is it named ['continent']?

What is called 'virginal' is assigned to the mystery of the aeons of greatness. And they called it 'virginal' by the category of all the light that did not [taste] of death, nor come to the enemy's war.

However, what is called 'continent' occurs to the mystery of the light that came and was mixed with the darkness. It was defiled in bodies [of the creatures] and went up to the light. [They] called [it 'continent'].

Furthermore, [the Maidenals] are of such a nature that, even] should they come out against the [enemy and come to the war, they would not] taste death, nor [be defiled].

On the other hand, what is called 'continent' [is this light] that mixed with the darkness, was [purified], came [up from] all the creatures, and was confirmed in the [greatness]. They called it 'continent' since it tasted [of the lust]; but afterwards was cleansed from it and [become an] holy one.

Furthermore, what is called ['virginal'] is this light that was purified by the [image] of [the Envoy]. It [went up and] attained [the heights. It was] confirmed in the image of the gods.

Again, what is [called] 'continent' is the remainder of this light [that] remained behind, from what was cleansed. It goes up and comes down in transmigration. [Also], there is a part [of] it that shall come and attain the form of [human flesh]. Again, that one too shall be chosen in the flesh, [accept] the hope, and become an holy one. And they name it 'continent'.

Furthermore, what is named 'virginal' is the Good Mind, should he come and assume the images [of the purified ones]. However, on the other hand, what is called ['continent'] is the new man, should it be purified from this old man. And it is cleansed and strips off the Sin that is compounded with it, and it becomes a continent one.

And also, what is called ['virginal'] in the flesh, is a man if he has [never] joined himself to woman, has not been defiled by intercourse. However, [in] contrast, what is called 'continent', is the man who has a [woman] in the world. Afterwards, he cleanses himself from her [and] renounces her. And because of this he [is purified] and he becomes an holy [continent] one.

There is a dragon with fourteen heads, and it is gathered in and [hidden in its] den with five refuges.

Again, this is how this earth [is likened] to it, as it is accounted a corporeal dragon [of desire] the dragon is this doctrine [and teaching] of the flesh [and its thought] also the fourteen heads that are distributed over the dragon are these.

The seven sense organs on the head of the body are the two of sight by which one sees; the two of sound by which one hears; the two of scent by which one smells; also the tongue [of taste] by which one selects, receiving there the different tastes that occur in every form.

These are the seven heads of the dragon, the seven sense organs that are on the upper part of the person; [and seven are] below. The seven of the torso are these: two [hands]; the two [feet] ruler [they correspond to] the seven heads that are above; so with the ones below they total and make fourteen heads of the dragon.

Conversely, the five dens about which they have spoken, where the dragon is congregated and protrudes, are these: the first is the tongue; the second is the lungs; the third is the heart; the fourth is the spleen; the fifth is the blood that dwells in them. Again, if it shall look out from them [and reveal its likeness and its observation above and below, it wages war by] its fourteen heads.

The dragon, which is the thought of the body.

The dragon that exists with its fourteen heads and five dens, wherein it is concealed and hidden. It does through them [all its evil deeds, fulfilling its will and its desire] all the time.

When the person is above water and looking down [into the waters], if he shall see his face reflected why shall you find his head turned upside down and also his feet upwards? Yet, when he stares down into the waters, his face shall not be visible, nor can he see it there?

[And] this: The face of people and the shape of trees shall appear turned upside down in the water as this is signified in [the] mystery of the summons, when it was sent down to the worlds of Darkness towards Lord Wisdom. [Since the summons came down] in this way it cast itself down [to the depths] like a person [who] plunges headlong into water; so it is also with the summons. It cast itself headlong to the worlds below, with strength and diligence.

And this too: Shall the person lift his head up from the water, his face shall not be visible to him, being bent below. This characterises the mystery of the obedience that ascended from below, from with Lord Wisdom his father to the Lord of Covenants.

The face of people and of animals and of trees is visible in the water, hanging upside down. This occurs to the mystery of the stars and the zodiac, which hang upside down and are visible in the great sea. For the face of people and beasts and all trees hang on the root of the stars and the zodiac, being begotten from them. Just as their fathers, who are spread out above, hang upside down; so it is also that the mystery of their fathers is being revealed to them whenever they stare down into the water. This is, that you shall find their shapes inverted.

Not only this, but [the] child who is born; as the [hour] approaches for him to be born, he hangs upside down and is born head first. Indeed, due to this, his mystery shall be revealed in these waters people stare down into.

Behold, you will find the shadow of the person who walks along is joined to the earth all the time. If the person is troubled [and seeks to lift] his shadow up upon the earth [it is bound from] above. It is impossible for him to do [this, to part from his shadow while he remains] on the earth. See, this mystery is [a] great sign, signifying that the entire body came from the earth and had ascended from the abyss. Again, due to this, its shadow is joined on the earth, turned downwards, and hanging from above.

The Productions of the Spirit and Incomplete Joy

Primary Teaching

Five productions from the spiritual sustenance a person receives: inmost blessedness rising in the Mind, truth expressed outwardly as doctrine, the power of good in active charity, what is generated by self-love when the proprium turns reception toward selfish ends, and the merely external person visible in the world. Of these five, only the outermost is attended to by the natural will and understanding. No mind dwelling in the mixed state possesses complete joy — even Divine Love and Divine Truth do not fully rejoice, because they see their beloved captive good in bondage and evil exercising dominion over what does not belong to it. Only when evil is permanently confined will complete blessedness come. The fivefold production of communicable truth is illustrated through the coin: one pours forth initial influx, another shapes through reformation, another refines, another impresses the authentic divine image, another purifies by separation. The seed grain formed by five elements illustrates the gathering of spiritual faculties under Divine Good.

This sustenance of various kinds that people gather in and eat, and enters the body; it shall be distributed to five productions.

The first product is this that shall issue from the person in rapture and rises up in the Mind, and it comes out from all his limbs, and is immeasurable.

The second is this that shall issue from the person in voice and word.

The third is this that shall spring from them in strength and activity.

The fourth is what is engendered by the pleasure of [lust] in men and women.

The fifth is this that shall be formed and sculpted in the flesh, and be engendered and come from them. It is this corporeal creature; only its parents can recognise this creature that they beget. They are attentive to its desire and its thought and its [love] every day, all the time. However, these other four forms they neither notice nor are concerned about; because they are not displayed.

There is not [one] person [existing in] the world, standing firm [in] mixture, for whom joy remains to the end.

Not only people, even the sun and the moon, the light-givers of the heavens, [do not suffer] nor are they oppressed, they know not [sorrow, being set] firm in a summons and an [obedience]. Nevertheless, they too, they do not rejoice completely.

So, one: Their eyes stare at their enemy, they [perceive] him and also look at his ugly shapes. They [see] him, that he is alive and established and is king above and below, in secret and manifest. He does every thing that he wants according to his [will].

[The second]: They perceive the living soul, they see [it] and that it is ensnared and set in a great [fetter] above and below, in the tree and in the flesh, [burdened] with every oppression. It is being pressed, drawn near to [and] sliced and eaten as it comes up and down; from above below and from below above. It [is] despoiled and moved from body to body.

Now, because of their living soul that is loved by them and honoured of them, when they see it in oppression [they can] not [rejoice] completely.

So, one about the soul; and one about their enemy whom they see ruling [over] what is not his own. He is proud and satisfied with a wealth that is not his own. Indeed, due to this, they do not rejoice in total; but bear up and swallow their heart until they cleanse the living soul and take it from the enemy's

hands. Then they obliterate the death that is their enemy and they gather it in [and fetter it in the lump] for ever and ever.

When they will chain their enemy in the bond at the [last], then they will rejoice and no longer grieve from this [time]. Also, they become the very same as they were from the [beginning] for ever!

The production of the word [that comes] from the mouth and is heard by the [ears]. [The mouth shapes it] and the throat draws it up and the tongue spreads it out and the teeth cut it and the lips [gather] it! The word shall come forth through the power of [these five] members and be heard outside.

[Similarly] the coin: One shall pour it out and an [other] beat it and another trim it as it is turned, and [another] put the stamp on it and another wipe it in the sieve (?). [Behold], these five craftsmen shall shape and beautify [their] coin, and it comes amongst mankind. It becomes a [possession] to be received and given.

This is also the case with the [word], as it is formed and embellished by five [members]. It comes forth and is heard by the ears [of] others.

This seed grain and this barley grain shall be formed and [nourished] and beautified by the five elements. Now, the warmth and the cold nourish the seed grain and the entire tree. So, just as these things nourish it [so also] it is destroyed [and consumed] through [great] hunger.

In this way also righteousness gathers the five to it.

In this way too, a lack and a shortfall shall occur from place to place through them; and they who have chosen it have gathered it in and beautified and attained it, while an affliction shall arise for it through those.

People also shall be caused to stumble on their account, through the energy of Greed that dwells in them. It has poured its shadow over them, just as it shall also pour its shadow over the elements and destroy the fruits of all the trees.

The Fullness of the Summons and Three Images in the Purified Ones

Primary Teaching

Within each of the five degrees of external truth, five interior faculties reside, totaling twenty-five — constituting the full complement of the summons and obedience. The elements fasted from their own nourishment until Divine Wisdom brought the living food that sustained them through fifty complete states. Three degrees of interior life exist within the regenerating person: the inmost spiritual degree (the new man formed by Divine Wisdom), the intermediate rational degree (bound in the proprium), and the outermost sensual degree. Spiritual nourishment descends through these three degrees — the sensual strips what does not belong, the rational strips natural affections of evil, and at the spiritual degree a pure affection of Divine Wisdom comes forth as guide, elevating the living element to the celestial. The Maiden who robes the new man is called 'the moment of true life' — she is the first origin and the final end.

[In each] one of these five garments that [Lord Wisdom] summoned there are five powers. They shall be counted to the [number of each] other, these five, and five times [five is] their number. However, at the time [when] the summons went down. The answer wished to ascend with it. And the summons with the obedience [constitute] twenty-five characteristics in their twenty-five limbs, [which] are the sons of the Man. The summons and [the obedience] were raised to the heights through them.

Just as their [father] the Lord Wisdom raised himself up through them, by these these other ones have set up all things [above] and below. They fasted from their [food], [which] is their own.

So, from that time until [the time] of [the advent] of the Kingdom of Wisdom, the glorious one who came [from the land of light and gave to themheir] food which is the [life] of [soul], which is the summons and the obedience [that is] that spiritual food. They [released them throughout] all these fifty days, which [means] this living food suffices for all of them. It filled them all with power and richness and life. [Light is] this living food that [in them] became rich.

[The light] exists [and comes] daily to the body of the person [and] there are two hundred and fifty thousand seals in it [And with them] there are another two hundred and fifty thousand rulers [and] they are cleansed and purified and enter [into the rest] by the voice, by the word, and by the [thought that grows] quiet with the silence at the time when his heart [is opened to the love] of God the Father.

Also, the twelve [signs of the zodiac and their] rulers that belong to the Darkness shall be swept out outside in wandering and in transmigration [and in perdition, and] some of them [shall pass through] this transmigration, and others among them shall be brought back.

There are four aspects among mankind that perceive, as they perceive [all things] without these four that are hidden in them [no one can perceive, for] they belong [to the Living Soul]. So, [these four give perception to all mankind].

[The heat] that is in the [body] belongs to the fire. The darkness belongs to the abyss; but the light that perceives what is hidden in all these things, being clear, is the living air.

How shall the pupil of the eye perceive? While it perceives by day, yet come the night it shall not perceive. [For it is blind in the darkness] The pupil of the eye shall not [perceive] the mystery of the [eye] is the door [to what is] below [and to] the other four cardinal points. For in the [height] above. He has [established a] great [power and] they came down [to the] living [spirit]. Lord Wisdom came forth from it and knew all things.

This bit of life and light that comes from [these three] vessels that surround the universe [and the] life comes up [to the light].

[... But] should the [life] ascend [through the] light of the rays that [come down] which are received, which shine and go in through these great open gates, through these doors, firmament by firmament.

For four [gates open] in each world, distributed at the four points of the compass, opening downwards to the vessels. So, due to this, the [light of the] rays shall go in through these openings and it shines on [that] place, and pulls through them the light and the little [pillar (?) that exists] there.

From that place [it] shall be poured [out to the] firmaments. It shall also be clarified in these firmaments [until] a part there is cleansed and it is [all] taken up with the living ones. However, its other part [of darkness] shall all [be cast] down.

Three images occur in the purified ones person.

The first is the spiritual image, which is the new man, which the Good Mind shall form in him; and it goes into him and dwells in him.

The second image is the remnant and remainder of the new man, which is the psychic image that is bound in the flesh, as the old man [has persisted since the] times of this psychic image.

The other one is the corporeal image [that is] added to them all.

These three images [exist in him] entirely. When it will [come into him] through the nourishment of food. If it shall sink [then it shall come] down to the corporeal image. [And] the corporeal, [that] is in it, shall divest itself of it and place it in the [psychic] image. [And] again it rises up and falls to the [spiritual] image; it shall divest itself of the psychical of the enemies, which [... ...] anger. The lust [... ... ...] with it.

Then shall a light virgin come and reveal the spiritual image that is [there], which [is] the new man. That virgin acts as a guide. [She goes] on before and it is extended to the heights above, and received into this spiritual image. And she [forms] it and adorns it with the new man [within]. It is sealed with all the limbs of this light virgin who is present and dwells in the new man.

So, this is [how] this living limb shall be [purified] and live, the one that comes into the body of [the righteous] one from without through the administration of food of various [kinds], like this. The living soul shall be [cleansed] entirely every [day] and traverse these three [images].

So, it shall divest itself of the body, which is not its own, in the corporeal. It shall also divest itself of the souls that are not its own, these that are mixed with it in the psychical [image, which are] anger and desire and [bitter]-ness and foolishness and envy and strife; and these other wicked teachings that are not its own.

However, in [the] spiritual image itself it shall live and be joined with [long]-sufferingness, the perfection of faith and love that reigns over them all. It is the Maiden who robes the new man and who shall be [called] 'the hour of life'. [She] is the [first], but [she] is also the last.

The Three Great Entreaties

Primary Teaching

Three successive divine prayers describe one continuous spiritual process. The first entreaty: the Divine Proceeding (the Bounteous Spirit) supplicated the Divine Origin on behalf of the Celestial Will that had cast itself down into the hells. The Lord of Covenants was sent forth, liberated the Celestial Will, and set it in rest and joy. The second: after constructing the universe, five divine powers stood in prayer requesting a guide who might purify the living soul. The Envoy was sent, perceived the whole entrapped soul, and redeemed it. The third: after displaying the divine image, the Envoy hid it from the powers of darkness, liberating those who called out. The chapter teaches that the entire drama of salvation is enacted through ascending petitions and descending divine responses — the two movements that constitute all conjunction between the Divine and the human.

The Great Spirit, the Bounteous Spirit, she claimed and prayed and besought and glorified and praised the first established one, who is the Father. She besought him an entreaty. She claimed of him a request. She received a great gift; she and the many powers with her.

She besought an entreaty on behalf of Lord Wisdom, because of how he had come forth and thrown himself down. He became distant from the Bounteous Spirit. He separated from her and gave himself; in great affliction. He joined war on earth with the destruction and the grief and the weakness; in the worlds of Darkness; in the abysses made of fear; in the midst of the demons' ditch; amongst the powers of the devil!

Indeed, he is like a king standing in the midst of his enemies. And when the Bounteous Spirit petitioned and prayed and glorified and praised the Father, the first established one, she did petition him that he might send a power; a protector and redeemer and helper for the son of God who is set in affliction.

Now, just as she had besought and interceded, so likewise was her prayer fulfilled and received into the presence of Boundless Time. He turned and gave to her her entreaty: the great power, the Lord of Covenants, the giver of ease. The Bounteous Spirit and the Lord of Covenants came with great power to the borders of the territory. They brought Lord Wisdom up from that war and struggle, wherein he is set.

He gave himself as a grace for the Bounteous Spirit. He became estranged and far from her, the one whom his enemies (place) in great affliction, the one who is in the land of Darkness since he became weak.

The Lord of Covenants grasped and took him in. He freed him. He set him right and gave him ease in the land of rest [and joy] the Lord of Covenants, the first giver of ease [he fulfilled] the will of these three. The welcomer [shall] find with the welcomer that [ease is given].

[He received] a great power [and the charity] of the loved one [for] Lord Wisdom who had been far away. He had become distant. She had besought on his behalf. He was set fast in affliction. (The Lord of Covenants) went to the place of destruction and weakness, the one that freed and redeemed him and gave him ease from the affliction. He set him right with rest and joy. He has himself become rested, with him for ever.

[These great ones came] and they built the universe and completed it with its firmaments, with its wheels, with the ships of light that are in the heights, with its fastenings, with its earths and its walls, with its vessels. They completed the universe and set it right by the fathers of light.

Then, the Great Spirit stood with the King of Radiance, the Dawn with the Lord of Covenants and Lord Wisdom. These five stood to prayer; they glorified and praised the Father, the first established one.

They besought of him an entreaty. They claimed of him a request, that he might give them the power [and] the leader, a guide to all the things of activity that they had constructed. That he might come and purify the living soul that is set in affliction.

They prayed and besought their Father, and he received from them their prayer [and] he gave them their entreaty and their request [and] he summoned from him [a great power] which is the Envoy. He, he came from the power of his greatness. He saw the entire soul, how it is entangled in a chain and set fast. It sees the things of activity that his brothers have constructed, that have come from the heights. Again, he saw the living soul, that it is entangled and set fast in a great torture. It is oppressed in the stink of the abyss that is joined with it.

And therefore, he, the Envoy [was moved] in his charity. So, he revealed his way, before this underworld that is dug deep down, to free the living soul. He redeemed it from all the fleshes of death wherein it is pained. He gave it ease. He set it right in the place of rest and joy.

And again, he too, the Envoy, he fulfilled the will of these three; the will of his brothers who had besought the Father for him. They claimed of him a request, together with the [will] of the Father, the one that [heard them and] he gave the entreaty that they had besought of him.

The third is the transferral of the living soul that he had freed. He released it and gave it ease from the affliction. He became king and first to the entire body.

The third entreaty when they besought him the third time [and he] displayed his likeness [to the light and] he hid his likeness from the [powers of darkness] he stood firm [in his power and] they revealed [the glory of] the light [to] Lord Wisdom [whom the archons] mock [and came] to him in [the height] which is exalted [in his] garment [and] they were freed [and came] to him [and raised] their voice [from] the body [in] prayer [and] it [did] beseech [for] the body [did] beseech [and] she besought [him] in [that they might] be free [through [the Envoy came] and also [gave them ease].

[He dwells] with the living ones and [rests] for ever [and Lord Wisdom] was freed] from the [affliction and] he gave him the hope [of life].

Also, the Kingdom of Wisdom perfected the will [of the Father and] the will [of the elements and] they found the light [and fulfilled] the will of the [elements] that he had [desired and] he gave them the power that is the Kingdom of Wisdom. He granted the will of the elements. [And they rest in joy] for ever. [Lord Wisdom] he was humbled, he was made free [and] the [great]-ness is displayed to his enemies. He received the hope [of life to] reveal [through] the Kingdom of Wisdom, the light power [of the Father] and the entreaty of the [fathers] of light [for ever].

Final Teachings: Names, Essences, and the Amen

Summary

A gathering of final doctrinal statements. Why severing essential faculties causes spiritual pain but removing outermost coverings does not — because the outermost regenerates from its intact root while deeper perceptions, once destroyed, cannot be restored; corrupt proprium persisting within regenerating will produces spiritual sickness. Names of the Celestial Human: 'confirmed in good' (set apart by innumerable heavenly societies), 'perfected in Divine Good' (possessing no falsity, acting in perfect accord with Divine Love), and 'sole-proceeding' (established alone to pour forth against evil). The Celestial Human stood firm amid all falsity, loving only the goods of his household, laboring to separate and purify. The two fundamental principles (wisdom and falsity, divine love and self-love, conjunction and separation) are restated. Three degrees of influx sustain the regenerating human. The assent and amen — affirmation belongs to the divine calling, confirmation belongs to the reciprocal response — these are the very states that opened the interior pathways of mercy. Includes two brief fragments (§920-§921, §928) that point toward fuller teachings not preserved in this substrate.

Why when limbs are cut from the body of the person he shall be pained? While if the hair on the head of the person's body should be shaved, and [the nails] of his hands and feet be cut, he does not notice it [nor feel pain] Some of these even now shall grow [and come forth] again. Just as the [nails are cut and grow] so the hair shall grow and [if you] cut a finger, he in [deed is pained] on the limbs of the [body] that you [cut from] him [shall not grow] since this time to the [dissolution of] body [again].

[That the] body is like the earth, [while these] limbs [also growing out] of it are like the trees. There are varieties [and kinds] of tree you shall find growing on the earth. They [arise] and grow again and stand firm. They have not [been uprooted from the earth] Again, there are others that if they are cut shall not [grow again] and they grow, as they are [like the grass] which shall be cut and grow [again] and [again] they too that occur [on the earth] they shall be cut and not grow, resembling [the limbs that shall neither] grow nor shall they [grow again. And] it [shall] please him on [that which is cut] and grows [again] in impurity [and shall not be cut away] from him. This flesh that is corrupt [is mingled] in the [living] flesh and they [in whom it dwells] are somewhat sick.

About these people who shall [depart from the world] and their soul is released from [their body and the bonds of darkness] if he shall fall upon [judgment].

The [second kind] if he shall fall [into the darkness for a time] one [portion of light remaining for] one hour [in that middle place and] others who shall [linger between the light and the darkness] and they remain. They shall delay until they [are purified and then] he is freed, and they delay to come toward [the land of light].

Which names shall be freed, as they [receive the light that shall] release them.

[The mind of the light came down] upon [the earth] from [the height] thus [it is].

[Once more he says concerning all] of them [are established by the light, so] that they shall [be purified and attain to the rank of] seven people [who shall be perfected in the light] Again, he too, this [person, in] the time when [the mind] of the light [shall be made manifest and shall fill all of] the universe [and all the mystery that is within it] is revealed [to him, and he shall] take to the light [completely and utterly], the way that he exists [and receives his life and his portion] from [among] these other three [aeons].

[The deed] and the [righteousness of the Father] is more than [the name and] the voice through them.

This one, whom they called "approved" [he received this name because] they approved him in the midst of the [aeons of] light. These numerous multitudes set him [apart], and he came forth against the enemy. They gave this name [to him on account of] this matter [... ...] who are numerous, that are in the aeons of light and who [are without] measure or number.

This one, [whom they called] "righteous", because he is the first righteous one who had no sin amongst all of the aeons that belong to the light and the thought [by which] they knew him, so that [it was known because] he is the first [who obeyed] his Father, who had sent him with five sons [into] perdition.

This one also [whom they called] "only begotten", because he was established [alone to] pour [forth against the] enemy.

[The only] begot-ten also from gold and silver and all the [treasures] of the universe.

[Lord Wisdom], himself stood firm in the [midst] of all the worlds of Darkness. He did not love [the] worlds of Darkness, nor did he lust for them! Rather, [his] thought and love for the household of his people is in [him]. Anything else that the enemy [did to them] with his violent [deeds]. Behold, (Lord Wisdom) toils and struggles; so that (the enemy) would be [separate from] them and be cast out from them. And he purifies them and [makes] them [free], and makes them as they were from the beginning.

The two essences that are present at the beginning [and are opposed to one another:] the light and the darkness, that which is good and that which is [evil], life and death.

The [Light] and the great [Power] and the great Mind that is [in] this Youth that is with the [Maiden of Light, and the] thirty-six angels [and the] twenty-two angels [that are with him] but [the number] of the twenty-two [is] the seven pillars that [stand in] the sea that surrounds the universe [and the] four angels that are distributed to the [whole] universe, supporting the mightiness [from] below, which is the earth of all the heavens [and also] these other five gods, the sons of the Man, they that [through them] the universe is stood firm [together with] the summons and the obedience [and] the splendour of the [Light Life-Champion against those that] they are become enemies [yet] they guide it.

The third also, [that is] below, there are twelve powers standing firm there. However, the number of the twelve images [and also] the three great pillars of mightiness that [are the] pillars supporting the disk [and] the other three [powers] they are the garments that the Lord of Covenants [wore] he put them at that time [upon those] that threw them, together with [the light] which is displayed therein [and] this [that is made] perfect before [the] great Porter [who is] in his power [and] these are the three great [powers] against [those that] are in the midst of people [and whoever] knows [them and] entrusts his soul to them [shall be saved].

What is the 'assent' and the 'amen'?

The assent and the amen have come about from these great ones of the powers. They were given the name as the assent belongs to the summons and the amen belongs to the answer.

Just as the summons and the obedience are the ones that opened the portals of mercy and entreaty for Lord Wisdom, so they also became portals for the Bounteous Spirit and the Father of the living. Lord Wisdom sought and found his redeemer. And also the Bounteous Spirit and the Father of the living sought [and found] this runner, who came forth from them, who is Lord Wisdom; but the summons and the obedience became the portals for them.

They have become portals for the aeons of greatness towards Lord Wisdom, and the soul that was conjoined with death. They became helpers [and saviours] of Lord Wisdom during his ascent. They gave him [back to] the Lord of Covenants and the Bounteous Spirit [who received him]. They are purifiers of the living soul, being helpers and bestowers of remembrance for it, be it either in [the water or] in the tree

or in the creation of flesh [wherein it is bound].

CORRESPONDENCE LEXICON

A comprehensive mapping of every natural term in the Ancient Word to its spiritual correspondence. Entries are organized by category. Where the same natural image carries both a positive and a negative sense, the opposite sense is noted.

Cosmological Entities (16)

Boundless Time — *The Infinite Divine Love itself — the Lord's own Esse, the absolute origin of all good and all being* (Father, God of truth, first established one, King of the lights, first Father)

As the supreme uncaused source from which all emanations proceed and to which all return, this figure corresponds to Divine Love in its infinite self-subsistence — the esse of the Lord that precedes and contains every derivative degree of good and truth.

The text repeatedly states the Father is 'hidden and immeasurable' and 'established in himself alone' — corresponding precisely to Swedenborg's teaching that the Divine Esse is incomprehensible and self-subsistent. The Father's five limbs (mind, thought, teaching, counsel, consideration) map to five essential faculties of the Divine itself. (Ch. 1, 3, 4, 7, 11, 14, 18, 19, 33)

Lord Wisdom — *The Lord as the Celestial Human — the Divine Rational proceeding into combat with the hells; the primordial celestial will united to the Divine* (the Man, Lord Wisdom, Lord Wisdom, Lord Wisdom)

As the first being called forth to descend into the realm of darkness and wage war, this figure corresponds to the Lord's own Divine Human in its first proceeding — the celestial degree of the will that descends into the deepest states of temptation to confront and overcome evil from within.

Lord Wisdom is consistently presented as clothed in five garments (= five external truths) and descending voluntarily into the abyss. This mirrors Swedenborg's doctrine that the Lord assumed the human through successive natural states in order to combat the hells from within. The 'five sons' who remain behind in darkness after Lord Wisdom ascends correspond to the faculties of celestial perception still captive in the natural mind after the Lord's glorification. (Ch. 1, 5, 9, 12, 13, 17, 18, 19, 20, 24, 28, 29, 34, 44)

the Lord of Covenants — *The Lord's operative Divine Truth proceeding from Love — the Divine power that orders, judges, constructs, and sustains the whole spiritual world* (the Lord of Covenants)

As the being who rescues Lord Wisdom, constructs the universe from the bodies of defeated rulers, and establishes all order, the Lord of Covenants corresponds to the Lord's proceeding truth in its active, judicial, and architectural function — the power that creates spiritual order from what had been chaos.

The Lord of Covenants performs seven works, each corresponding to a complete operation of spiritual regeneration. The number seven here signifies holy fullness. The Lord of Covenants's 'five sons' correspond to the five structural powers that sustain the spiritual world — distinct from Lord Wisdom's five sons which are faculties of perception. (Ch. 1, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 26, 27, 29)

the Envoy — *The Lord's mediating Divine Truth that proceeds into universal manifestation — the Divine principle that purifies wisdom from its admixture with falsity by displaying the Divine image* (Envoy, king of the zone)

As the figure who displays his likeness to purify light from darkness, the Envoy corresponds to the mediating function of Divine Truth — the proceeding that makes the Divine visible to all degrees of creation, drawing forth captive good by revealing the Divine likeness.

The Envoy's distinctive act is displaying his 'image' — a correspondential term for the Divine Human form made perceptible to the understanding. When evil sees this likeness it lusts for it and generates counterfeits (Adam and Eve), teaching that the

proprium cannot truly receive the Divine form but can only imitate it externally. (Ch. 1, 4, 5, 7, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 18, 19, 21, 23, 26, 27, 29)

the Kingdom of Wisdom — *The Lord as Divine Wisdom made radiant — Divine Truth in its fullness of glory, proceeding to illuminate, liberate, and regenerate* (the Kingdom of Wisdom, the glorious one, Son of Greatness)

As the figure who hunts after light and life through wisdom, who uproots evil perceptions and plants the tree of life, and who descends to Adam and Eve to give hope, the Kingdom of Wisdom corresponds to Divine Truth in its saving, illuminating, and regenerative power — the Word made manifest.

The Kingdom of Wisdom occupies the fourth position in the hierarchy of 'fathers' and 'days,' corresponding to the fourth degree of illumination. His distinctive function is twofold: uprooting false perceptions (the bad fig-garden) and planting genuine ones (the tree of life). His 'twelve wisdoms' correspond to the twelve truths derived from good. (Ch. 4, 5, 7, 8, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 18, 19, 23, 32)

the Bounteous Spirit — *The Divine Truth proceeding from Love as the generative matrix of all spiritual life — the first operation of the Divine into created existence* (Great Spirit, first Bounteous Spirit, Mother of the living, first Mother)

As the first emanation from the Father who gives birth to Lord Wisdom and intercedes for his rescue, the Bounteous Spirit corresponds to the Divine Wisdom in its generative and life-giving aspect — the proceeding Divine Truth that is the matrix or womb from which all derivative spiritual states are born.

The Bounteous Spirit is described as spending immeasurable time within the Father before being called forth — corresponding to the Swedenborgian teaching that Divine Truth exists in potential within Divine Love before proceeding. She is always paired with the Lord of Covenants in the work of constructing the universe. (Ch. 3, 7, 9, 10, 11, 13, 16, 18, 19, 31, 43)

the Maiden — *Pure uncorrupted wisdom — the affection of truth from good in its pristine, celestial innocence* (light virgin, holy virgin)

As the figure who captivates the rulers through her beauty and gathers her own back to herself, the Virgin corresponds to pure truth united with celestial innocence — truth that is uncorrupted by any admixture of falsity, and whose spiritual beauty draws captive good toward liberation.

The Virgin's function of 'taking the heart of the rulers by her likeness' corresponds to how pure truth from good, by its inherent spiritual beauty, dispossesses evil of the good it holds captive. The extended parable of the free woman in her palace describes how celestial truth does not voluntarily expose itself to external states except out of love for the entrapped divine good. (Ch. 3, 7, 10, 18, 19, 20, 36, 39, 42)

Good Mind — *The Lord's Divine Wisdom entering and operating within the human understanding — the interior illumination that regenerates the person* (Mind, the Mind)

As the figure who descends into the individual body, binds the old man, loosens the soul's faculties from bondage, and constructs the new man, the Good Mind corresponds to Divine Wisdom as it flows into and transforms the individual human understanding — the actual operative power of regeneration within the person.

The Good Mind's entry into the body and its binding of the old man with five counsels directly corresponds to Swedenborg's teaching that the Lord's influx into the natural mind progressively subordinates the proprium. The Mind comes in secret, in love, with the Maiden — that is, through interior affection and pure truth. (Ch. 7, 10, 18, 19, 23, 30)

Hearkening — *The sustaining Divine Truth that connects all degrees — the fully regenerated Divine Human form that upholds all spiritual order from the lowest to the highest* (Hearkening, great porter, Pillar)

As the cosmic column bearing all things and connecting earth to heaven, the Pillar corresponds to the Lord's Divine Truth as it forms the ordered axis through which all influx descends and all purified good ascends — the vertical structure of discrete degrees made into a single form.

The Pillar is identified both as a cosmic structure and as Hearkening — teaching that the fully regenerated human is itself the living connection between the lowest natural and the highest celestial. As one of the 'three great rocks,' it represents foundational truth that cannot be moved. (Ch. 2, 3, 4, 7, 8, 10, 11, 23, 32, 36)

Greed — *The proprium — the corporeal mind devoid of spiritual life; the self-derived will that fashions all forms of evil* (thought of death, sculptress, mother of demons)

As the female power that sculpts the world of darkness and gives strength to its king for war, Greed corresponds to the proprium — the inherited self-will that generates and sustains all forms of evil and falsity by fashioning them into organized external forms that imitate genuine life.

Greed is consistently called 'the thought of death' — the proprium conceived not as inert substance but as an active intention toward spiritual death. She is the 'mother' of all evil affections, corresponding to Swedenborg's teaching that the proprium is the womb from which all particular evils are born. (Ch. 2, 4, 6, 16, 17, 27)

Evil Spirit — *The ruling principle of self-love — the sovereign evil that governs all states of falsity from evil* (Evil Spirit, Evil Spirit, chief of demons)

As the supreme ruler of the five dark worlds who consolidates all evil under himself for war against the light, this figure corresponds to the ruling love of self in its most organized and dominant form — the love of dominion from self that is the head of all hells.

The five shapes upon the King (lion, demon, eagle, dragon, fish) correspond to five genera of evil operating through him. His qualities — hardness, magic, limited perception — describe how ruling self-love is impervious to truth, operates through persuasive falsity, and can only perceive what is immediately present (i.e., has no foresight). (Ch. 6, 15, 17)

the Final Body — *The fully realized Divine Human form — the completed Grand Man of all regenerated good and truth gathered into final unity* (the Final Body)

As the ultimate form into which all purified life is gathered and sculpted at the end, the Final Body corresponds to the completed universal human — the Grand Man of heaven in its final perfection, composed of every good and truth that has been liberated from its captivity in the natural world.

The Final Body teaching parallels Swedenborg's Grand Man (Maximus Homo) — the complete form of heaven constituted from all angelic societies. Its being 'sculpted' from what is gathered teaches that the collective form of heaven is not automatic but requires active divine ordering. (Ch. 5, 12, 13, 16, 18, 21, 24, 31, 34)

Summons — *The Lord's calling forth of divine truth — the active influx of truth from the Divine into the human will* (the call, summons)

As the voice sent from above to the captive Lord Wisdom, the summons corresponds to the active proceeding of truth from the Lord — the Divine call that penetrates into the deepest states of captivity and initiates the process of liberation and regeneration.

The summons and the obedience together form a conjugial pair — the father-principle and mother-principle of spiritual communication. The summons is always active and descending; the obedience is always receptive and ascending. (Ch. 4, 5, 8, 10, 11, 12, 13, 18, 37, 38, 42, 44)

Obedience — *The will's willing reception of divine truth — the responsive ascent of good toward the Lord's calling* (the answer, the hearing, the obedience)

As the answer that ascends from Lord Wisdom back to the Lord of Covenants, the obedience corresponds to the human will's free response to divine truth — the reception and acknowledgment that completes the circuit of influx and makes regeneration possible.

The obedience is compared to a letter written from the battlefield — the interior communication of all temptation-states back to the Divine. This teaching corresponds to Swedenborg's doctrine that the Lord perceives all states of the person in temptation through the medium of the person's own responsive acknowledgment. (Ch. 4, 5, 8, 10, 11, 12, 13, 18, 37, 38, 42, 44)

the Dawn — *The Divine Wisdom that organizes understanding into coherent form — the power of divine ordering that constructs the interior architecture of the regenerating mind* (architect)

As the master architect who constructs buildings according to plan, the Dawn corresponds to the ordering power of Divine Wisdom — the capacity to organize scattered truths and goods into a coherent, functional spiritual structure that can serve as a dwelling for the Divine.

The Builder constructs both the 'new aeon of joy' (= new heaven) and 'a prison for the enemy' — teaching that the same ordering wisdom that builds heaven also constructs the permanent containment of hell. (Ch. 10, 11, 18, 19, 21, 26, 29)

King of Radiance — *The Divine Good made manifest through wisdom — the union of love and truth as perceived by all illuminated faculties* (King of Radiance)

As the beloved one who is honored among all the lights, this figure corresponds to the Divine Good united with wisdom — the quality of love as it is perceived and cherished by all faculties of spiritual intelligence.

Associated with the Dawn and the Lord of Covenants as part of the third greatness. Represents the affectional dimension of the Lord's operation — what is loved and honored among all who perceive truth. (Ch. 7, 10, 11, 16, 19, 28)

Cosmic Elements & Substances (15)

light — *Divine wisdom — truth proceeding from love that illuminates the understanding* (radiance, splendour, luminous, shining, rays)

As the universal medium of vision and knowledge, light corresponds to divine wisdom and truth — that which proceeds from the Lord's love and enables the understanding to perceive spiritual realities. Light is the form that love takes when it enters the intellect.

Opposite sense: When stolen or counterfeited by evil: falsified truth, or truth appropriated to self

The most fundamental correspondence in the entire text. 'Light' pervades every chapter and is consistently rendered as wisdom or truth from the Divine. The five 'light elements' are wisdom differentiated into its five constituent faculties. (Ch. 1, 2, 8, 14, 28, 34)

darkness — *Falsity from evil — the absence and opposition of divine wisdom; spiritual ignorance proceeding from self-love* (the Darkness, shadow, night, black)

As the absence and enemy of light, darkness corresponds to falsity proceeding from evil — not mere ignorance but the active privation and corruption of truth that flows from self-love and constitutes the essential nature of all hells.

Darkness is not merely passive absence but active opposition — it 'stirs itself,' 'rises up,' and 'makes war.' This corresponds to Swedenborg's teaching that falsity from evil is not mere privation but a living, active force proceeding from the hells. (Ch. 1, 2, 4, 15, 28, 34)

fire (living) — *Divine Love — celestial love that is the inmost life of all spiritual reality* (living fire, holy fire)

As the element that is 'above them all' and constitutes the inmost garment of Lord Wisdom, living fire corresponds to Divine Love — the supreme animating principle from which all other spiritual faculties derive their life.

Living fire is present in eight places according to the text — eight states of spiritual order. It is the first and last garment of Lord Wisdom, teaching that divine love is both the inmost origin and the ultimate consummation of all the Lord's work. The living fire 'withers the tumescence of the enemy' — love alone has power to collapse the inflation of self-love. (Ch. 3, 5, 8, 28, 38)

fire (dark) — *Self-love — the consuming infernal love that burns with the desire to dominate and possess* (dark fire, fire of the rulers, furnace of fire)

As the element belonging to the world of fire whose king is lion-faced, dark fire corresponds to self-love — the love of dominating others from oneself that is the ruling evil of the hells and the consuming passion that destroys all genuine spiritual life.

Dark fire is paired with 'lust' as the father and mother of all evil generation. The great fire at the end of the world that dissolves all things corresponds to the final judgment through divine love consuming what is false. (Ch. 1, 2, 4, 6, 12, 15, 16, 17, 26)

water (living) — *Living truth — truth that purifies, regenerates, and carries spiritual life* (living waters)

As the element in which Lord Wisdom dwells (in his ship) and which purifies and regenerates, living water corresponds to truth that carries genuine spiritual life — truth proceeding from good that cleanses the understanding and sustains the soul.

The 'ship of living waters' is consistently identified with the moon and with Lord Wisdom's dwelling — teaching that truth as doctrine is the containing form through which celestial good operates in the spiritual degree. (Ch. 2, 3, 8, 10, 14)

water (dark) — *Falsity itself — corrupted truth; the pervasive medium through which evil is communicated and spread* (dark waters, poison, vessel of water)

As the dark element whose king is fish-faced and whose taste is deceptive sweetness, dark water corresponds to falsity in its fluid, pervasive form — corrupted truth that flows through all states of the mind, carrying evil influence wherever it goes.

The dark water vessels are the first to be discharged from the heavens — corresponding to the teaching that falsities of the understanding are addressed before the deeper evils of the will in regeneration. (Ch. 6, 15, 26)

wind (living) — *The living influx of the spirit — the active flow of understanding into the mind from the Divine* (living wind)

As the element that blows and moves actively, living wind corresponds to the influx of spiritual understanding — the breath of the Divine spirit that flows into the rational faculty and gives it the power of active thought.

Wind as one of the three garments of the Lord of Covenants corresponds to the doctrine of understanding — the external form of truth operating in the rational plane. (Ch. 8, 20, 26)

wind (dark) — *False persuasion — vain reasoning; the force of argument from falsity* (world of wind)

As the dark element whose king is eagle-faced and whose taste is 'sharp,' dark wind corresponds to false persuasion — the force of reasoning from falsity that cuts and divides, creating the appearance of intellectual power while serving evil ends.

The eagle-faced quality of the wind-king corresponds to predatory intellectual sight — rationality that seizes and devours rather than illuminates. (Ch. 6, 15, 17)

smoke — *Obscurity of understanding — dense falsity arising from evil that darkens the intellect* (world of Smoke)

As the element that obscures vision and rises from burning, smoke corresponds to the obscurity of understanding that arises when the mind's intellectual faculty is dominated by self-love — dense falsity that clouds all perception.

The world of Smoke is consistently identified with the 'mind' (nous) — but in its perverted form, the intellectual faculty given over to evil. Its king came up 'from the depth of darkness' as the first to make war, teaching that intellectual pride proceeding from self-love is the origin of all spiritual assault. (Ch. 2, 6, 11, 15)

air (living) — *The living sphere of spiritual perception — the rational atmosphere in which the mind breathes and perceives truth* (living air)

As the element that all flesh lives upon by breathing, the living air corresponds to the sphere of spiritual perception — the rational atmosphere proceeding from the Divine in which the understanding subsists and through which it perceives all spiritual realities.

The living air is unique among the five elements: it alone was not wounded in the first combat. This corresponds to the teaching that the rational sphere of spiritual life — the inmost level of understanding closest to the celestial — cannot be penetrated by falsity from evil. It becomes the 'spirit of life' for the other four, teaching that the rational degree sustains all lower faculties. (Ch. 5, 8, 14, 20, 28, 42)

gold — *Semblance of celestial good — the external form that counterfeits heavenly love; or, positively, celestial good itself*

As the most precious metal associated with the body of the King of Smoke, gold corresponds to the appearance of celestial good — which, when appropriated by evil, becomes the most dangerous form of counterfeit: evil disguised as the highest good.

Opposite sense: When attributed to the Evil Spirit: the counterfeit of celestial good used as a disguise for evil

Gold belonging to the rulers of Smoke (perverted intellect) signifies how self-love clothes itself in the appearance of celestial good. This is the deepest deception — evil that presents itself not merely as natural good but as divine love itself. (Ch. 6, 13, 44)

silver — *Spiritual truth — or, when belonging to darkness, falsified truth*

As the metal associated with the rulers of the world of Water, silver corresponds to truth in its spiritual form — which, when corrupted, becomes falsified truth that retains the appearance of truth while serving falsehood.

Opposite sense: When attributed to the realm of water/darkness: truth perverted to serve evil ends

Silver belongs to the water-world, whose king is fish-faced. The conjunction of silver with deceptive sweetness teaches that falsified truth is especially dangerous because it tastes pleasant — it satisfies the understanding's desire for truth while actually confirming falsity. (Ch. 6, 13, 44)

copper — *Perverted natural good — natural good turned to serve self-love*

As the metal associated with the rulers of the world of Fire, copper corresponds to natural good that has been perverted — external acts of good performed not from charity but from the love of dominion.

Copper belongs to the fire-world (self-love). Swedenborg identifies copper with natural good; here in the dark sense it signifies natural good made to serve infernal ends. (Ch. 6)

iron — *Hardened natural truth — truth in its most unyielding and resistant form; or natural truth applied with severity*

As the hardest common metal and the body of the wind-world rulers, iron corresponds to natural truth in its most rigid form — which, when perverted, becomes hardened falsity that resists all penetration by genuine truth.

Opposite sense: When belonging to darkness: hardened natural falsity impervious to correction

Iron's hardness is emphasized repeatedly in describing the Evil Spirit's impenetrability. In its positive sense, iron implements are used to work the earth — corresponding to natural truths applied to reform the natural mind. (Ch. 6)

lead — *The densest, basest falsity — the heaviest and most external form of perverted truth* (lead and tin)

As the heaviest metal assigned to the world of pure Darkness, lead corresponds to the densest and most external form of falsity — falsity so heavy with evil that it sinks to the lowest possible state.

Lead belongs to the dragon-ruled world of pure Darkness, the lowest of all infernal states. Its extreme density corresponds to falsity so deeply embedded in evil that it constitutes the very substance of the lowest hell. (Ch. 6)

Structural Terms (13)

aeon — *A discrete state of spiritual life — a heavenly degree or society within the Lord's kingdom* (aeons of light, aeons of greatness, aeons of glory)

As the cosmic realm in which divine beings dwell, an aeon corresponds to a discrete state or degree of spiritual life — each aeon being a distinct condition of reception of the Divine, from the most celestial to the most natural.

Opposite sense: When belonging to darkness: an infernal state or hellish condition

The text uses 'aeon' for both positive and negative states — 'aeons of light' and by implication 'aeons of darkness.' The 'new aeon' constructed by the Dawn corresponds to the new heaven established after the last judgment. (Ch. 1, 3, 4, 10, 14, 16, 24)

ship — *A containing form or vessel — a doctrinal structure that carries and conveys divine good or truth through successive states* (ship of living fire, ship of living waters, ship of the day, ship of the night, light ship, carriage, vehicle)

As the vessel that carries beings across the cosmic sea, a ship corresponds to a doctrinal form or vessel of reception — the organized structure of truth that carries the mind's affections and understandings from one state to another.

Opposite sense: When dark: a containing form emptied of life

The two primary ships — of living fire (sun/day) and living waters (moon/night) — correspond to the two fundamental doctrinal vessels: the doctrine of celestial love and the doctrine of spiritual truth. The sun's ship never wanes while the moon's does, teaching that the vessel of love is perpetually full while the vessel of faith fluctuates. (Ch. 1, 2, 3, 5, 6, 8, 14, 17, 19, 21, 26, 34)

firmament — *A discrete degree of heavenly order — a structural separation between interior and exterior states of the mind* (firmaments, ten firmaments)

As the solid boundary dividing upper from lower cosmic regions, a firmament corresponds to a discrete degree of spiritual order — the structural boundary that separates one level of the mind from the next, preventing improper mixing while allowing ordered influx.

The 'ten firmaments' correspond to the ten ascending degrees of heavenly consciousness. Doors opening in the firmaments correspond to communications between discrete degrees being opened by Divine influx. (Ch. 7, 13, 19, 21, 22, 23, 26, 27, 29)

wheel — *The providential cycle of spiritual reformation — the revolving order of knowledges and states through which the mind is progressively purified* (wheel of the stars, wheel of the sphere, wheel of the course, sphere)

As the revolving sphere that carries the stars and zodiac, the wheel corresponds to the ordered cycle of Divine Providence — the revolving arrangement of spiritual knowledges and states that serves as both a purifying mechanism and a restraint upon evil.

The wheel is described as having no root in the earth but gaining authority through the fall of evil upon it — teaching that the cycle of natural knowledges has no inherent spiritual power but gained dominion over the proprium only because evil contaminated it during the fall. (Ch. 1, 2, 7, 21, 22, 26, 27)

bond — *Divine restraint upon evil — the ordering power that confines falsity and evil within limits so they cannot spread* (chain, fetter, seal, lump)

As the chain that holds the rulers in their appointed places, a bond corresponds to the divine ordering that restrains evil within fixed limits — preventing the hells from exceeding their appointed bounds and destroying spiritual freedom.

Opposite sense: When imposed by evil: the captivity and bondage in which the proprium holds the living soul

The 'lump' — the final bond — is the ultimate consolidated mass of evil from which there is no liberation. It corresponds to the eternal state of hell where evil is permanently sealed. (Ch. 1, 2, 7, 12, 16, 25, 26)

throne — *A governing principle of spiritual authority — a seat of divine judgment and governance over a particular domain* (thrones)

As the seat upon which a ruler exercises authority, a throne corresponds to a governing principle — the organized authority through which the Divine or its opposite exercises dominion over a particular region of the spiritual world.

Opposite sense: When belonging to darkness: a seat of evil power

Eighteen thrones are named — nine in the interior heavens and nine in the intermediate sphere — teaching that divine governance operates through corresponding degrees in both the celestial kingdom and the world of spirits. (Ch. 4, 18, 19)

earth — *The natural mind — the ground of reception upon which spiritual life is built; or the celestial good in which the Divine dwells* (land, ground, earths, three earths, light-earth, earth of Darkness)

As the ground that receives seed and produces growth, the earth corresponds to the natural mind as receptive ground — the plane of consciousness where spiritual truths are implanted and either grow into good works or are choked by evil.

Opposite sense: When qualified as 'of Darkness': the natural mind given over to falsity from evil

The 'three earths' correspond to three degrees of the natural mind. The 'light-earth' of the Father is the infinite ground of divine good. The 'earth of Darkness' is the natural mind wholly given over to evil. The text consistently teaches that these earths are 'conjoined' — the natural mind is a unified structure with discrete levels. (Ch. 1, 2, 4, 7, 11, 14, 23, 25, 26, 27, 32, 36, 39)

mountain — *An elevated state of love or perception — or, in the negative sense, a state of self-exaltation in falsity* (mountains, four mountains, hills)

As elevated terrain rising above the plain, mountains correspond to elevated states of the will — either genuine states of celestial love rising toward the Divine, or the inflated pride of self-love exalting itself above its proper degree.

Opposite sense: When belonging to darkness: prideful self-exaltation; mountains of Darkness = states of self-exaltation in falsity

The 'four mountains' surrounding the earth correspond to four elevated states of celestial good that enclose and protect the natural mind. Mountains in the realm of darkness correspond to pride — the 'black mountain near the sunrise' signifies self-intelligence persisting even near the source of illumination. (Ch. 1, 6, 16, 26, 27, 34)

vessel — *A containing form of reception — a doctrinal or structural form that holds and conveys spiritual substance* (vessels, three vessels, vessel of fire, vessel of darkness, vessel of water)

As a container that holds and preserves its contents, a vessel corresponds to a containing form — the organized doctrinal or mental structure through which spiritual substance (whether good or evil) is received, preserved, and conveyed.

Opposite sense: When dark: a containing form of evil — a structure that holds falsity or perverted love

The 'three vessels' that surround the universe correspond to containing forms of corrupted truth, falsity, and infernal desire. Their being 'discharged' corresponds to the process of vastation — evils first brought into conscious awareness and then expelled. (Ch. 1, 2, 16, 21, 26, 27)

wall — *A protective boundary of truth — the outermost enclosure that separates and protects the regenerated mind from external evil* (walls, wall of fire, four walls)

As the outermost enclosure of a city or building, a wall corresponds to the protective boundary of truth — the outermost doctrinal truths that surround and defend the interior life from invasion by falsity from evil.

The 'wall of great fire' that surrounds the entire building corresponds to the ultimate boundary of divine love that encloses all creation — within which evil is confined and from which the aeons of light are protected. (Ch. 21, 26, 27)

gate — *A passage of communication between degrees — the opening through which influx passes from one state of the mind to another* (door, portal, orifice)

As an opening that permits or prevents passage, a gate corresponds to the means of communication between discrete spiritual degrees — the openings through which divine influx enters or through which the soul passes from one state to another.

Gates opening before influx and closing behind it corresponds to the teaching that each discrete degree receives the Divine proceeding and then seals itself — influx moves only in one direction through discrete degrees. (Ch. 21, 30, 34, 42)

conduit — *A pathway of spiritual influx — the channel through which divine life flows between interior and exterior degrees of the mind* (root, pathway)

As a channel that conducts fluid between locations, a conduit corresponds to a pathway of spiritual influx — the living connection through which good and truth flow between the celestial, spiritual, and natural degrees of the mind, and through which evil is also discharged downward.

Three conduits connect the entirety of the zone from abyss to heights — corresponding to three pathways of influx linking the lowest natural to the highest celestial. The teaching that conduits cannot be 'cut' because they are spiritual corresponds to the doctrine that influx is self-healing and cannot be permanently disrupted. (Ch. 27, 39)

zone — *The intermediate sphere between good and evil — the boundary between the spiritual and the natural; the world of spirits* (circuit, boundary)

As the intermediate region between the upper and lower worlds, the zone corresponds to the boundary between interior and exterior states of the mind — the intermediate spiritual realm where good and evil are still mixed and where the processes of separation and judgment operate.

The zone is the realm where all active governance takes place — where the five watches operate, where the Good Mind enters the body, and where the paths of ascent and descent are established. It corresponds to the world of spirits between heaven and hell. (Ch. 7, 12, 13, 16, 19, 22, 23, 36, 39)

Body & Anatomy (4)

head — *The ruling love — the governing principle of the whole spiritual life; or, inmost wisdom*

As the part of the body from which all other members depend and which contains the organs of highest perception, the head corresponds to the ruling love — the single governing affection from which all other faculties of the spiritual life proceed and upon which they all depend.

The text explicitly teaches the correspondence: 'as the root of all limbs hang upon the head, so if one limb be cut off while the head exists, there is hope; but if the head be cut off, the entire body dies.' This directly parallels Swedenborg's teaching about the ruling love. (Ch. 6, 20, 23, 28, 36)

heart — *The will — the seat of love and the innermost center of spiritual life*

As the organ that circulates life-giving blood through the body, the heart corresponds to the will — the central faculty of love from which all spiritual life flows and which governs the direction and quality of the whole person's existence.

The heart is described as 'the king' to whom all five senses report — corresponding to the will as the central governing faculty that receives input from all perceptive functions. The heart being likened to the Lord of the Settled Lands who governs the seven firmaments teaches that the will governs all rational degrees. (Ch. 23, 30, 36)

eye — *Intellectual sight — the faculty of the understanding by which spiritual truth is perceived* (eyes, organs of sight, pupil)

As the organ that receives light and forms images, the eye corresponds to intellectual sight — the understanding's capacity to perceive truth, discern forms, and apprehend spiritual realities through the light of divine wisdom.

The two eyes are likened to the two ships of light (sun and moon) — the containing forms of love and truth by which the understanding perceives. The pupil that perceives by day but not by night teaches that intellectual sight operates only in states of spiritual illumination. (Ch. 23, 30, 32, 34, 36, 42)

ear — *Obedient reception — the faculty by which divine truth is heard and received into the understanding* (ears, organs of hearing)

As the organ that receives sound, the ear corresponds to the faculty of obedient reception — the understanding's capacity to hear and receive truth communicated from the Divine or from others.

The ear's repository that preserves sound 'for a thousand days' corresponds to the memory's preservation of heard truths through a complete state of spiritual development. (Ch. 30, 36)

Natural Imagery (22)

tree (good) — *Perception rooted in divine wisdom — a living system of understanding that grows from good and produces genuine spiritual works* (good tree, tree of life)

As a living organism that grows from its root, draws nourishment from the earth, and produces fruit, the good tree corresponds to a perception rooted in divine wisdom — an organized system of understanding that draws life from the Lord's love and produces genuine works of charity.

The good tree has five limbs corresponding to five ascending faculties (consideration, counsel, teaching, thought, mind) — teaching that genuine perception is organized in discrete ascending degrees from outermost reception to inmost willing. (Ch. 2, 12, 27)

tree (bad) — *Perception rooted in self-intelligence — a system of understanding that grows from evil and produces only false and harmful works* (bad tree, tree of fire)

As a tree that grows from corrupted soil and produces inedible or poisonous fruit, the bad tree corresponds to perception rooted in self-intelligence — understanding organized not from divine influx but from the proprium, producing works that are spiritually harmful.

The bad tree has the same five-limb structure as the good tree but inverted — teaching that self-intelligence mimics the structure of genuine wisdom but reverses its direction: from the rule of spiritual death to the ultimate mass of consolidated evil. (Ch. 2, 11)

fruit (good) — *Good works — the deeds of charity that flow from genuine perception of truth united with love* (good fruit, nourishing fruit)

As the product of a tree's growth that provides nourishment, good fruit corresponds to the works of charity — the deeds and effects that proceed from a mind rooted in divine wisdom and animated by genuine love of the neighbor.

The teaching that good fruit cannot arise from the bad tree directly parallels the Lord's teaching in Matthew 7:18. (Ch. 2, 11, 12, 34)

fruit (bad) — *Evil works — deeds proceeding from self-love and falsity that harm spiritual life* (evil fruits, bad fruit)

As the inedible or poisonous product of a corrupted tree, bad fruit corresponds to evil works — the deeds and their effects that proceed from self-intelligence and self-love, which damage both the doer and others.

The text teaches that evil 'spent a long time in the fruits before it sculpted the demons' — evil works precede and eventually give rise to organized evil affections. (Ch. 2, 11, 16)

garment — *External truth clothing interior good — the outermost layer of truth that protects, accommodates, and makes the interior accessible* (garments, rags, clothing, armour, five garments)

As the outermost covering of the body that protects and presents the person, garments correspond to external truths — the outermost doctrinal coverings that clothe interior good, protect it from profanation, and accommodate it for reception by others.

Opposite sense: When torn or ragged: devastated and degraded truths stripped of their life
The five garments of Lord Wisdom are five successive layers of external truth by which the Divine accommodated itself for combat with the hells. The three garments of the Lord of Covenants (wind, fire, water) correspond to the three doctrinal forms through which Providence operates. 'Rags' signify degraded truths still containing some life. (Ch. 1, 7, 9, 15, 20, 23, 26, 28, 37)

sun — *The Lord as Divine Love — or Divine Truth proceeding from love as the source of all spiritual illumination* (light-giver of the day)

As the source of all light and warmth in the natural world, the sun corresponds to the Lord as Divine Love and Wisdom — the one source from which all spiritual illumination and warmth of charity proceed into the created universe.

The sun's ship 'never wanes' while the moon's does — teaching that the Lord's love is perpetually full and constant while faith fluctuates. Seven good things the sun does daily correspond to seven complete operations of divine truth in the regenerating mind. (Ch. 1, 3, 9, 32, 34, 35)

moon — *Faith from natural truth — divine truth as it operates in states of spiritual obscurity; the containing form of truth* (light-giver of the night, ship of living waters)

As the lesser light that shines by reflected light in the night, the moon corresponds to faith — truth received from the Lord that illuminates the understanding even in states of spiritual obscurity, though with reflected rather than direct light.

The moon waxes and wanes while the sun does not — teaching that faith fluctuates while love remains constant. The moon is always paired with 'living waters' (truth), distinguishing it from the sun's 'living fire' (love). (Ch. 1, 3, 10, 19, 35)

star — *Knowledge of good and truth — particular items of spiritual knowledge that illuminate like individual points of light* (stars, wheel of the stars)

As individual points of light in the heavens, stars correspond to particular knowledges of good and truth — the discrete items of spiritual understanding that together constitute the complete body of knowledge through which the mind is illuminated.

Stars are bound on the revolving wheel — teaching that knowledges of spiritual truth are organized within the cyclical order of Providence. The stars' authority over the flesh came through the fall — not from inherent power but from evil contaminating the cycle of natural knowledge. (Ch. 7, 22, 26, 27, 29)

sea — *The general mass of natural knowledge — the vast aggregate of sensory and factual knowledge in the outermost memory* (great sea, inner sea, waters)

As the vast body of water that receives all rivers and upon which ships sail, the sea corresponds to the general mass of natural knowledge in the external memory — the aggregate of sensory experience and factual knowing upon which doctrinal systems navigate.

The salty inner sea signifies natural knowledge adulterated by the residue of evil — corresponding to how the outermost memory inevitably carries traces of corruption. The sea giant formed within the sea corresponds to the monstrous composite selfhood that consolidates within this mass of natural knowledge. (Ch. 5, 23, 26)

river — *A stream of truth — a particular flowing current of understanding proceeding from a higher source* (rivers, streams, Tigris)

As a flowing body of water that proceeds from a source and nourishes the land through which it passes, a river corresponds to a stream of truth — a particular flow of understanding that proceeds from a higher spiritual source and nourishes the mind through which it passes.

The Tigris is described as merely one river among thousands of rivers from unrevealed secrets — teaching that any particular natural-plane stream of truth is only a minute fraction of the immense flow of truth from the Divine. (Ch. 26, 27, 32)

pearl — *A precious interior truth of faith — a truth of great spiritual value formed through suffering and refinement*

As a precious object formed within a living creature under adverse conditions, a pearl corresponds to an interior truth of faith — a spiritual understanding of great value that is refined and perfected through the process of temptation.

Lord Wisdom being brought up 'like a pearl from the sea' teaches that the celestial state of innocence is rescued from the overwhelming mass of natural knowledge as a truth of supreme value is drawn from the depths. (Ch. 21)

net — *Encompassing doctrine — the organized teaching of truth that captures and draws forth spiritual life from its captivity in falsity*

As an implement that captures what is within a body of water, a net corresponds to encompassing doctrine — the organized system of truth through which the Divine draws forth captive good and truth from the general mass of natural knowledge.

Opposite sense: When belonging to evil: the persuasive means by which self-love ensnares spiritual life
Each of the four divine hunters uses a distinct net — teaching that each degree of divine operation employs its own form of encompassing doctrine suited to the plane on which it operates. (Ch. 5, 10, 13)

cloud — *Obscured truth — truth in its natural, accommodated form; truth veiled for reception by lower states* (clouds)

As a formation that carries water between heaven and earth while obscuring the sun, a cloud corresponds to truth in its natural, obscured form — divine truth veiled and accommodated so that it can descend into lower states of the mind for reception.

The four types of clouds (fire, water, wind, light) correspond to four modes of obscured truth ascending from the four elements toward purification. Each type releases its ruling evil upon ascent, corresponding to how truths rising toward purity trigger the expulsion of embedded falsities. (Ch. 5, 6, 39)

seed — *Interior truth in its seminal state — truth implanted in the mind that has the potential to grow into understanding and produce good works* (seed grain, grain)

As the germ from which a plant grows, a seed corresponds to an interior truth in its earliest state — truth implanted by the Lord in the understanding that contains within itself the potential for growth into full comprehension and the production of charitable works.

Seeds that are 'threshed, plucked, and cut down' correspond to interior truths that are violated and consumed by the proprium before they can mature. (Ch. 37, 39, 41)

lion — *The lust for dominion from self-love — the predatory quality of the ruling love of self that seeks to devour and control all others* (lion-faced)

As the predatory animal associated with the pride of dominion over all other beasts, the lion corresponds to the lust for dominion from self-love — the quality of the ruling self that seeks to exert supreme power over all things.

The lion-face of the Evil Spirit's head and the king of the fire-world teaches that the love of dominion is the highest quality of evil — the 'head' of all infernal organization. (Ch. 6, 17)

eagle — *Predatory rationality — intellectual power turned to self-serving ends; the capacity to see from above in order to seize* (eagle-faced)

As the bird that sees from great heights and swoops down to seize prey, the eagle corresponds to predatory rationality — the intellectual faculty when it serves self-love, using its elevated perspective not to illuminate but to identify and capture what it desires.

The eagle-face of the Evil Spirit's shoulders and the wind-world king teaches that false reasoning occupies the 'shoulders' of evil — the power and capacity that evil uses to elevate itself and attack from above. (Ch. 6, 17)

dragon — *The falsification of all truth — the comprehensive distortion of understanding that perverts every true perception into its opposite* (dragon-faced)

As the mythological beast that combines predatory qualities with deception, the dragon corresponds to the falsification of all truth — the comprehensive corruption of the understanding that twists every genuine perception into a counterfeit serving evil ends.

The dragon with fourteen heads described in the final chapters is explicitly equated with 'the thought of the body' — self-derived thinking in all its organized complexity, with seven perceptive faculties above and seven below. (Ch. 6, 17, 40)

fish — *Base corporeal knowing — the lowest form of natural knowledge perverted to infernal ends* (fish-faced)

As the creature that lives in the depths of water and cannot rise above it, the fish corresponds to the most sensory and corporeal form of knowing — natural knowledge that remains at the lowest level and, when perverted, serves only the basest purposes.

Opposite sense: In positive sense: natural knowledge seized from the waters of the external mind

The fish-face of the Evil Spirit's tail corresponds to the most external expression of evil — the ultimates of sensory cunning. Being caught 'like fish in the sea' signifies natural knowledges seized from the mass of sensory knowledge. (Ch. 6, 13, 17)

perfume — *The perception of spiritual delight — the sphere of good perceived through interior sense; the quality of celestial acknowledgment* (scent, aroma, odour, fragrance)

As the subtle quality perceived through the sense of smell, perfume corresponds to the sphere of spiritual good as perceived through interior sensation — the delight of love perceived not through the understanding but through the affectional plane.

Opposite sense: When foul: spiritual putrefaction and corruption

The Father's 'sweet perfume' that 'takes away all affliction' corresponds to the sphere of divine good that, when perceived, removes all spiritual suffering. The 'stench' of evil is its opposite — the sphere of corruption that emanates from hell. (Ch. 1, 14, 26, 30, 34)

crown — *The highest governing wisdom — supreme truth that crowns and rules the whole spiritual life* (diadem, wreath)

As the ornament placed upon the head signifying supreme authority, a crown corresponds to the highest wisdom — the governing truth that presides over the whole of the spiritual life and signifies authority derived from the Divine.

Three types are distinguished: diadem (highest wisdom), wreath (intelligence), crown (illuminated knowledge) — corresponding to three degrees of truth that govern the regenerate mind. (Ch. 7, 38)

bird — *Thought — a swift act of spiritual perception; rational thought that rises freely through the atmosphere of the mind*

As a creature that moves freely through the air, a bird corresponds to thought — the rational faculty that rises through the spiritual atmosphere, moving freely between states of perception. A bird with its feathers plucked represents thought stripped of its truths.

A person whose Good Mind departs becomes 'as if a bird were its feathers plucked' — thought stripped of truth becomes merely natural. The bird's path through the air leaving no trace corresponds to how rational thought passes through the spiritual atmosphere without disrupting the channels of influx. (Ch. 6, 16, 23, 27, 39)

spring — *An origin of truth — a living source from which understanding flows forth* (well, fountain, source)

As a natural source from which water flows forth continuously, a spring corresponds to an origin of truth — a living interior source from which understanding and doctrine flow outward to nourish the mind.

Springs that are 'obstructed' in the three earths correspond to the impediment of truth-sources within the natural mind that must be cleared for regeneration to proceed. (Ch. 14, 23, 27)

Actions & Processes (9)

purification — *Spiritual reformation — the progressive separation of good from evil and truth from falsity within the regenerating mind* (cleansing, purifying, washing, refining)

As the process of removing impurities from a substance, purification corresponds to the spiritual process by which good is progressively separated from evil and truth from falsity — the essential work of regeneration that transforms the mixed state of the natural mind into ordered heavenly life.

The entire text presents purification as the central purpose of the created order — the universe itself is a mechanism designed for the progressive separation and purification of wisdom from its admixture with falsity. (Ch. 1, 12, 13, 18, 21, 26, 39, 42)

war — *Spiritual temptation — the combat between good and evil, truth and falsity, within the regenerating mind* (battle, combat, contest, struggle, fight)

As armed conflict between opposing forces, war corresponds to spiritual temptation — the intense interior combat in which the forces of divine good and truth contend against the forces of evil and falsity for possession of the person's will and understanding.

Five wars correspond to five degrees of spiritual combat — each more interior than the last, culminating in the work of providence that gathers all into the final form. (Ch. 1, 6, 9, 11, 13, 25, 28)

ascent — *Elevation toward celestial states — the progressive interiorization of the mind from natural to spiritual to celestial degrees* (rising, going up, ascending, elevation)

As upward movement from lower to higher ground, ascent corresponds to the elevation of the mind toward more interior states — the progressive movement from natural understanding through spiritual perception to celestial wisdom.

The ascent of the elements through successive degrees — light to fire to water to wind to air — corresponds to the gathering of goods and truths from outmost to inmost. (Ch. 1, 2, 8, 10, 23, 36, 39)

descent — *Proceeding into lower states — the accommodation of divine influx through successive degrees into the natural mind* (coming down, going down, falling)

As downward movement from higher to lower ground, descent corresponds to the proceeding of divine influx into lower degrees — the accommodation by which the infinite makes itself receivable in the finite, or the exposure of hidden evil into conscious awareness.

Opposite sense: When evil descends: the fall of evil from interior concealment into the natural mind where it can be confronted

Lord Wisdom's descent and the subsequent discharging of the three vessels both describe descent — but of opposite kinds: divine descent to rescue, and the descent of evil into conscious awareness for removal. Both are essential to regeneration. (Ch. 1, 8, 12, 13, 15, 16, 26)

sculpting — *The giving of determinate spiritual form — the active shaping of interior states into organized structures whether of good or evil* (fashioning, forming, moulding, constructing)

As the act of giving form to raw material, sculpting corresponds to the process of giving determinate spiritual form — whether the Divine ordering goods and truths into heavenly structures, or the proprium fashioning evil affections into organized systems of falsity.

Both the Divine and Greed 'sculpt' — teaching that the same process of giving form operates in opposite directions: the Divine forms goods and truths into heavenly order, while the proprium forms evils and falsities into organized hells. (Ch. 4, 5, 12, 16, 23, 26, 29, 30)

gathering — *The collecting of scattered goods and truths into spiritual unity — the progressive reintegration of what had been dispersed through the fall* (collecting, gathering in, sweeping)

As the act of collecting scattered things into one place, gathering corresponds to the spiritual process of reintegrating dispersed goods and truths — bringing back into unity what had been scattered through the fall into falsity and evil.

The Good Mind is called 'the gatherer in of the ones who are scattered' — Divine Wisdom's essential function is to collect all dispersed affections and truths back into the unity of the regenerate will. (Ch. 1, 5, 10, 12, 18, 36, 37)

transmigration — *Endless revolving from one false appearance into another — the condition of spiritual vastation in which the soul cycles through successive states without rest* (wandering)

As the passage of a soul through body after body without finding rest, transmigration corresponds to the spiritual condition of endless vastation — the perpetual cycling through successive false states that characterizes the intermediate condition of those not yet confirmed in either good or evil.

Transmigration is presented as one of the eight 'mixed' paths — neither pure ascent nor pure descent, but the intermediate condition of those whose spiritual state is not yet determined. (Ch. 2, 21, 39, 42)

kiss — *The conjunction of interior affections — the intimate union of love with truth, or of one good with another* (embrace, kiss of affection)

As the expression of intimate affection between persons, the kiss corresponds to the conjunction of interior affections — the spiritual union of love with truth, or of one celestial good with another, in which the inmost qualities of each are communicated.

One of the five mysteries of Lord Wisdom — five modes of spiritual conjunction. The kiss signifies the deepest mode of affectional union, distinct from the peace (conjunction of good), the right hand (communication of power), the salutation (humble acknowledgment), and the laying on of hands (transmission of authority). (Ch. 9)

laying on of hands — *The transmission of interior spiritual authority — the communication of governing power from a higher to a lower degree*

As the ritual gesture of conferring authority or blessing, the laying on of hands corresponds to the transmission of interior spiritual authority — the communication of governing power from a celestial good to its derivative, enabling the lower to act with the authority of the higher.

The second laying on of hands — given after Lord Wisdom's victory — enables him to 'become leader of his brethren in the new aeon,' teaching that authority to govern in the regenerated state is conferred only after the completion of temptation-combat. (Ch. 9)

Qualities & States (11)

life — *Spiritual life — the continuous reception of love and wisdom from the Lord into the will and understanding* (living, the living)

As the animating principle that distinguishes living beings from dead matter, life corresponds to spiritual life — the state of receiving influx of love and wisdom from the Lord, which alone constitutes genuine existence.

The text consistently pairs 'life' with 'light' as the two aspects of what the Divine hunters seek to recover — corresponding to Swedenborg's pairing of good (life) and truth (light) as the twofold proceeding from the Lord. (Ch. 1, 2, 5, 10, 12, 24, 27, 34)

death — *Spiritual death — the state of complete separation from the Lord's influx; the condition of the proprium when cut off from all divine life* (spiritual death, the dead, corpse, carcass)

As the cessation of biological life, death corresponds to spiritual death — the state in which the will and understanding are wholly cut off from the Lord's influx of love and wisdom, subsisting only in the reactive energies of self-love.

Two deaths are distinguished: the first is temporal (lasting until purification is complete) and the second is eternal. This maps precisely to Swedenborg's distinction between vastation (temporary) and the second death (permanent spiritual death). (Ch. 2, 11, 15, 16, 24)

peace — *Interior peace — the state of rest and conjunction that comes when goods and truths are conjoined and all conflict in the mind ceases* (greeting, calm, silence, rest, tranquillity)

As the cessation of conflict and the presence of harmony, peace corresponds to the interior spiritual state in which goods and truths are perfectly conjoined and there is no opposition between the will and the understanding — the deepest rest that comes from conjunction with the Divine.

The text teaches that the peace given in descent is the same as the peace in ascent — divine conjunction is not interrupted by temptation but passes through it unbroken. This is a key Swedenborgian principle. (Ch. 9, 10, 11, 24, 34, 39)

love — *Divine Love itself — the infinite esse of the Lord from which all good proceeds*

As the deepest affection uniting persons, love corresponds to the very esse of the Divine — the infinite good from which all derivative goods proceed and which constitutes the life of all that lives.

The text defines love as 'the Father' — that is, the Divine itself. 'Love is Boundless Time who dwells in his glorious land. The entirety of the divine has been revealed therein.' This directly parallels Swedenborg's identification of Divine Love with the Lord's own esse. (Ch. 23, 33, 36)

hate — *The primal spiritual death — the consuming hatred of all good that arises from self-love; the essential nature of evil* (envy, enmity)

As the opposite of love, hate corresponds to the essential nature of evil — the consuming desire to destroy what is not one's own, arising from self-love and constituting the very life of all hells.

Hate is defined as 'the first death that welled up' — the primordial spiritual death that manifests the realm of falsity. Its essential quality is envy — 'the hatred of all life and good that belongs to another.' This corresponds precisely to Swedenborg's teaching that the essential nature of evil is the lust to appropriate what belongs to the Divine. (Ch. 33, 38)

virginal — *Pristine wisdom — truth that has never been contaminated by falsity or conjunction with evil* (virgin)

As the state of never having been conjoined with another, virginity corresponds to pristine wisdom — truth that has never tasted spiritual death, never been defiled by conjunction with falsity, and retains its original purity from the Divine.

Contrasted with 'continent' (= restored wisdom that was defiled but has been purified). This distinction parallels Swedenborg's distinction between celestial innocence (never fallen) and spiritual innocence (restored through regeneration). (Ch. 40)

continent — *Restored wisdom — truth that was contaminated by falsity but has been purified and returned to holiness*

As the state of having renounced what one formerly indulged, continence corresponds to restored wisdom — truth that descended into mixture with falsity, was defiled, but has been purified through the process of regeneration and restored to its proper holy state.

The text defines this precisely: 'it tasted of the lust; but afterwards was cleansed from it and became a holy one.' This corresponds to the Swedenborgian 'spiritual' degree — truth that has been through temptation and emerged purified. (Ch. 40)

salt — *The craving for conjunction of evil with falsity — the quality of desire that binds falsity to evil love* (salty, salinity)

As a substance that creates thirst and preserves through desiccation, salt corresponds to the craving or desire quality by which evil seeks conjunction with falsity — the preservative force that maintains the bond between corrupt will and corrupt understanding.

The salty inner sea signifies natural knowledge corrupted by the residue of evil — the lingering taste of bitterness from the washing-out of corrupted truth. (Ch. 6, 26)

bitter — *Interior torment — the grief and anguish of unmixed evil; spiritual suffering* (bitterness)

As a taste that causes involuntary rejection and pain, bitterness corresponds to interior spiritual torment — the inherent suffering that constitutes the very life of evil when it is stripped of all stolen goods and exposed in its true nature.

Bitterness as the taste of the world of Darkness and as the fourth property of the Evil Spirit ('his own soul') teaches that the essential life of evil is torment — evil's own experience of itself is bitter. (Ch. 6, 39)

sweet — *Deceptive delight of falsified truth — the seductive quality that makes falsity appear desirable* (sweetness)

As the most attractive taste, sweetness corresponds to delight — in the negative sense, the deceptive pleasantness by which falsified truth seduces the understanding into accepting what is false; in the positive sense, the genuine delight that accompanies truth from good.

Opposite sense: In positive sense: genuine spiritual delight

The 'sweetness of water' as the taste of the water-world (perverted truth) teaches that falsified truth is especially dangerous because it tastes pleasant — seducing the understanding through false delight. (Ch. 6, 14)

lust — *Concupiscence — disordered desire proceeding from self-love; the active force of the proprium that seeks to possess and consume what belongs to the Divine* (desire, concupiscence, cupidity)

As intense, consuming desire for possession, lust corresponds to concupiscence — the active force of the self-derived will that seeks to possess, consume, and appropriate everything to itself, especially what belongs to the Divine.

Lust is consistently paired with fire as 'the father and mother' of all evil — self-love (fire) and concupiscence (lust) together generate all derivative evil. This directly parallels Swedenborg's teaching that the love of self and the love of the world are the two universal origins of all evil. (Ch. 4, 5, 10, 23, 27, 30)

Numerical Correspondences (10)

two — *Conjunction and distinction — the quality of duality as in will and understanding, good and truth, love and wisdom*

Two signifies the quality of conjunction-in-distinction, particularly the fundamental duality of will and understanding, good and truth, love and wisdom — the two aspects of every spiritual reality that must be united for completeness.

Two essences (light and darkness), two ships (sun and moon), two deaths, two sons of Lord Wisdom, two eyes of the body — in every case, two signifies a fundamental duality that defines the structure of reality. The 'two per world' describes the masculine/feminine (= intellectual/volitional) polarity within each degree. (Ch. 4, 7, 17, 24, 32, 35, 36, 44)

three — *Fullness as to degrees — completeness in the vertical dimension of discrete degrees (celestial, spiritual, natural)*

Three signifies fullness as to discrete degrees — the complete vertical structure of successive planes through which the Divine proceeds and through which all spiritual reality is organized: the celestial, the spiritual, and the natural.

Three earths, three vessels, three garments, three rocks, three emanations from each father, three seasons, three days, three deaths, three wars — the number three pervades the text's architecture. Every triad represents the same reality: the threefold structure of discrete degrees through which all spiritual substance passes. (Ch. 1, 3, 7, 11, 12, 13, 17, 24, 25, 32, 39)

four — *Fullness of reception in all directions — completeness of conjunction with the Divine in every quarter of spiritual existence*

Four signifies fullness of reception in all directions — the complete spatial extent of spiritual reception, like the four cardinal points or four walls that enclose and protect from every side.

Four days, four nights, four hunters, four advents, four mountains, four walls, four climes — four consistently signifies the complete quadrant-structure of spiritual reception. The four are always 'distributed three by three before his face' when combined with twelve, showing the relationship between four (reception) and twelve (completeness). (Ch. 1, 4, 5, 21, 27, 35, 42)

five — *Fullness as to manifestation — the complete set of spiritual faculties through which interior reality is expressed and perceived in the outermost degree*

Five signifies fullness as to manifestation in the sensory and natural degree — the complete complement of faculties (perception, thought, teaching, counsel, consideration) by which the spiritual is made present in the natural, and by which the natural perceives the spiritual.

The number five is the most architecturally significant number in the entire corpus. Five elements, five worlds, five garments, five sons, five fathers, five trees, five fleshes, five senses, five faculties of the mind, five wars, five releases, five watches, five camps — everything in this text is organized in fives. The five always correspond to the complete set of faculties by which spiritual reality is made manifest and perceived at a given degree. (Ch. 2, 3, 5, 6, 7, 9, 10, 11, 13, 14, 16, 17, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 34, 35, 36, 42)

seven — *Holy fullness — completeness of a spiritual state or process from beginning to end*

Seven signifies what is holy and complete — the fullness of a spiritual state or operation when it has passed through all its phases and reached its divine conclusion. It represents the sanctification of what six (labor) has prepared.

Seven works of the Lord of Covenants, seven firmaments, seven hostels for rebels, seven ditches, seven rulers in each bodily world, seven good things the sun does, seven evil things the night does — seven consistently signifies the complete cycle of a spiritual process. The seventh firmament where the Lord of the Settled Lands dwells is the inmost rational degree. (Ch. 10, 18, 19, 21, 26, 27, 31, 32, 34, 36)

ten — *Fullness of remains — all truths and goods stored inwardly by the Lord for use in regeneration*

Ten signifies the fullness of remains — all the goods and truths that the Lord stores within the interior memory from infancy onward, constituting the complete treasury from which regeneration draws its material.

Ten firmaments, ten vehicles of the Kingdom of Wisdom, ten works of the Envoy, ten parts (five male, five female) — ten signifies the complete fullness of what constitutes the structural basis of the spiritual world. The ten firmaments are the ten ascending degrees of heavenly consciousness. (Ch. 4, 8, 11, 21, 27, 29)

twelve — *All things of faith and the living assembly in their completeness — the full complement of truths and goods that constitute a complete spiritual order*

Twelve signifies all things of faith and love in their completeness — the full and total complement of goods and truths that together constitute a complete spiritual order, whether heavenly or infernal.

Opposite sense: When belonging to darkness: a counterfeit completeness of falsity — the full system of evil organized to oppose the Divine

Twelve hours of each day and night, twelve judges, twelve zodiacal signs, twelve seals, twelve spirits of error, twelve wisdoms — twelve always signifies completeness of an organized spiritual system. The twelve signs of the zodiac when inverted become the twelve governing principles of evil's dominion. (Ch. 4, 10, 11, 14, 18, 22, 23, 26, 35, 36)

fourteen — *Complete dominion as to both good and truth — the fullness of spiritual governance through the conjunction of derivative goods and derivative truths*

As 7+7 or as 5+5+2+2, fourteen signifies the complete dominion that arises from the conjunction of goods and truths in their holy fullness — both the seven of celestial completeness and its mirror in the spiritual degree, united.

Opposite sense: When belonging to darkness: fourteen heads of the dragon = complete perversion of governance over both will and understanding

The fourteen aeons of light are explicitly enumerated as 5+5+2+2 (five sons of Lord Wisdom, five sons of the Lord of Covenants, plus the summons and obedience). The fourteen heads of the dragon similarly comprise seven sense-faculties above and seven below — a complete perversion of governance. (Ch. 10, 40)

eighteen — *The fullness of governing principles across all degrees — complete spiritual governance as it operates through every plane of existence*

As 9+9, eighteen signifies the fullness of governing authority distributed between the interior heavens and the exterior spiritual world — nine governing principles in each realm, together constituting the complete system of divine governance.

Eighteen thrones (9 in the outer aeons + 9 in the zone) and eighteen garments surrounding a child (9 + 9) — in both cases signifying the complete covering or governance of spiritual reality from both the interior and exterior sides. (Ch. 19, 26)

twenty-five — *Fullness of manifestation multiplied by itself — the complete self-replication of all five faculties within each of the five faculties*

As 5×5, twenty-five signifies the complete interpenetration of the five spiritual faculties — each faculty containing within itself the full complement of all five, producing a total integration of manifestation at every level.

The twenty-five characteristics 'in their twenty-five limbs' explicitly derive from five times five — each of the five garments of Lord Wisdom containing five interior powers. This signifies total integration: every faculty of spiritual perception contains within itself the complete structure of all five. (Ch. 42)